

43 AD



*- Invasion & Insurrection -
Roleplaying in Roman Britain*

ZOZER

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Roleplaying in Roman Britain*

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INTRODUCTION

43AD is the roleplaying game of Roman invasion and of native British resistance to Roman rule. In **43AD** the Roman legions crossed the English Channel under orders from emperor Claudius and began the conquest of barbarian Britain. Resistance from the Iron-Age tribes was fierce and unrelenting. The last futile attempts to complete the conquest were still in progress forty-years later!

43AD is a gritty military-style game with a slice of dark horror running through it. Life is grim and the world of the native Britons is painted in dark and horrific colours. Britain is a place of fear and death, terrors and torments, and the Iron-Age tribes live with these horrors. Celtic priests, the druids, contain them in lakes and pits and forests. When the legions step onto British soil, they step onto a land of ancient horrors of which they (as yet) know nothing. Life, honour and warfare amongst the tribes is explained for players and GMs alike.

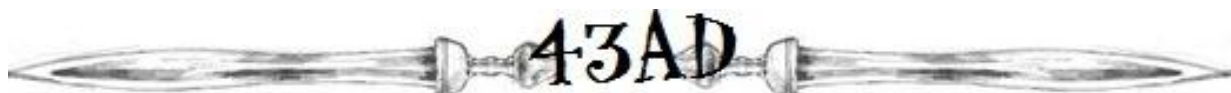
Characters are Roman soldiers, fighting for the emperor in a hostile land against the battle-hardened warriors of the tribes. This is the visible enemy, but beyond, should the Game Master wish to go there, lay the dark secrets of Britain, the night terrors, the death-bringing spirits of the wild, the night crawlers, the face eaters, the skinchangers and the rest of the monsters and wild things that infest Britain. The tribes themselves live in fear of these malign entitles. But at least they know of their existence! As the legions march into hostile territory, they think their toughest battles are going to be with blue-faced tribesmen. How little they know ...

CONVENTIONS

The game uses normal **six-sided** dice for nearly all rolls. A single D100 is required during character creation.

Language Conventions. This game is written in modern English, but tries to convey an account of life two thousand years ago, amongst two very different cultures. Latin and Brythonic were the languages of the day, but words in **43AD** are given in these languages only sparingly, or for the GM's information. Fort is used rather than castra, spear rather than lancea, tribe rather than teuta. Plain English is the order of the day. Sometimes, however, an ancient word evokes an image or mood and is used instead; such as druid, gladius, dun, rath and vicus. When the ancient name for a place is known (Rutupiae, for example), it is used, but the modern name is always given in parenthesis (eg. Richborough). This facilitates further research by the Game Master, if required.

Conventions of Measure. By fortunate co-incidence the Romans used a system of measures very similar to the modern 'feet-and-inches'. This modern system is used throughout the game. Please note that 'miles' and 'feet' in **43AD** are *modern* 'miles' and 'feet', not Roman (which were slightly shorter). Weights are less compatible, but one Roman libra is roughly equivalent to a modern 'pound', divided into twelve uncia (roughly equivalent to a modern 'ounce'). The Romans measured capacity (grains and liquids) in modii (sing. modius), equivalent to around 16 modern pints. Each modius was divided into 16 sextarii (sing. sextarius) of about a pint each.



Naming Conventions: A long list of names (both Brythonic - that is native British) and Roman are given in chapter XII, Play Aids. Both players and Gamemaster can use these lists to create character names. The GM will also need to create names for hills, rivers, forests, ridges and other geographic locations. Two methods are possible. One is to improvise, making up a short name that sounds vaguely Celtic, the other is to use plain English. A mountain might be called Gwethir (according to the first method), or Black-Rush Mountain (according to the second) - both are acceptable!

Date Conventions: All dates are given as AD in order to assist the Game Master in researching any aspect of the background further. Romans and Romanised Britons might use the year of the foundation of Rome as their dating system, more likely they used the rule of the various provincial governors. "I was born in the second year of the rule of Tiberius Avidius Quietus".

CHANGING HISTORY

Do not be deceived by this book's title. This is a game, not a history lesson. Plenty of historical background is given to assist the Game Master in placing his characters in time and space, but once the game begins, it ceases to be historical. The gloves are off, anything can and should happen. It is a poor GM who forces events to occur just as they did in history ***despite*** the actions of the player-characters. If they assassinate emperor Claudius when he crosses the Thames, or persuade Cogidubnus to support the resistance, then so be it. The whole point of roleplaying within a historical setting such as this, is to answer those 'what ifs' as well as give players the thrill of participating in historical events. A writer of historical fiction ***must*** conform to the historical record, but the GM and players have no such limitation. This is one great virtue of the roleplaying game!

Alea iacta est (the die is cast)
Julius Caesar





I CONQUEST

The villa was a fine one, the freshly lain mosaics gleaming in the unseasonable sun.

'Is it to your liking?' asked the tribune, holding his crested helmet under his arm as the king surveyed his new courtyard.

'It is,' said King Cogidubnus. Already, mere weeks after the legionaries had landed on the shore controlled by his tribesmen, Cogidubnus was wearing the toga and speaking passable Latin. 'You have made the right choice, tribune. Rome could easily have gone to war with us. Instead, I feel our alliance is off benefit to all.' Cogidubnus threw a couple of scraps from his plate to the dogs scurrying around his feet.

'Caesar agrees,' said the tribune. 'Rome does not oppose those whom she can befriend.' The tribune cleared his throat. 'There is still the matter of the scouts.'

'Ah, yes. You went behind my back and sent them to spy on my holdings inland. Rather rude, I think.'

'Intelligence on our friends is a necessity for an alliance,' said the tribune briskly. 'I hope you can understand. But they are good men and if they are found, their return would help seal our friendship.'

'I am sure,' said Cogidubnus idly, 'they were merely following the orders of your Caesar. He is a god, is he not? Or will be when he is dead?'

'That is our way.'

Cogidubnus flicked another scrap of meat to his dogs. The tribune saw for the first time that the meat was raw and bloody. 'I am beginning to understand,' said the king, licking his fingers, 'how you Romans do things.'

In the year 43, a force of approximately 40,000 professional soldiers invaded Britain. For over a generation they fought to subdue the native tribes, fought with iron blades, with fire, and with brutal intimidation. Lives were changed, many were swiftly ended, but without a doubt the invasion of 43 AD transformed life in Britain for the next three centuries - and beyond. What stories could that generation tell? This roleplaying game allows players to explore the invasion from the viewpoint of Roman soldiers, either fresh to the islands, unsure of what they will encounter, or soldiers generations later, trying to secure the hard-won Roman province from belligerent tribes and dark forces.

This chapter gives an account of the invasion. Within are campaign suggestions and adventure seeds which can be utilised by the Game Master (GM) to form the basis of his game. Later chapters describe Britain, its people and its invaders in great detail, and are similarly interspersed with scenario and campaign ideas. The game rounds off with a chapter that gives advice to the GM on making and using props to increase the atmosphere of his 43AD games.

THE ISLAND OF THE MIGHTY

For the ancients, the world ended where Ocean began. There were many seas, lakes and rivers - but only one Ocean, a world-girdling river of immense size and ferocity, a churning mass of storms and sea-monsters that surrounded the flat disc of the ancient world in all directions. And yet, there lived a remote



tribe, the Veneti, clinging to the coastline of the world on the shores of the Ocean. Its men folk could sail into it and across it, and reach mysterious islands that floated beyond a veil of mist. These islands they called the Britanni. Who knew what awful terrors lived on these remote islands? What barbaric races and lost tribes forgotten by the gods still dwelt there in primitive savagery?

In 55 BC, Julius Caesar conquered the Veneti and stole their secrets. Standing on the cliff-tops, his world-conquering army behind him, Caesar could see Britain through the mists - the abode of giants, the land of Apollo, of blood-cults and cannibals. No man had conquered that remote wilderness. The glory that awaited the general brave enough to cross the savage Ocean and win a victory there, would be immense. No enemy, no king, would dare stand against the man who could conquer the unconquerable Ocean. Even his hero, Alexander, had not crossed the Ocean, although he had tried. Caesar might outstrip even Alexander the Great!

And so Julius Caesar led his soldiers, after much effort and mishap, across the wild waters and onto the unknown shores. He did battle with the tribes and forced those close to the coast to submit to his rule. A year later he returned to cow the Tribes once again, and then he left, his godhood assured ... his destiny to be played out elsewhere.

In 43 AD, almost a century after Caesar's incredible adventure, the Emperor Claudius has *his* eyes set on mysterious Britain. Recently elevated to the purple by a fickle Praetorian Guard, he is keen to win battle honours, and to keep the legions busy fighting barbarians - instead of fighting one another in a civil war. He astutely recognises that the remote lands of Britain, swimming in Ocean, would provide more than enough glory to secure his tenuous hold on the throne of Rome. His plan is daring, to cross those terrible waters, to conquer the tribes there who resist, and then to stay, to create a province out of this land of myth and legend, to exploit its land and its resources. He will give it as a gift to the Senate!

The spies and agents of Claudius return with many useful facts. There are some tribes on the island who are engaged in ancient feuds with their neighbours, and who would welcome the armed intervention of the Romans. Claudius will be most happy to oblige. There are iron mines, gold and tin in abundance, a brisk trade in slaves from the interminable wars of the tribes, and wheat a-plenty in the summer months. In addition, Britain's mysterious reputation seems to hold water. The Greeks claim that the god Apollo rests amongst the people of the island, that they call it Hyperborea and that they worship his coming at a large round temple. Spies of Claudius claim to have seen this circular temple for themselves. The myths are true!

Of course, the emperor Claudius requires some pretext, some reason to send his legions out into the Ocean. In AD 43 that pretext has arrived in the shape of Verica, king of the Atrebates. This tribe, on the south coast of Britain, has been loyal to Rome since the invasion of Julius Caesar. A violent and power-hungry Tribe called the Catuvellauni, which was severely mauled by the legions of Caesar and forced to submit to him, has invaded the territory of tribe after tribe. Some of these tribes still ship gold across the Ocean to Rome, in honour of Caesar to whom they once pledged oaths of loyalty. The two brother-kings of the Catuvellauni have tried to wipe out all those kings loyal to the memory of Caesar and to Rome. They hate all things Roman and have welcomed with open arms refugees from conquered Gaul, including members of the outlawed Druid sect.

King Verica has come to Rome to appeal to the emperor; there he meets up with Prince Adminius of the Catuvellauni, a man also loyal to Rome, but cruelly ostracised by his hot-headed brothers, Caratacus and Togidumnus, for his sympathies.



Will the Catuvellauni conquer Britain before the legions of Rome even get there? Will the brothers Caratacus and Togidumnus create on the island a haven for every malcontent, refugee and outlaw from Roman justice? Could the savage cunning of the druid mystics help the Catuvellauni to launch their own attacks on Roman Gaul? Surely the Senate will not sit still for this. Emperor Claudius will have his legions, and he will have his glorious victory! The invasion is on ...

THE CROSSING

It was just like the build-up to war six years ago, when Caligula had tried to convince us to board the ships and sail across the Ocean to Britain. His invasion had come to a stand-still at Gesoriacum when we flatly refused. Most of the army just mutinied, and it wasn't only the rank and file, the centurions and optios too were with us. What was he going to do, execute us all?

We were there again. Again we'd stayed in our tents and refused to march down to the ships. I was scared, I don't mind admitting - I'd heard the stories of giants and of wild Tribes that preserved the heads of their victims and trapped their souls inside. And we knew for certain that the Druid scrum who had fled Roman justice in Gaul were now in Britain, across the water. Their horrible rites were an abomination; they were known to receive messages from their Gods by stabbing bound and captured legionaries, and observing how the dying men squirmed, flailed and stumbled.

Narcissus, the emperor's right-hand man addressed the Twentieth legion on the parade ground. We all jeered the idiot, he wore a fine toga, but he had been a house slave and was now a freeman! Some of the soldiers were all for throwing stones. In the end he made a fine speech and laughed at himself, calling himself Saturninus, after the mid-winter festival of Saturnalia where slaves swap roles with their masters for a day. We like an officer who sees the funny side, and applauded him. And so, the next morning we were on the ships...

Campaign Suggestion #1

Player-characters are all soldiers in the same Roman auxiliary cohort, or in the Twentieth, Ninth or Fourteenth legion. The game begins in Gaul with the mutiny, then follows their unit's progress into Britain, through Kent and across the Thames into Catuvellaunian territory. They can participate in innumerable skirmishes as well as all of the big battles of the campaign. By the start of 44 AD they will all be hardened veterans!

Most of the day was spent on those groaning galleys, and we parted the veil of mist that separated the world of men from these mysterious islands. Once through the veil we could see white cliffs, and an hour later our squadron navigated a wide channel to come up into a safe haven. During the voyage, my centurion Titus Antoninus, had told endless tales of Caesar's invasion, and how the troops had been forced to fight simply to get off the ships. Mercifully, we were spared that, and by dusk the bulk of the men and material was onshore and our defensive camp was almost completed. We had made landfall on the infamous Island of the Mighty - Britain. Would we ever step foot on those boats again?

AFTER THE LANDING

The four legions and their accompanying auxiliaries (mercenary soldiers from warrior tribes who fought with Roman arms and armour) sailed across in three divisions, landing at Richborough (Rutupiae) in Kent. Richborough sat (in Roman times) on a promontory that stuck out into the sea. Immediately in front of Richborough was the Isle of Thanet, in those days a real, water-bound, island. Between Richborough and the mainland, and the island was a narrow channel, the Wanstum Channel - a perfect natural anchorage. This



made Richborough vital, it guarded the southern end of this channel, while Reculver, also swiftly garrisoned by the fleet, guarded the northern end.

A native track-way led from Richborough to Canterbury (later becoming Roman Durovernum), and led on to Bigbury hillfort to the west of the settlement, then across Kent toward the River Medway and the Tamesis (River Thames). Canterbury was quickly occupied, and since it had a river navigable directly from the Wanstun Channel, it became a vital Roman supply depot in support of further military action. A range of wooded hills called the North Downs ran east to west across Kent, and these hills were used by the Roman commander, Aulus Plautius, to shift his invasion force westwards. Plautius led three legions on a direct lowland route through Blean Woods from Canterbury to Rochester (Durobrivae); meanwhile his second-in-command, Gnaeus Hosidius Geta, led one legion, one cavalry regiment and auxiliary cohorts along the northern escarpment of the North Downs, providing flank protection for the main force, whilst clearing the wooded hilltops of enemy scouts and raiders. The North Downs Way was an ancient trackway, dry and safe in all seasons. A garrison made up of infantry cohorts taken from various units remained at Canterbury to guard the store base, while others garrisoned the invasion camp at Richborough. These landing and supply points were now vulnerable to native attack.

Plautius was frustrated to find that the British warriors refused to fight, but instead hid in the forests and marshes of Kent, waiting for the Romans to expend their supplies and return to Gaul. The Tribes had been cocksure and disbanded the armies once they heard about the mutiny. After-all, the last mutiny stalled the entire invasion, why wouldn't this one?

Campaign Suggestion #2

The PCs are members of the Second Legion, sent personally by Vespasian (the legion's commander) to escort Prince Cogidubnus to Calleva. Here he is to take up the rule of the south, from Caratacus' own dun. It is quite an opulent, sophisticated place, but still, the locals may not give this prince the welcome he deserves. The campaign focuses on the characters' attempts to protect the prince, and root out any treachery. He is literate, well-read and used to Roman comforts, how will he settle in to a British dun? Do the Atrebates and die-hard Caratacus' supporters have a surprise in store for the prince and his Roman guard-dogs?

The Roman column, strung out and vulnerable, soon attracted the attention of the canny British warriors, but the legions first defeated the force led by Caratacus (the Battle of Blean Woods), and then one led by Togidumnus. Both princes fled eastward, to gather forces at the River Medway. Following these initial battles, representatives of the Dobunni, unwilling allies of the Catuvellauni, surrendered their Tribe to the Romans.

The Roman army moved westward through Kent, and was faced with a substantial British force at the River Medway. The Britons were confident in their

safety, but the Romans were determined to cross this large river. The Fourteenth Legion held the bank while Batavian cavalry crossed in secret to the north and routed the British chariot force. The Second Legion under Vespasian crossed at night to the south and gave battle, the Twentieth followed as a supporting force. Unusually for an ancient battle, it was not resolved by nightfall, the British warriors sheltering in woods not far from the riverbank. In the morning fighting resumed, the Fourteenth crossed the Medway directly while the Ninth legion waited in reserve. The British force under the command of the two princes eventually crumbled and the warriors fled into the marshes northwards that bordered the Tamesis. Here they crossed via a bridge. The Roman legions were in pursuit.

The Twentieth legion pursued the fleeing warriors, whilst the Second Legion marched westward before turning north toward the Tamesis; its job was to cut off any southerly escape route. The Fourteenth followed behind the Twentieth. The Ninth remained east of the Medway, as a rear-guard and construction battalion.



With the Britons in full retreat the Romans pursued them to the River Tamesis. There Caratacus and Togidumnus organised a defence along the north bank. In this period the Thames flowed through reed-beds and marshes out into the Mare Germanicum, there was little habitation along the banks but for a scattering of roundhouses and farmsteads. Again, units of Batavian auxiliaries swam the river, while the Twentieth Legion made a direct assault (probably in transport vessels supported by artillery from warships). The British force was defeated and Togidumnus killed. Aulus Plautius did not advance on the Catuvellaunian capital, however. His scouts reported that the Tribes were not regrouping. This was the end. This was victory.

Plautius halted the Roman army and sent for the Emperor Claudius who arrived in Britain close to the end of the campaigning season. Claudius brought with him additional troops and even elephants, these assets may not have been needed, however - it was simply that Claudius wanted to take the glory of total conquest for himself!

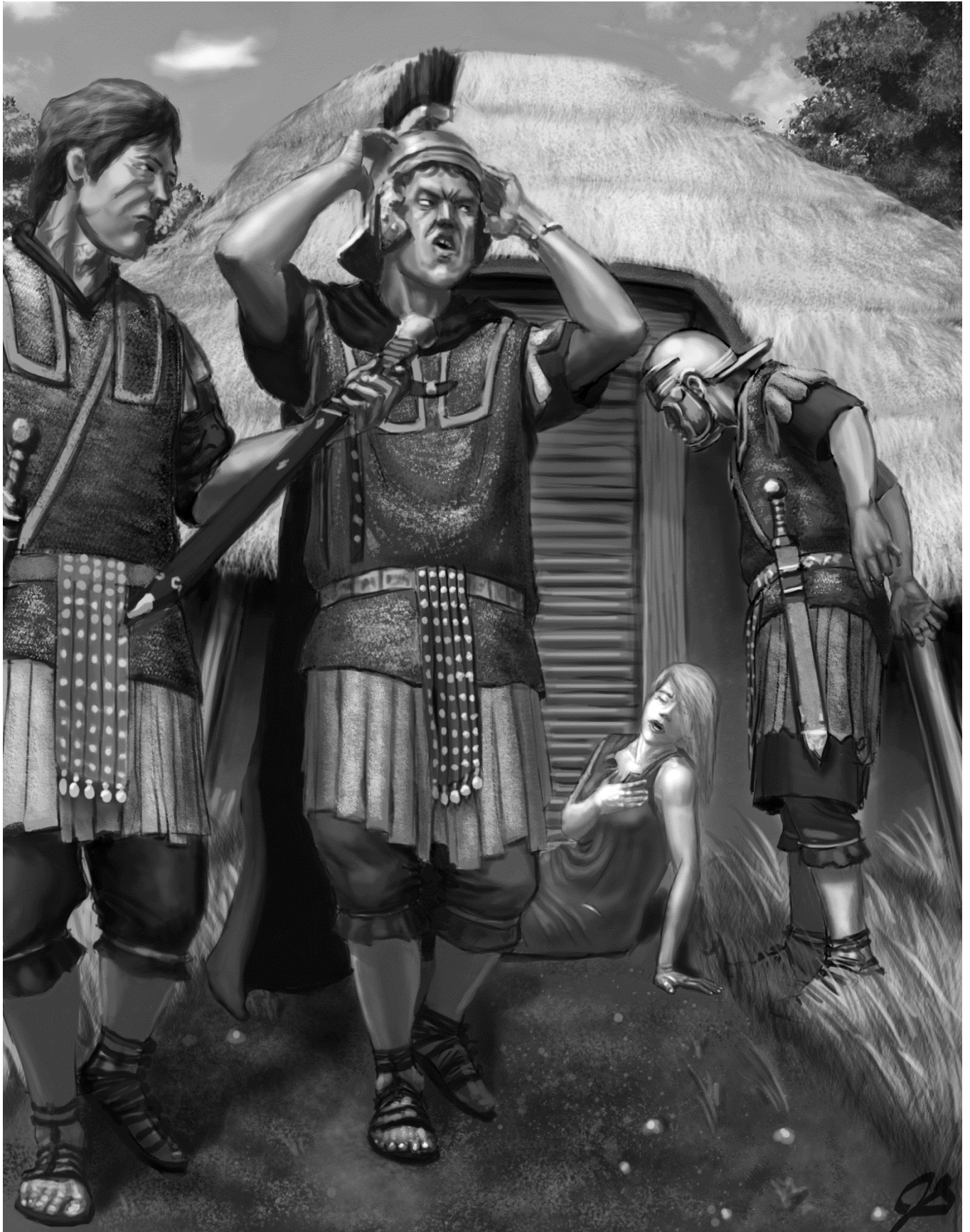
Whilst the Roman forces awaited their emperor, Cogidubnus the sophisticated Roman-taught British nobleman, was dispatched to rule the Atrebatas with Roman support from Calleva (modern Silchester). This had been Caratacus' home, and the home of his warband, family and retainers. Cogidubnus served as a client ruler, pro-Roman and ultra-sophisticated, ready to lead the other Chiefs by example. Elements of the Second Legion may have accompanied him.

Perhaps at Chelmsford (Caesaromagus), Claudius joined his troops and took command, he had with him (quite unusually) a number of distinguished senators from Rome plus a huge court entourage. Led by Claudius and his elephants, the Roman force advanced into Catuvellaunian territory. It is likely that there were additional minor battles, before the Roman legionaries marched in to capture the Tribal capital at Colchester (Camulodunum) It seems that the Catuvellauni simply surrendered and overnight became close allies of Rome. Claudius' victory quickly triggered the submission of many of the southern Tribes, which were disarmed and handed over to Aulus Plautius for governance. Plautius was named as governor of Britain (at least the Britain that had been conquered and which was worth governing!). Already the respected chief Cogidubnus was installed as the Great King (rex magnus) over the tribes of the south coast.

As Claudius journeyed back to Rome, the general Vespasian was already preparing to campaign in the west with his Second Legion. Caratacus had fled west, away from the humiliating surrender of his kinfolk. He would soon be brewing up revolt and resistance against the Roman occupation.

Campaign Suggestion #3

PCs are members of Vespasian's security troops in the Salisbury Plain area, west of Calleva in 44 and 45. Can Vespasian find these damn rebels or their families? The Plain is a haunted land, covered with hundreds of Hollow Hills, focussed around the Old Stone Circle at Stonehenge. Do these have any influence over the campaign? The mixed Roman force garrisons the wooden fort of Cunetio, at Mildenhall, near Marlborough. Caratacus' warband dwells on the plain and in the dense Savernake Forest, south of the fort. Stonehenge is 20 miles, and Calleva is 30 miles from this Roman fort.





II ESTABLISHING THE CAMPAIGN

Their orders had been simple. Hold the ford until were relieved. Cnaeus had set out with a handful of legionaries and auxilia to do just that.

Things had rapidly become more complicated.

Cnaeus leaned against a tree to catch his breath and get a good look at the men who had fled with him. The Gaul he knew, a filthy and foul-mouthed creature even by Auxilia standards. He wasn't mouthing off now, though – he was bent double spluttering for air. The boy was an adjutant to one of the officers and it seemed to be Fates' own warped will that the youth had made it when so many had died. The last man was a bearded Briton who had started gibbering nonsense the moment everything had started to slide to Hades.

'One of us has to make it back to Luguvalium and tell them what happened,' said Cnaeus. 'If any man lags behind, he dies. Understand?' The youth nodded, terror in his eyes. The Gaul just spat on the ground. Another man had joined them. He had jet-black skin and was spattered with blood.

'You!' said the man in thickly accented Latin. 'You're from the legion. They live?' Cnaeus shook his head. 'Just us. You're from the Numidian cavalry, yes?'

'I am.' The Gaul grinned bleakly. 'You're a bloody long way from Numidia, mate.'

The crash of bodies through the trees reached them. The enemy were whooping in that damned animal tongue of theirs. The Briton whimpered at the sound.

'It is not so different from here,' said the Numidian, drawing his spear.

The great draw of this era is the Roman legion, that infamous military organisation that conquered much of the known world. The player characters are Roman soldiers, working side-by-side within the same unit to carry out their orders. This is a purely military game, with all of the advantages and disadvantages that this implies.

THE MISSION

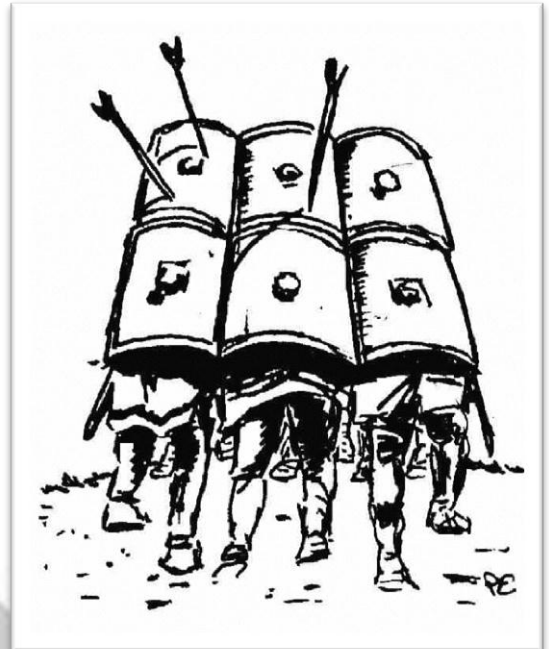
A military scenario benefits from a strong central goal - fulfil the mission assigned to you! Obey orders! Work with your team-mates, use the equipment and intelligence provided! As such, the Band of Brothers-style campaign can be easy to organise and run, it can be focussed, exciting and actually mean something in the grand scheme of the war. Players are never at a loss for something to do - orders are handed out at the start of each game, and the players have leeway in meeting the mission objectives. In addition, every Game Master

will be familiar with the military genre, and missions for a small unit of Roman soldiers will be relatively easy to create. We've seen countless examples in war movies over the years! In fact, the Roman army was the world's first fully professional standing army; because of this, many, many scenarios, situations and missions that armies in later historical periods carried out, are just as applicable in 43 AD.

This focus on the mission, and on the need to carry out orders from above, re-enforces team-work amongst the players, and player team-work is always encouraged within the game.

Having the scenario fed to the players as a mission briefing can of course be very restrictive. Why roleplay, when you have to follow someone else's agenda? *"March west to the ford, set up an observation post for sixteen hours and capture any Brigantian messengers heading south. Then return to the fort via the old cemetery."* Is that an adventure?

In reality, military orders in many historical periods involved a lot of autonomy, at every level. For the Game Master, this means that a mission briefing can be set up to allow a great deal of lee-way for the player-characters. The centurion or his optio may assemble the squad in the courtyard of the principia (headquarters building) and present the briefing to the assembled team. *"Orders have come down from the legatus, we need to capture some Brigantians, and find out what messages they are sending to the Coritani. I've chosen you all because of your record, you're all adaptable and good at improvising. I want you to get out there, snatch a couple of Brigantian couriers and bring them back here... I suggest a set piece ambush, or an observation post – bring me back a squealer!"*



The mission objectives should be crystal clear, but the methods should be given only in outline. Let the players themselves sit down and plan the mission. To be honest, it's half of the fun, not least because a good GM *always* ensures the plan goes awry! Let the players plan. Give them mission outlines with firm objectives. Deadlines are also effective tools that the GM can use to increase tension and keep the team focussed on the mission. Add to the briefing above: *"Get back before dawn, because unless your captives tell us nothing is going on between the two kingdoms, the legatus is moving the legion forward to take the Coritani capital by force. Hundreds of our men will die in the assault. Get the captives back here by dawn!"*

It's the same mission, but with the stress-o-meter turned to 9! Time limits also force the Roman soldiers to make uncomfortable decisions. If we spot no-one, how long do we wait at the ford? Why don't we hit the homestead along the river bank instead, it would be quicker... what if we get delayed returning? What happens when a captive claims he knows nothing, but that his foster-brother two-hours away knows the entire Brigantian battle plan? Do they have time to mount a raid into Brigantian territory to snatch him?

In this way, a simple order received from on high can be used to create a very interesting scenario that provides the player-characters with innumerable decisions, problems and options – without railroading them. The military is renowned, in every age, for monotonous missions repeated ad nauseum - patrol, guard duty, patrol, courier duty, patrol etc. The GM only has to remember that although the briefing can certainly bear a passing resemblance to last week's mission, it is the actual resolution of the adventure which is important.



Three kidnap missions could be played one after another, but each should turn out radically different from the others. The first might run as expected. During the second, the legionaries stumble upon a surrendering prince who needs guiding back to friendly territory whilst being pursued by Brigantia's armed might! In the third, the unit might only get to the first farmstead on the route, and discover terrible druid magic at work, forcing them to abandon the snatch in order to deal with the threat. In other words, what happens in the field can be wild, unpredictable, exciting and surprising, no matter what the mission orders were!

THE TEAM

A typical fantasy roleplaying group is made up of a disparate band of adventurers, spell-casters, cut-throats, skill specialists and warriors. In other words a diverse and interesting mix. What choice exists in an army unit of rank and file legionaries, armed and armoured identically? Surely all the Roman soldiers will be the same - is that entertaining to play?

That's the enduring myth of the Roman empire at war, that its soldiers were Cylons, steel-clad automatons, rank upon rank of them. In reality, the soldiers had trades, different skills, even different battlefield roles. Some were archers, others were scouts, some armourers or smiths, yet they trained and lived together, and drew the same rations. Weaponry and equipment was not issued by pattern book, with 'AD 63' patterns replacing all arms and armours prior to 'AD 63'. Instead helmets, swords, armour was handed down, re-used, or bought back off legionary widows, which meant that there was a mix of armour within a legion. Yes, all carried the gladius and a shield, but helmet and sword patterns varied, and some troops may have worn chainmail, while others wore the lorica segmentata much beloved of Hollywood. Some legionaries on carvings are shown with oval, round or even hexagonal shields instead of the curved rectangular scutum. Different missions also required different weapons, an actual group of Roman legionaries were sent into the streets of an Eastern city in plain-clothes, they were to infiltrate a growing mob. When the order was given these men pulled out clubs and sprang on the ring-leaders, thoroughly intimidating the crowds and preventing a riot. Legionaries undercover? Truth is stranger than fiction.

Likewise, a unit of legionaries moving across rough country, perhaps on a scouting expedition might go unarmoured, and carry a mix of shields, some large, some small, some none at all, one man might take bow and arrows, another a spear, his friend a longsword, yet another might take a quiver full of javelins.

More importantly, there is evidence from Britain that the auxiliary troops (barbarian mercenaries, armed and led by Roman officers), were often seconded to legionary units, and worked alongside them. Add to that the possibility of friendly local tribes sending guides and translators to work with the Roman war machine, then you have quite a diverse mix of character types. In addition, it is quite feasible that a tribal warrior or guide might be female, breaking that all-military-all-male stereotype. This certainly gives female players a break!

The character creation rules further on use a method of differentiation familiar to viewers of war movies. Whether it's marines in *Guadalcanal Diary*, airborne soldiers in *Hamburger Hill* or legionaries in *Centurion*, the characters are defined first by their origins and second by their role within the squad. There is the rogue, the joker, the leader, the thinker ... roles vary, but they are important and help differentiate characters.

THE CHAIN OF COMMAND

Roleplaying games have always appealed, because they allowed freedom, the freedom to do what you want and go where you want, to follow your own personal agenda. How is that supposed to work, when one of the other players is in command? Realistically, every military unit, however small, will have a unit commander



and also typically an assistant commander. Roleplaying games have thrived on teamwork, equality and the simple enjoyment of friends sitting around a table together, socialising, and playing characters on an equal basis with one another. Players don't want to be bossed around, and often don't want the role of boss, either! The group leader is expected to come up with plans, settle arguments and their soldiers on the move – its all responsibility which means the leader can take a lot of credit or catch a lot of criticism.

Getting rid of the role of unit leader really saps the dynamic out of the military campaign, turning legionaries into a standard roleplaying group – but in silly uniforms! The answer is not to abandon intra-party rank but to embrace it. Long time gamer and US Army Private First Class (E-3) Conrad Deitrick has summed up the way in which rank actually works in the field for a small unit. *"I'm an E-3, a PFC. My team leader is a Specialist E-4. My squad leader is an E-5, a sergeant. I consider both to be my buddies. They've got more experience than me; I trust their judgement often more than I trust mine, but they're friends and we're in everything together. I've got 'buddies' who are Staff Sergeants, E-6. Its not basic training; we're not talking about Drill Sergeants. Squad leader sergeants don't yell all the time in the regular army. They're too busy looking out for the guys in their squad. You work together and live together, you are friends and battle buddies."*

Having a spread of different ranks within the player-character party is no obstacle, then, to a good game. Modern US Special Forces A-Teams provide quite a good model for any GM organising a Roman military campaign. These 12-man A-Teams are commanded by a Captain, who is assisted by a Warrant Officer. The rest of the team members include a Master Sergeant, Sergeant First Class and a number of Sergeants and Staff Sergeants. The team has no Corporals or Privates. Do all these officers and non-commissioned officers constantly bicker about rank and seniority? In Vietnam, an outsider was hard-pressed to spot which member of an A-team was actually in charge! Everyone did their job; each member of the team had a role: one guy was the weapons sergeant, another the intel sergeant, or the operations sergeant, the medical sergeant, and engineer or communications sergeant. Some of these were duplicated.

THE ROMAN MILITARY UNIT

So, how would these elements all combine to create a player-character unit? A centurion in the team is not unlikely, but more than one certainly would be! The centurion is roughly equivalent to a US Army Captain. Players shouldn't keep looking to rank or to age for authority – rather the players and characters should use experience as a measure of respect. Respect is for experience.

In practice, the character creation system will produce a range of distinct and very soldiers. Detailed skill lists are not used, instead soldiers are capable individuals able to attempt many tasks, each with one or two unique 'skills'. These skills resemble special abilities only available to the character who rolls them in character creation. By giving characters their own special skill, whether its marksmanship, marching with extra kit, or streetwise contacts, each character fills his own niche – just like an American A-Team.

Every team will benefit from the addition of a two or three NPCs. These add weight to the group numbers, especially during combat, and provide a pool of characters that can step in to replace any characters killed during the game. Either the GM can play these

A Few Definitions

Speculatores

Long range scouts, intelligence gatherers, body-guards, spies, couriers. A combination of special forces and military spy.

Exploratores

Long range scouts and recon troops, lightly armed and fast-moving.

Procursatores

Scouts forward of the main army during a march.

Frumentarii

The Imperial secret police, every governor has access to some of these!



NPCs, or the players can take turns in running them.

Selecting Kit

For most missions, the PCs can take along their regular arms, armour and kit. It will all be useful in a fight. For some missions, however, the heavy armour and the big rectangular shields will prove more of a hindrance. Perhaps the squad is going undercover in Londinium, perhaps they are exploring a network of tunnels and caves, or they are climbing one of Britannia's highest mountains

In these cases, the soldiers can take equipment from the legionary stores. The quartermaster (custodes armorum) will make detailed records, and allow them to carry away climbing rope, wicker baskets, small shields, a mule or two ... generally whatever is needed, as long as they have a signature from the centurion. Any of this kit that **is not** returned to the quartermaster must be paid for (probably by the squad as a whole, they can share the expense).

A Typical Mission

A mission might go like this: before dawn the trumpets sound, watches changed and soldiers rise to fetch water, cook outside their barrack blocks and prepare equipment. The centurion of each century goes to the main hall of the principia to receive orders. He is accompanied by an aide from the beneficiarius staff (administration). Other centurions are there, and the most senior amongst them, hands out orders for patrols, guard duty, courier missions, granary guard, tax collection duty etc. These orders are of the everyday type. In a war situation, one of the commander's three tribunes will be there, he is a staff officer, working closely with the legionary commander (legatus). He will have the 'big picture' and give centurions directly their orders. "Titus Antoninus, you will be responsible for guarding this bridge, Gaius Valerius, you will send men to this hilltop pass for 3-days and watch for signs of enemy activity. Take appropriate action – either sending for reinforcements, or attacking"

The centurion returns to his office in his house and writes up the list of duties his men have been given, in peace they have various duties assigned (clean the latrines, customs duty in the town, man the wall-walk, hand out rations from the fort granary etc.) In a war situation, the bare minimum of his century will be assigned to these duties, and he can pull his men together outside the barrack-block for a briefing. They will be carrying out the mission he has been handed. Those men who have certain skills or work well together, will find themselves being given regular roles, whatever the mission.

WHO ARE THE PCs?

The GM may wish to roleplay the lives of regular soldiers, encountering regular problems on a day-to-day basis, or he can arrange for the player-characters to be given the 'special ops' missions. These missions call for small groups of soldiers with a good spread of skills, as well as a large amount of freedom and initiative. Such missions were certainly assigned in Roman times – but the teams were not called 'special ops', more probably they were known as 'speculatores'.

Marius' Mules - The legionaries gained this nickname around 100 BC when the general Marius tried to speed soldiers on the march by having them carry all of their own kit. In this type of campaign the characters can be regular soldiers and the GM can run a regular army campaign that mirrors a number of war movies and countless real-life war diaries. These guys aren't commandoes of special forces, they are regular soldiers following orders, their squad is part of a bigger unit and everyone plays their part. This is *Full Metal Jacket* or the TV series *Band of Brothers*. Day-by-day, mission-by-mission, get through the campaign. This type of game will involve a lot of time 'out-of-action' and stories featuring relationships with other military personnel, or



natives in and around the local settlement. The great appeal of playing Marius' Mules is the way in which the characters are able to develop back stories and plots that involve NPCs.

The campaign would resemble a TV show - with an established fort, commanders and army buddies, established routines and in-jokes, a well-used and very familiar barrack-room, and an interesting and varied cast of NPCs. These will be both inside the fort, and in the vicus outside of it, and the players may get to know them well, game by game. Missions should always appear to be very routine in nature, but of course in practice turn out to be anything but! Since they are part of the regular army, most missions will be undertaken in co-ordination with other parts of the legion or other auxiliary forces. In Marius' Mules, the PCs are part of a large, relentless military machine.

The player-character soldiers may be assigned duties as exploratores, these are scouts, long range patrollers and recon experts that provide intelligence for the legion or auxiliary cohort. Gone for days at a time, they have a great deal of autonomy and much more freedom in what they carry and wear. Exploratores missions may appeal to the players.

Speculatores - This small unit in each legion carried out long-range reconnaissance in hostile territory, sometimes in plain clothes. These speculatores also carried out irregular duties, acting as executioners, kidnappers or couriers. They make an ideal force for 'special ops' - a small group of Roman soldiers often called upon to carry out special missions, without help or back-up. Such small scale missions are perfectly suited to the small independently-natured roleplaying group.

The speculatores would take their secret orders from one of the legion's three tribunes at the principia, and they would share a barrack-block with a regular century of soldiers. It's likely that the PC team have actually been sent to a small auxiliary fort out close to the frontier, in which case the praetor or tribune in command will issue orders to them. Any civilians in the team might easily be able to share the barracks with the regular soldiers. Academics are equally split on the existence of servants, slaves, even families, inside Roman forts!

Missions carried out by the speculatores resemble those found in most war movies featuring raids, special missions and commandos. Look to *Saving Private Ryan*, the CRPG *Splinter Cell* or the real-life Long Range Recon Patrols of the Vietnam War that defended against Communist infiltration by striking deep into enemy territory. The great advantage is the freedom to achieve the goals of the mission without interference from command, and the chance to attempt all kinds of different (and unusual!) missions. The downside is a lack of interaction with any NPCs other than the enemy and the unit commander. The speculatores campaign probably represents the type of game most familiar to roleplayers.

ADVENTURE SEEDS

An exciting military adventure is not determined by what is said by the officer in the briefing. Excitement and adventure stem from what happens *during* a mission. It is the unexpected, the unplanned and the Law of Murphy (see later) which turns a patrol into a memorable adventure!

Prisoner Snatch 1 - The job is to snatch enemy tribesmen that may provide the Roman army with valuable intelligence. But the local interpreter is extremely defensive of his new masters, and slits the throats





of any victims who show disrespect!

Prisoner Snatch 2 - The mission is a prisoner snatch from a designated tribal homestead, but when the team get there they discover an important meeting in progress. Local rebels (with their bodyguards) arrive in force, trapping the PCs. Can they get away - with or without a prisoner?!

Rescue that Man - During a long range patrol, the team see an enemy force with an important-looking Roman prisoner. Can they rescue him?

Fetch Water - The team is recollecting fresh water at a river close to the frontier, and see two Roman bodies float past, one looks like an officer, perhaps a centurion. What happened upstream? Who are these men?

Friendly Farmstead - The team patrols through a friendly farmstead and find the locals in hiding, they were threatened by a scout from a fierce bandit gang yesterday, and the entire gang will come to ransack the settlement right about NOW! Can the PCs create an effective improvised defence?

Collecting Taxes - The team accompanies the tax collector in a local Roman settlement, but a dangerous mob grows and there will be an assassination attempt.

The Fugitive - A soldier has been accused of cowardice and knows he will be executed by stoning outside the fort gates, he has fled and the team are sent out to track him down. Will he perhaps lead them to a notorious gang of deserters and cut-throats? Or to his woman in a lonely homestead?

Centurion Sertorius - This guy has seen too many murders and massacres in the name of Rome. He has flipped and joined a tribe as a warrior-initiate. Now he is roaming the wilderness killing Romans. The team need to lure him out, perhaps by acting as bait. This mission could turn sour - while they are investigating the tribe that took him in, Sertorius has used his knowledge of the Roman military to carry out a surprise attack on the fort! He and his fanatical cannibalistic followers achieve complete surprise and success. Now the team needs to get back into the fort and kill Sertorius!

Collect Tribute - The team is sent to guard a centurion collecting tribute from an allied tribe. They arrive at the hillfort and spend the night, the centurion in deep discussion with the chief. The team have freedom of the hillfort to interact with the locals. When they leave in the morning, with a wagon full of tribute (stolen silver, furs, gold plate and bronze ingots), a boy stows away! He is a foster son of the chief and has been very badly treated. He wants to go home, but his Tribe hates the Romans, and kills on sight! Do the PCs take him back to the hillfort? Do they take him to his own Roman-hating tribe? Or do they tell the centurion - who will probably either kill him or abandon him in the wilderness.

Disease - The vicus is wracked by disease and each century sends a unit down to the river to offer up sacrifices (top-notch military equipment). A young boy tells them that a soldier had taken a sacrificial item out of the river, thus bringing on the wrath of the god and the disease. OK. But why does the disease strike the vicus, not the fort? Is it a retired soldier, or a soldier who spends his free time with a family in the vicus. Once they track him down, what has he done with the item (a gold miniature spearhead), sold on to a merchant, or to a druid out in the wilderness?

Mopping Up - In this straight fight, the team is sent up a hill occupied by an enemy force recently defeated in battle. They have their sector of the fight to deal with.

The Watchtower - Natives claim that one of the fort's distant watchtowers is in trouble and a couple of squads (including the PCs) is sent to check the story out. When they get there, everything seems to be fine. But then rebel forces mount a sudden ambush and the two squads are trapped inside the watchtower. This is a mini siege situation, with all the drama and tactics, but in a shorter time frame and on a small scale.

The New Officer - A new, inexperienced and very young centurion takes command of the PC's century. He takes an instant dislike to the player-characters 'unconventional' methods and picks on them mercilessly. There is continual drill, night duties and long marches, often all in the same day! His missions are equally brutal: bringing back the head of a rebel leader from a valley no Roman soldier dare enter, demolishing



a sacred grove at the great risk of suffering the wrath of the gods, attacking a well defended camp in the woods. Can the PCs get rid of him? Or will they all be killed, or if they survive ... highly decorated!!!

Horse Whisperer - The commander's horse has escaped and run away, the team is sent out to recover it. After following several leads they meet a tribal horse whisperer who tracks the horse to a druid grove in the woods. The druid has three identical horses, all fast asleep. If the soldiers choose the right horse, it will wake and return to the fort. They pick a horse and it returns with them. Unfortunately it is a faerie horse, a changeling, an evil stallion that runs amok! The commander is not happy and complains to the team who must return to the grove. The druid is gone, instead there are faerie warriors guarding a stable within a deep cave in a cliff-face.

Arson - The team must sneak into an enemy hillfort and set fire to the chief's roundhouse. This forces a stealthy approach, and pits the PCs against the elite warriors of the kingdom!

The Hidden Causeway - An enemy hillfort is surrounded by lowland that is flooded at this time of year, protecting the tribe from Roman aggression. The team must use stealth to discover the way across the flooded land (a way used by the natives at night) and lead Roman troops in a surprise attack.

Hostage Rescue - An enemy tribe is holding a Roman hostage. Command has heard that the Tribe intends to transfer him to another tribe further away, and during the transfer the PCs must make a rescue attempt.

Bones of the Dead - A hostile tribe is now friendly, and reports that it has the bones of several Roman soldiers, killed many years ago. The PCs are sent to recover the bones. While at the hillfort they discover a plot to kill the chief and replace him with an anti-Roman chief, turning back the new policy of friendship and reconciliation. Stop the murder!

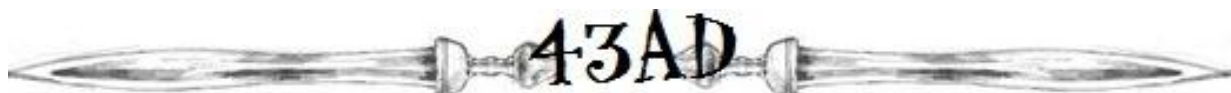
Silver Torc - A Roman soldier has stolen a silver torc that has been dedicated to the god Camulos, and that was destined to be thrown into a sacred lake. Now Camulos is angry and the Roman fort is wracked by illness and fever, the torc must be given to the god and cast into the lake. Unfortunately, the lake is deep in enemy territory and if the tribes get hold of the torc, they will complete the sacrificial ritual, cast it into the lake themselves, then sweep down onto the fort and win a resounding victory (since the garrison is so ill). A team of stealthy, foolhardy soldiers is needed for this daring job ...

The Twenty-Four Hour Hostage - Local tribes are meeting on the frontier with Roman representatives to discuss new treaty arrangements. The treaty threatens to be totally ruined, however, by a die-hard chief from a recalcitrant tribe. The PCs must kidnap this chief and murder his entourage before they make it to the council, hold him for 24 hours, and then let him go. They must ensure that there can be no evidence linking them with the Roman army, and they must make some effort to convince the chief that he is being held for some other reason. This is a difficult mission!

Gangland - The mother of an ex-gangster from the nearby Roman town has come to the commander to appeal for his rescue. The man has offered to tell the authorities every detail of the gang's illegal dealings, and as a consequence his violent associates have kidnapped him. They now holding him in some town basement and torturing him to discover what the authorities already know. Can the PCs rescue him before they go too far and do him in?

War Wagon - A small band of determined but poorly armed bandits, outlaws from Roman justice, are living in the woods and attacking civilian supply wagons. The PCs must masquerade as traders and take a wagon through the forest to entice the rebels into attacking. They will not be able to withstand a disciplined Roman squad when forced to fight.

Apollo-in-the Grove - There is a disturbing number of Roman defectors, fleeing into the forest to join a mysterious band rebels. Why? The PCs must pretend to be deserters looking to join this new rebel force. It is said to be led by Apollo-in-the-Grove. In truth, the leader is a mystical youth with a powerful charisma who styles himself as Apollo, and the islands of Britain his own. He has a hypnotic stare and a voice which can stop a man in his tracks. This commune is a cult of warrior fanatics, fuelled and controlled by mind-altering fungi.



Can the PCs join without arousing suspicion? Can they get out again to make their report without getting hopelessly caught up in the cult?

MURPHY'S LAW

Ex quocumque facere poteris te sauciabit, nihilo comprehenso

Anything you do can get you killed, including nothing

To truly conjure up the experience of Roman army life, the GM and players can really do no better than to peruse Murphy's Laws, a cynical list of military adages shot through with black humour. These are timeless, and reflect the pessimism and resignation of the common soldier to the adversities and insanities of organized warfare.

Collaboratio maximi momenti est, quia eis alterum scopum praebet

Teamwork is essential; it gives the enemy other people to shoot at.

Here are the Murphy's Laws, adapted for the legions:

- No matter which way you have to march, its always uphill.
- Never stand when you can sit, never sit when you can lie down, never stay awake when you can sleep.
- The enemy never watches until you make a mistake.
- Make it too tough for the enemy to get in, and you won't be able to get out
- A retreating enemy is just falling back and regrouping
- Field experience is something you don't get until just after you need it.
- The worse the weather, the more you are required to be out in it.
- The newest and least experienced soldier will usually win the highest decoration.
- Every command which can be misunderstood, will be.
- Don't ever be the first, don't ever be the last and don't ever volunteer to do anything.
- The more stupid the leader is, the more important missions he is ordered to carry out
- Your bivouac for the night is the spot where you got tired of marching that day
- No battle plan ever survives contact with the enemy
- If you really need an officer in a hurry, take a nap
- Complain about the rations all you want, but just remember; they could very well be your last meal
- Hope for the best, but prepare for the worst

Si impetus bene it, in laqueum incessistis

If your advance is going well, you are walking into an ambush



III CREATING MILITARY CHARACTERS

'This is Rome,' said Servillius.

'This is Rome,' echoed Gaius.

'Like you mean it!' snapped the centurion.

Gaius looked at what he held in his hands. The blade was just less than three feet long and dead straight, the grip beneath the hilt gnurled for his fingers. The blade was wide, the point just the right angle to force the whole length through skin and flesh.

It was ugly. War was ugly, too. That was what set the Romans apart. They accepted all the ugliness that victory demanded. The gladius was designed to inflict the ugliest death, to thrust up beneath a shield into a man's belly. It only had to sink in a couple of fingers to kill him. And before he died he would lie squealing, holding his guts in and rolling on the floor, and the men around him would be struck cold with the inhumanity of such a sight. That was the secret. That was why the Roman eagle was held over this place, this distant pit of a country, the edge of creation.

Gaius weighed up the gladius. It was perfect for killing. Nothing else. It was a butcher's tool, not a duellist's or a hero's. It was designed for murder and nothing else.

'This is Rome,' he said.



This chapter allows players to create Roman military characters. Player characters begin as seasoned legionary soldiers. There are a number of rank and pay grades within a Roman century, the most famous of which is the centurion, the commander of the unit as a whole. There are also a number of junior officers who assist the centurion, these positions are available to PCs later on if they receive promotion. All these positions are of equal status and PCs can try and achieve them in any order. Each provides a new skill and cash bonus and adds to the soldier's status. Once he has achieved all of the positions, he can attempt promotion to centurion! In a squad of veteran player character soldiers, brought together as a special team, it is likely that one or two of the group will hold the same position, this is acceptable, even though a century had only one of these officer's each. Assume the squad has been pulled from different centuries! Details of how to gain promotion is found in VI Actions & Encounters. All starting characters are seasoned soldiers with the rank of **legionary**.

Normally each player will create and run one character, but there may be times when this basic rule is ignored. Perhaps one of the players cannot make it to the



game and someone volunteers to run his character. Perhaps the adventure calls for an extra career type ... There are really no hard and fast rules. As long as the players feel comfortable with the characters that they are running, and can see the world through the eyes of their character (or characters). There are *eight main steps* to character creation, but each step is very simple and quick to resolve.

STEP 1	Attributes
STEP 2	Culture of Origin
STEP 3	Character Type
STEP 4	Social Class
STEP 5	Events
STEP 6	Allies & Enemies
STEP 7	Background Details
STEP 8	Money and Equipment

Step 1 - ATTRIBUTES

To create a character for the world of **43AD**, players need to determine the value of various attributes that describe him, his abilities, strengths and weaknesses. The primary attributes are MIGHT, FATE, HITS, CRAFT and LEARNING.

MIGHT:	A measure of strength, physical prowess, and fighting ability. Typically between 2 and 6.
FATE:	Luck and the will of the Gods. Fate is also a measure of the adventurer's inner power and is used for all manner of tasks, from spotting an ambush to holding your breath to sneaking past a guard. Typically between 2 and 6.
HITS:	The adventurer's toughness, endurance and bodily health. At 0 HITS he is dying. Typically between 12 and 22.
CRAFT:	A measure of the adventurer's ability to perform basic manual tasks, to repair or construct items and work as a craftsman. Initial score is 1.
LEARNING:	A measure of education, book learning and social skills such as persuasion and leadership. Initial score is 1.

Determine Attributes

In a game where players prefer a random generation, then they must roll 1d6 for MIGHT and FATE (always re-rolling a '1' result). HITS should be generated by rolling 2d6+10.

In a game where players prefer allocation of attributes, then allow the a pool of 12 creation points between MIGHT, FATE and HITS. The player should keep in mind that 2 is the lowest score possible for MIGHT and FATE and that 6 the highest. For this system he can set HITS at any number between 1 and 6. Finally, when his allocations are completed, the player must multiply his HITS allocation by 2 and then add 10. This new figure is his character's final HITS score. LEARNING and CRAFT begin at 1, but may change during later character creation.



Step 2 – CULTURAL ORIGINS

The Roman army recruited from across the empire. Members of the squad are almost as likely to come from Gaul as Rome. The recruit joined up when the unit was stationed in his province, or he was transferred to the new legion with a number of his comrades to replace casualties. A culture of origin provides the character with his native language, an idea about his general outlook and also some minor bonus, either a skill, or a modifier to one of his attributes. Later British recruits would resemble Gauls.

<i>2d6</i>	<i>Origin</i>	<i>Bonus</i>	<i>Language</i>
2, 3	German	War Cry	German
4	North African	+1 CRAFT	Latin
5	Greek	Turn A Profit	Greek
6	Gallic	+2 HITS	Celtic
7	Italian	+1 LEARNING	Latin
8	Hispanic	+2 HITS	Hispanic
9	Syrian	Killing Shot	Syrian
10	Illyrian	Streetwise	Illyrian
11	Anatolian	Mountain Travel	Greek
12	Egyptian	+1 FATE	Greek

Anatolian

Hardy mountaineers used to their own company and unused to the cosmopolitan riches of the lowland cities.

Egyptian

Native Egyptians are a down-trodden underclass that have been ruled and administered first by Greek invaders and now by Rome. They are an insular and haughty.

Gallic

These Celtic tribes are now part of the empire; its men, restless with the peace, join the legions in their search for

adventure and the glory of war. Gauls tell tall tales, boast and enjoy a good feast.

German

Most of Germany is wild and barbarous ('Free Germany') but some of the tribes were conquered and live in tribes at the mouth of the River Rhine. The Germans are a proud, fierce people, warlike and stubborn.

Greek

Greece is a civilised land of city-states. Greeks still retain their culture and sophistication, and go out into the world as sailors, traders and physicians. Greeks are canny merchants, always looking for a good deal.

Hispanic

Rich in resources, Hispania was conquered centuries ago. Hispanics are prosperous and well-thought of by Rome. Still, they retain the tough and pragmatic outlook of their Celtic forefathers.

Illyrian

Illyricum is a great spread of rugged provinces along the River Danube. Its people are tough, no nonsense types used to barbarian invasions. Illyrians in the legions stick together creating an Illyrian brotherhood.

Italian

Many Italian families have taken root in the provinces, families of legionary veterans, colonists, entrepreneurs and landowners. They are cultured, but can also be blunt, harsh and lacking compassion.

North African

The cities of North Africa are inhabited by the descendants of Carthaginians, redoubtable farmers, craftsmen and industrialists. A North African is optimistic, erudite and hard-working. He'll never give up.

Syrian

Syrians are the city-dwelling descendants of desert bedouin of a thousand years earlier. Tough, talkative and cunning, the Syrian blood-lines have mingled and merged with centuries of invaders and settlers.



Step 3 – CHARACTER TYPE

When all the player characters are soldiers in the same squad they often carry the same types of weapons, and perform the same roles in combat. What really differentiates the soldiers from one another is their personalities – the roles they play out within the small group. Players should select from, or roll on, the table here to determine their character type. Is he a coward, shirking the dangers? Is a wannabe hero who always steps up – no matter the peril, or is he a thief and a rogue. These labels are guidelines, the player is encouraged to have fun with them and on no account to take them too seriously. They are an aide to the imagination, not a straight-jacket!

2d6	Type	Bonus
2,3	Coward	Evade
4	Old Veteran	+1 MIGHT -4 HITS
5	Killer	Killing Blow
6	Practical Man	+1 CRAFT
7	Hero	+2 HITS
8	Rogue	Open Lock
9	Thinker	+1 LEARNING
10	Callous Survivor	Hard to Kill
11	New Recruit	+1 FATE
12	Entertainer	Acting

1d6	Class	Bonus
1	Landless Poor	Find Direction
2	Freed Slave	Silent Movement
3,4	Farmer/Labourer	Carry Burden
5	Craftsman	Evaluate
6	Noble	Seek Audience

Step 4 – SOCIAL CLASS

The character might come from any one of several social niches. Perhaps his father was a slave, perhaps he was a priest or maybe even a wealthy aristocrat! He may have been a shepherd, perhaps a hill or irrigation farmer, a craftsman or some city dweller. But whatever the details of

the character's origins, he has since joined the legions and become a soldier of Rome. A player may select a social class from the table below, or he may roll 1d to determine his origins randomly. The table provides an easily remembered origin for the character as well a bonus to his character provided by his family upbringing.

Step 5 – EVENTS

Every career in the legions is eventful. The player should roll four times to create meaningful and dramatic events for his character. Sometimes these events can be woven into a narrative, at other times they stand alone, each one an individual crisis or triumph. Event 1 is always rolled on the Reason For Joining Up table. Events 2, 3 and 4 are rolled on the Event Table, use a d100.

2d6	Reason for Joining Up
2	Escape failed love life
3	Escape bad debts
4	Escape a crushing family situation
5	Get one up on arrogant brother
6	It pays good steady money!
7	Make his parents proud of him
8	Punish himself
9	Earn money for his starving family
10	Father was a soldier
11	Family is always being pushed around by others
12	Find a soldier who committed crime against his family



<i>d100</i>	<i>Event</i>
1-3	A comrade takes the blame for your mistake and is stoned to death. Your comrades all know this.
4-6	You are beaten mercilessly for a mistake in the fort. Lose 1 HIT permanently.
7-9	You have a child with a woman in the vicus, daughter of a trader.
10-12	Your comrades protect you from the bullying of a veteran in another unit (gain enemy).
13-15	You make a good friend in the staff section, a clerk (beneficarius) and get a posting in the offices (+1 LEARNING)
16-18	You gain fame in the vicus, and the attentions of a girl, for a good deed.
19-21	A centurion in the next century has it in for you (gain an enemy).
22-24	You start an affair with another soldier's girl (roll FATE, 10+ to keep it secret).
25-27	Unit marches north to support a major campaign, gain an ally on that campaign.
28-30	Your unit takes its frustration out on a local tribe (gain an enemy).
31-33	You learn a trade at the fort, building, baking, or blacksmithing, etc. (+1 CRAFT)
34-36	A head wound leaves you with permanent damage, -1 HIT permanently.
37-39	A centurion in the legion is grateful for your help (gain a secret ally).
40-42	Local wisewoman curses you, -1 FATE permanently.
43-45	Severely injured in a skirmish, -2 HITS permanently.
46-48	Captured and tortured by tribes, endless nightmares follow.
49-51	You dishonour a local tribesman (gain an enemy).
52-54	Get involved in a gambling ring. Roll FATE on 10+; if you succeed then double your starting wealth, if you fail then halve it.
55-57	Get an opportunity to backstab a comrade in your century. If you go ahead then you can remove an enemy from your character sheet, if not, you gain an ally (your comrade).
58-60	You discover an opportunity to make money by abusing your position. Add 50 denarii to starting cash if you take that route.
61-63	Assigned to security for a local visiting official from the governor's staff.
64-66	Seconded to the governor's staff where you enjoy a year of good living, +1 LEARNING
67-69	Tax collection duties get you deeply involved in local tribal politics.
70-72	Suffer a severe bout of fever that seems to reoccur over the years.
73-75	Gain an ally in the legion, you did them a favour.
76-78	Your bribery gets you exempt from the worst jobs, and your comrades hate you for it.
79-81	You make extra money from your work, multiply starting cash by x1.5.
82-84	Accident at the fort. You are injured along with a few other men.
85-87	You spend all your free time in the vicus, make an ally there.
88-90	Your work is shoddy and gets someone killed, their friends resent you (gain an enemy).
91-92	You try to help a local clan or tribe that the legion is about to destroy, risking your reputation to help them. Is it worth it?
93-95	Your commander's mistake costs lives and the mission; if you report him gain double x1.5 your starting cash, if you do not, then sleep easy and gain your commander as an ally.
99-97	A conspiracy against the emperor tries to recruit you. If you accept, roll FATE on 10+ to remain above suspicion and gain +1 FATE. If you fail you are tortured during interrogation, lose 2 HITS permanently.
98-00	Imperial officer arrives to investigate rumours of treason at the fort, you give them lots of information on your rivals, and they suspect you.



Step 6 – ALLIES & ENEMIES

It is important that every character begins the game with relationships, good and bad. Firstly these tie that soldier into the world in a real way, and secondly they provide great plot hooks that the GM can use to bring a character closer to the action. Some allies and enemies will be generated through the Events table, but every player should also roll on the table here twice to create two more additional relationships, one ally and one enemy.

Roll once 2D6 on the table for an ally, and again for an enemy. The result indicates an NPC's occupation or role. If rolling for an enemy then roll another 2d6 to determine the origins of the animosity. These NPCs are active in the character's life and are part of his concerns as the game opens. It may be possible to create a narrative that involves a number of these NPCs, as well as any incidents which may arise from a roll on the Event Table (see Step 6, above).

<i>2d6</i>	<i>Nature of NPC</i>	<i>2d6</i>	<i>Origins of Animosity</i>
2,3	Soldier in the unit	2,3	Betrayed
4	Relative	4	Romantic rival
5	Junior officer	5	Old friend, now enemy
6	Centurion	6	Loss of face or honour
7	Member of another unit	7	Responsible for the death of a relative, friend or lover
8	Senior officer	8	Injured the other, or a member of his family
9	Local tribesman	9	They spread lies about you
10	Local merchant/trader	10	Spurned the other's offer of a job/partnership/deal etc.
11	Criminal/gangster in vicus/town	11	Caused other to be stripped of award or promotion
12	Woman in vicus	12	Clash of personality, background, methods, etc.

Step 7 – BACKGROUND DETAILS

There are a host of lesser details that can be created for a player character, details that really bring that character to 'life' in the imaginations of the players. Players needn't write reams of background history - a short paragraph should suffice, outlining the character's upbringing, his early career or life, the changes that affected him and the chain of events that gave him the previous experience selected by the player. Every character really needs some kind of background story. Where are they from? Why have they turned their backs on their old life to adventure in the big wide world?

Appearance

The appearance often becomes a visual description of the hero's past life or personality. To personalise a hero, think of a trademark 'look'; perhaps a scar, tall, short, blue eyes, crooked teeth, a cackling laugh, a whisperer, cracks his knuckles, wears rings, has a broken nose, stubble, a short pointy beard and so on and so on. Just one or two 'quirks' will keep an image of that character fresh inside of everyone's head ...Things to note, however, are that short-sleeved tunics without trousers are universal amongst Romans, although trousers and even long sleeved tunics are being adopted by soldiers who realise how damn cold Britannia can get!



Name

Naming is very easy. Keep things simple, give your legionary characters a single Latin name. A list is included in chapter XIII Play Aids.

Age

Player character legionaries are between 18 and 28 (2d6+16), while Old Veterans are between 34 and 44 (2d6+32).

Languages

Each language is rated as either 1 - Basic Understanding, or 2 - Fluency. Basic Understanding of a language implies a thick foreign (or local dialect) accent and recognition of only the most basic written words. Fluency implies a wide vocabulary, subtle and inferred speech, knowledge of myths and legends of the language, and (if it has a written form – which British does not) literature written in that language.

A character's LEARNING score indicates the points available to him to spend on additional languages. For example, a scribe with LEARNING 4 could select one language at Fluent (2 points) and two more at Basic (both 1 point each). All characters begin with their native language at a Basic (1) level, and must spend their first 1 point of LEARNING on gaining Basic Latin (1) as taught by, or picked up within, the legion.

Step 8 – WEALTH & EQUIPMENT

Starting Money

The soldier begins with 2d6 x 10 sestertii at the start of game. The fort's headquarters building can store any or all of this for him so that he carries around just what he needs. Modify this basic amount by any Event that states a change in starting cash is called for.

Wages

Roman soldiers were paid only three times a year. In **43AD**, however, soldiers are paid a wage by the Game Master after every mission or adventure. The value is small, and is usually supplemented by battlefield booty or taking bribes. Soldiers can spend it on wine and wenches, on new kit or on setting up some money making scheme (a popular activity!)

<i>Legionary wage</i>	<i>50 sestertii</i>
<i>Junior officer wage</i>	<i>80 sestertii (+20 sestertii for every additional position held)</i>

For example, a soldier who has been promoted twice, and has first held a position as actuarius and now as optio, has held two junior officer positions in total. Because of this he currently earns 100 sestertii after each mission. More information on promotion can be found in chapter VI Actions & Encounters.

Initial Equipment

All characters begin with the following basic bits of kit: ***Leather Satchel, Tunic, Trousers, Boots, Poor Cloak, Brooch, Waterskin, Pouch, Saucepan, Wooden Spoon, Military Belt.***

Kit Choices

Contrary to popular notions, Roman legionaries could kit themselves out with a variety of weapons. Many bows and spears are found alongside more traditional legionary weapons on excavations. The Player Character



should select one of the following Kit Choices (A, B, C or D) with which to equip his legionary. Of course the character can pick up or purchase other items, thus changing his kit later on in the game. This is a starting option.

A SPEARMAN

Dagger & Shortsword
Chainmail
Helmet
Spear
Flat Shield

C SKIRMISHER

Dagger & Shortsword
Chainmail
Helmet
3 x Javelins
Small Shield

B ASSAULT TROOPER

Dagger & Shortsword
Segmented Armour
Helmet
Pilum
Curved Shield

D ARCHER

Dagger & Shortsword
Chainmail
Helmet
Bow
Quiver & 12 arrows
Small Shield

Spending Money on Kit

Prior to the first game, a player might want to spend a few sestertii to further equip his soldier. Use the table below. When the PC accumulates more money and loot he may find the more detailed list in VI Actions & Encounters of greater use. This kit belongs to the soldier, no-one can take it away from him. If he just wants to borrow kit for a mission, then the GM should refer to the section entitled 'The Roman Military Unit' in chapter II. Included here also is a Replacement Weapons & Armour table. When weapons and armour need replacing, the quartermaster will provide new kit at a replacement cost of **one-tenth** the actual cost stated in the table. This is to prevent wastage or the abandoning of kit. If the soldier can't pay, he gets the replacement and the fee is deducted from his next wage (he gets paid after every mission/adventure). He will only get equipment replaced that is listed on his Kit Choice (above) replaced. If he wishes to buy new equipment not on his kit choice, he has to pay the full price! A soldier owns his own kit, and many scratch their names into it.

<i>General Items</i>	<i>Price</i>	<i>General Items</i>	<i>Price</i>
Oil Lamp	5 sestertii	Sling and Pouch of 10 Stones	3 asses
Wooden Bowl or Plate	2 sestertii	Bird Bone Whistle	2 asses
Wooden Spoon	1 sestertius	Fish-hooks and line	5 sestertii
Handaxe	40 sestertii	First Aid Kit	25 sestertii
Iron cook pot, small	45 sestertii	Bronze Ring	60 sestertii
Fishing net	35 sestertii	Bone Dice	1 sestertius
Wool Blanket	10 sestertii	Horn Cup	3 sestertii
Fire steel & flint	1 sestertius	Lantern, Glass & Bronze	100 sestertii
Leather Bag with Strap	20 sestertii	Wax Tablet & Wooden Stylus	20 sestertii
Pouch	2 sestertii	Leatherworking Kit	30 sestertii
Waterskin	10 sestertii	Spare Tunic	16 sestertii
Iron Canteen (for oil)	20 sestertii	Cloak, Average	40 sestertii
Knife, Small	20 sestertii		



<i>Replacement Weapons & Armour</i>	<i>Price @</i>	<i>Replacement Weapons & Armour</i>	<i>Price @</i>
Dagger	25 sestertii	Small Shield	60 sestertii
Shortsword	100 sestertii	Flat Shield	80 sestertii
Spear	30 sestertii	Curved Shield	200 sestertii
Javelin	20 sestertii	Helmet	120 sestertii
Pilum	125 sestertii	Greaves	200 sestertii
Sling	10 sestertii	Manica	400 sestertii
Bow	200 sestertii	Mail Armour	600 sestertii
Quiver (for 12 arrows)	4 sestertii	Mail Doubling	180 sestertii
12 Arrows	free [6 sestertii] #	Segmented Armour	800 sestertii
Quiver (for 5 javelins)	6 sestertii	Breastplate Armour (tribunes, legates, praetors only)	800 sestertii

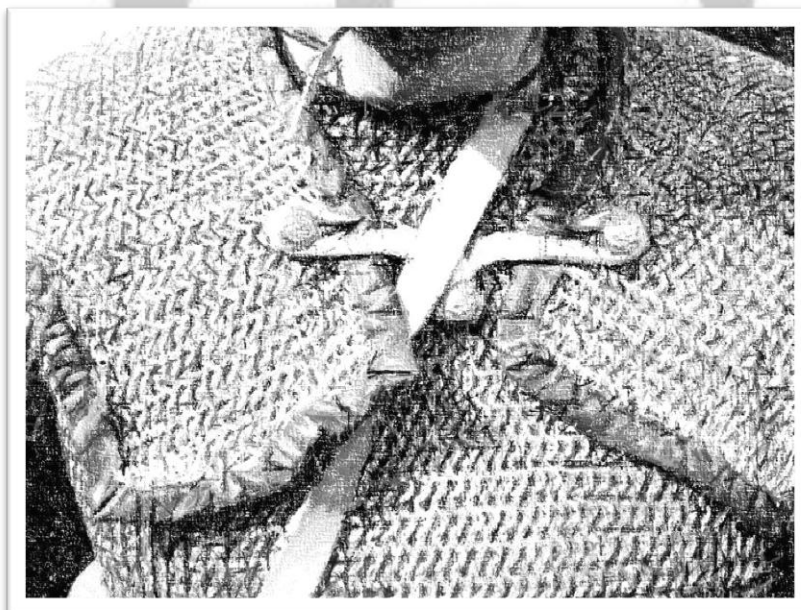
Arrows are provided free up to the maximum for the quiver; the **actual** cost of a quiver load is 12 sestertii.

@ These are full prices. To replace kit from the character's initial Kit Choice, pay only one-tenth of this.

Carrying Equipment

How much can a soldier carry? Players have a tendency to overload their characters, picking up equipment, loot, new weapons and so on without thought. The rule should be "carry what's valuable, ditch the rest". As a rule of thumb assume that a character can comfortably carry MIGHT + 8 items, this is his Load Capacity. An item is an object that can be held in one hand (like a dagger, quiver, helmet, scroll or a sword). Larger objects, often two-handed objects (such as spears, javelins, pila, shields, loaded satchels and bows) count as two items. Some items (pouches, hats etc.) are either too small, or counted as being worn. Armour is as heavy as its Armour Value (AV).

Being encumbered (ie. going over your MIGHT + 8 maximum) results in ***half marching speed and - 1 on all combat and physical actions***. No one may encumber themselves beyond MIGHT + 14 items. Those characters with Carry Burden skill get to double their MIGHT when calculating Load Capacity.





An Example of Character Creation

Step 1: We allocate the attribute twelve points in this way: MIGHT 3, FATE 5 and HITS 4. CRAFT and LEARNING always begin at 1. Before we continue, the HITS score is doubled and added to ten for a total of 18.

Step 2: Our character (who we will call Tiberius) turns out to be an Illyrian from the Danube provinces. He gains the skill Streetwise.

Step 3: It seems Tiberius is the real veteran of the group, an old timer with plenty of combat experience. He gains +1 MIGHT and -4 HITS. We adjust his MIGHT to 4 and his HITS to 14.

Step 4: Unremarkably Tiberius hails from a poor farming background. Like many soldiers he is used to humopping stuff around, he gains the skill Carry Burden. His Load Capacity increases from 12 to 16.

Step 5: We roll for Tiberius' life events. He has four rolls, the first on the Reason for Joining Up table, on which he rolls 5, 'Get one up on arrogant brother'. On the main table we roll 43, 55 and 2 and write down the following results: (43) Tiberius was severely injured early on in a skirmish, almost losing his left arm (and 2 HITS, reducing him to 12). He sports a massive scar from neck down to his armpit. (55) Tiberius found a way to backstab a comrade and so was able to be rid of an enemy from his character sheet (Step 6). Finally (2), someone takes the blame for a mistake of Tiberius and is stoned to death, everyone knows about it.

Step 6: Tiberius has an ally, the legion's CO, a man called Cassius Frontinius. Perhaps the centurions often point Cassius toward Tiberius as an old timer who knows more about the mood of the legion than anyone else. Our man also has an enemy, another legionary 'who was responsible for the death of a relative'.

Step 7: Here we put things together. Tiberius is 46 years old, and his enemy has been 'eliminated' by event number 55. Looking at the other events we can suggest that the old soldier first joined up to out-do his older brother in the same legion. At some point his brother was killed, perhaps another soldier killed him in a fight, or out of negligence...or cowardice. Tiberius vowed to be avenged and at some point arranged for this man to take the blame for something he didn't do, and face an execution squad. Tiberius is a patient, hard-working man and people don't mess with him. He is short and stocky, with a blank stare and unsmiling face. The scar on his neck turns red when he gets angry.

Step 8: Starting money is 80 sestertii. We roll a 1d6 for his kit choice, re-rolling a 5 or 6, and get a 1. Tiberius is often equipped as A (a spearman).

Finally Tiberius COMBAT is +7, his AV is 2 dice. He carries 10 'items', but could easily carry 6 more.

TIBERIUS						
MIGHT 4	FATE 5	CRAFT 1	LEARNING 1	HITS 12	COMBAT/AV	7/2
Legionary	Character: Old Veteran		Origins: Illyrian Farmer/Labourer			
Appearance: Short, stocky man with a blank stare and unsmiling face.					Sestertii: 80	
Background: Tiberius joined to compete with his brother. When his brother was killed due to the cowardice of a comrade Tiberius set him up and he was executed! He is an unsmiling ‘Rock’ around which the legion moves, he has seen centurions and commanders come and go. He rarely tells war stories. His blank expression says it all. Typical quote: “Don’t ever be the first, don’t ever be the last, and don’t ever volunteer to do anything”.						
Skills: Streetwise, Carry Burden						
Kit Choice: Dagger & Shortsword, Chainmail, Helmet, Spear, Flat Shield						



43 AD

LEGIONARY CHARACTER SHEET

NAME:		AGE:
CLASS:	ORIGINS:	
CHARACTER TYPE:		
RANK:	COLLEGIA:	

ATTRIBUTES

MIGHT	
FATE	
CRAFT	
LEARNING	

SKILLS

IMPROVEMENT POINTS:	

ALLIES ET ENEMIES

ARMOUR

ARMOUR RATINGS:
AV:

COMBAT

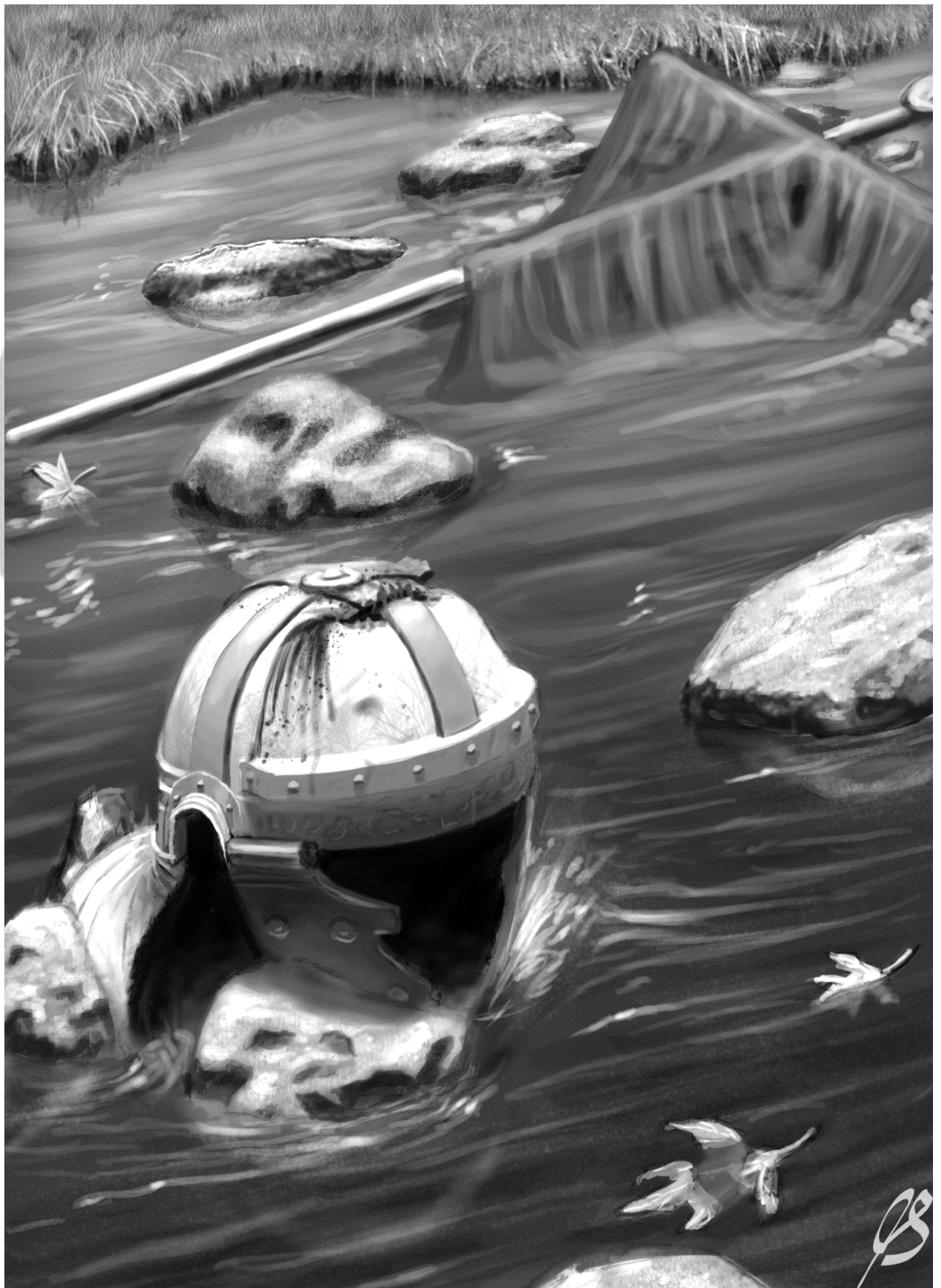
COMBAT
GLORY
HITS

SESTERTII

EVENTS ET NOTES

WEAPONS ET EQUIPMENT

XLII AD



IV INSIDE THE LEGIONS

Ahead of Rufus stretched the Mons Graupius, scattered with dark heather. Rufus steadied his horse at the sound of distant thunder. In his hand was the report that Rufus himself had taken from the hands of a dead scout that morning.

'Sir?' asked the young soldier by Rufus' side.

'If even half what that poor crazed bastard saw is true,' said Rufus, 'then beyond those hills is no place for a Roman. Not even a man of the Twentieth.'

'So... we're turning back?' There was no disguising the hope in the soldier's voice. After the battles that had brought them this far and the tales of what lay ahead, many men were poised to throw aside their shield and flee south.

'How many lives have we spent to reach these hills?' said Rufus. 'And how many promises has Agricola made to Rome that the Caledonians would kneel? No, I cannot go back empty-handed.'

'But sir, the men will not follow you. To the end of creation, yes, but not beyond the Mons Graupius...'

'Go to Agricola,' said Rufus. 'Tell him the Twentieth will go no further. If he argues, show him this.' Rufus handed the scout's report to the soldier. It was still dark with blood.

'And you, sir?'

'I am an old man,' said Rufus, 'and I will be no great loss. Besides, falling on one's sword is rather unoriginal, don't you

Right - Invasion-period legionary (40-60AD) with crossed belts, early pattern helmet and chainmail with reinforced shoulder doubling. Segmentata armour was also in use at this time. From around 50AD onwards daggers were hung from a single belt, swords were instead hung from baldrics.





think?' Rufus spurred his horse, and rode towards the purple-black horizon. The young soldier watched him go, but Rufus did not look back. He rode on, to his doom, at the place where the civilisation ended and the tortures of Tartarus began.

The Roman army is a sophisticated, well organised and well ordered military machine developed over many centuries of warfare. It has adapted the tactics, weaponry and armour of its foes to suit its own ends - this is not a rigid, inflexible army. Over twenty legions guard the frontiers of the Roman empire, and they are concentrated where the fighting is expected to be fiercest. It takes a lot of effort to raise a new legion, and so when the expedition to Britain was proposed, the legions that would do the conquering had to come from the German frontier.

THE ROMAN WAR MACHINE

Each **legion** is proud of its history and contemptuous of others. It is a self-contained military unit that has medical staff, cavalry, artillery, tools, tents, supply officers, transport and enough men to crack open a town or fight a pitched battle. Including the horsemen, a legion numbers around 5,500 men.

The Command

The legion is commanded by a legate, a senator from Rome in his 30s who is obliged to take the job as one step on his political career. He has an entire ladder of posts that he must take as he climbs the ladder. His second-in-command is a senior tribune (*tribunus laticlavus*), also of senatorial rank, but much younger, and at the start of his political career. Some of these posts are military, most were civil, such as treasury officials, or at the highest levels, provincial governors. This means there are no 'career generals', at best only talented part-timers. A good legate listens to his centurions! There are five other tribunes (junior tribunes, or *tribuni angusticlavii*) assisting the legate as staff officers, all recruited from the wealthy equestrian class of Rome.

Each legion's command unit comprises, not just the aristocratic legate and his well-heeled and eager to please tribunes, but also the camp prefect (a veteran centurion and the legion's quartermaster, responsible for transport, supply and equipment). After the legate and the senior tribune, the camp prefect (perhaps 50 or 60 years old) is the legion's third in command. Next in the chain of command is the *primus pilus*, the most experienced of the command centurions who leads the first century of the first cohort. These were the regimental sergeant-majors of their day.

The Organisation

How is the legion organised? Each legion is divided into ten **cohorts**, these are units of around five hundred men that move as one on the battle field. In turn these cohorts are divided into six **centuries** each of 80 legionaries and commanded by a centurion. Away from the battlefield, these centuries are very flexible and capable of all kinds of tasks, much like a modern army company. Centurions often rise up through the ranks and are tough and hard-bitten veterans, while others are the young sons of wealthy Roman equestrians, untried and inexperienced.

The centurion commands a unit of 80 men, although the first cohort is given a position of honour and its centuries are double strength (160 men instead of 80). This first cohort contains the veteran fighters, the elite of the legion.

Every centurion has a second-in-command, an *optio*, who carries out his orders. Assisting the *optio* is the *tesserarius*, who acts like a junior NCO, organising the legionaries for their daily routines, handing out



passwords and checking the sentries. The men work, live and fight together in 'tent parties' (**contubernia**) of 8 men. One of these is given the job of squad leader by the tesserarius, he makes sure his squad gets its jobs finished on time!

Most legions include a unit of cavalry (*equites legionis*) that carry out scouting, courier duties and battlefield attacks. It is 120 men strong. The legate has an administrative staff (the *beneficarii*) and to staff it he recruits those men in the ranks who can read and write Latin. Legions also include artillery pieces (stone-throwing catapults and bolt-shooting ballista) that are carried on carts and deployed by troops to support attacks, or to repel attacks on their camps.

There are also various junior officers that serve the legion, and who were promoted from the ranks. Ordinary soldiers aspire to these positions, particularly because they get one out of all the unpleasant duties such as gate-guard and latrine-cleaner!

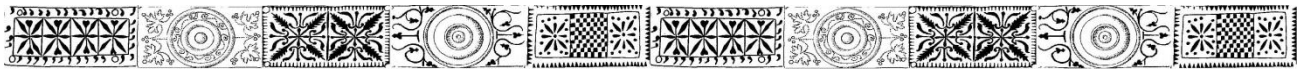
The legion is completely self-sufficient. In the field its men can harvest grain in enemy territory and 'forage' (pillage enemy houses and farms for food), they can dig and fortify a temporary marching camp in a day, and are quite capable of building much more substantial timber fortifications. Given the proper tools and time, the legion can even construct impressive stone structures - from roads to bridges, walls, forts and watch-towers. Throughout the legion there are talented officers and men skilled in surveying, engineering, medicine, stonemasonry, carpentry, iron-working and so on. On the move the legion is an invading army, settled and in garrison it is an occupying force, with centurions in remote posts dispensing justice, and legionaries serving as policemen. When confronted with an enemy, the Roman legion often simply digs its way to victory, erecting fortifications, vast earthworks and siege mines. It can fell timber and build battering rams, siege towers and scaling ladders when the situation calls for it. At Alesia, when fighting the Gallic King Vercengetorix (52 BC), the legions commanded by Julius Caesar surrounded the huge hill with fortifications to face the besieged Gauls. When news came of Gallic reinforcements on their way, they then built another ring of fortified earthworks, this time facing outwards. In total the legions erected 39 km of fortifications in order to besiege Alesia. The wood-axe and mattock are as crucial to Roman warfare as the gladius and pilum!

The Auxiliaries

Legions often have auxiliary units attached to them. An auxiliary unit is typically a single cohort (around 500 men) of native warriors recruited from one of the frontier provinces. It isn't just foot-soldiers that the auxiliary provide. Since the Romans have little skill in cavalry, entire units of native auxiliaries provide the Roman army with horsemen. They are not citizens and upon retirement after 25 years will be granted Roman citizenship - a great boon! A cohort's title indicates the original province or tribe of recruitment, the Second Batavians were recruited from the Batavi tribe, for example. Auxiliary troops are often used in static garrisons in occupied territory, but also accompany legions on campaign, acting as a patrolling or screening force and also fighting in the battle line. They are equipped in a slightly different manner to the legionaries, but still consider themselves Romanised, with adopted Latin names, adopted Roman culture and every bit as tough, disciplined and well-trained as the legions.

Many auxiliary units are cohorts of about 500 men (called **quingeniary cohorts**), that are commanded by a prefect, either a noble of the tribe, given citizenship especially for the purpose, or a Roman equestrian. They still have centuries and centurions, just like the legions. Some units are double strength (**milliary cohorts**), around 1,000 men commanded by a tribune. The cavalry use different terminology, calling their units *alae* (wings) instead of cohorts. A **quingeniary wing** consists of 16 troops (*turmae*) of 32 men. A double-strength **milliary wing** fields 32 *turmae*. Every *turmae* is commanded by a decurion, rather than a centurion.

Just to complicate matters, some auxiliary units are designated *cohors equitata*, they mix infantry and cavalry together to create a fast-moving mobile force. These cohorts probably field 500 infantrymen, and then either 120 or 240 cavalrymen, depending on whether the *cohors equitata* is a *quingeniary* or *milliary* unit.



The Arms and Armour

Roman military equipment is fairly standardised, but since it is handed down from one man to the next, and bought back from legionary widows, a lot of older equipment is used alongside newer kit. When a new style of helmet or armour is introduced, many soldiers continue to use an older pattern. Keep this in mind when equipping a Roman squad, very little is 'uniform'.



Let us begin with clothing. Soldiers wear extremely large and baggy tunics, either T-shaped or square, bunched at the waist with a military belt (*cingulum*). This is leather, covered with decorated square plates. Civilians universally wear simple leather or embroidered cloth ties around their waists, the chunky, metal-covered military belt marks out a man as a soldier, whether on the parade ground or in a public latrine out of armour and without his weapons. With the heavy belt goes a swagger and sneer that civilians recognise and avoid! Tunic colours start arguments amongst historians! They were probably dull red, the colour of Mars, the Roman god of war. White tunics are kept in kit-bags for ceremony, triumphal marches, religious services and parade ground pay-days.

The famous legionary *caligae*, the heavy Roman sandals, were worn by the invasion forces, but within a generation they had adopted Northern-style enclosed boots (*calcei*). Trousers also quickly came into fashion, along with socks and (in the winter) long-sleeved British tunics!

Of course, cloaks are universal - everyone wears a cloak, even indoors. Two types are common, the military *sagum*, a brown rectangular cloak that doubles as a blanket on campaign, and the *cucullus* which is semi-circular and hooded. It can be flipped back like a poncho to reveal a soldier's *gladius* at the ready ...

Tooled up for war the soldier wears a jingling belt of leather straps with metal terminals, this dangles between the legs, gives moral support, but is essentially there to make a noise on the march, and in the street. How else will the stinking Brits know when to get out of the way?



Underneath the belt is armour; typically a shirt of chainmail (*lorica hamata*), or bronze scale (*lorica plumata*) or a cuirass of *lorica segmentata*, which is made up of strips of iron plate armour that curve around the body. All armour requires the wearing of a padded shirt (*subarmalis*) beneath to cushion incoming blows. Often these padded shirts have fringes at the waist and shoulders which help to ward off blows.

On his head the legionary wears an iron or bronze helmet, the auxiliary typically wears a cheaper bronze helmet. These have generous cheek-guards, wide neck-guards and brow-band that stops an opponent's sword slipping down into the face. It can be fitted with a horse-hair or feather crest during parades, or when going into big battles.

The sword of the Roman soldier is the *gladius*, a stabbing short-sword carried in a highly decorated scabbard. It is slung on a baldric and hangs on the soldier's right hip. He is taught to stab into the body of the enemy with the *gladius*, and not to thrash it around with slashes and parries. He has a dagger (*pugio*) slung from his military belt on his left hip, and this is used as a battlefield back-up. The cavalry trooper wears a long sword (*spatha*) with which he is able to reach infantry opponents as he rides them down.

Legionary soldiers carry a shield (*scutum*) into combat, and the shape and size varies. Some are the tall, rectangular, curved shields seen so often in movies, others are large ovals or tall hexagonal shields. Standard-bearers carried small circular shields as a last-ditch defence. It's possible all these shield types were used in the same unit! The auxiliaries use only the oval shields. Every shield is constructed of plywood, with a metal boss, and a bronze edging that stops the shield splitting. Each legion has its own colours and designs.

Centurions seem not to have worn *lorica segmentata* at all, perhaps due to tradition, and perhaps also to the fact that they like to wear their awards (*torcs* and *phalerae*) on leather straps over their armour. A centurion wears his *gladius* on his left hip rather than his right, and he often wears leg armour (*greaves*) which the regular soldiers did not wear as often in the 1st century AD. Finally, it seems that the centurion wore his crest 'transversely', that is from ear-to-ear, which would certainly have made him stand out on the battle-line.

When the legionary fights, he fights with his *gladius*, but before the battle-lines meet, he throws two heavy javelins to break up the opposing line. These are the *pila* (singular, *pilum*) formed of a wooden shaft around shoulder height, topped by a thin two foot metal shank that ended with an armour piercing point. These *pila* are heavy and crash down either into the enemy with devastating results, or into and through his shield. The thin shank bends and the javelin cannot be pulled from the shield. He has to abandon the shield and fight without it.

The auxiliary soldiers do not use the *pilum*, but the *hasta*, the short stabbing spear. Those on horseback use the *hasta* as well as light javelins, which can be thrown one after another as the cavalryman races past his target.

Do not mistake the *gladius* and *pilum* for super-weapons, however. There are many accounts of Roman legionaries being beaten in combat, being massacred, or running away. Yes, they were disciplined and well-trained, but disciplined and trained men can still cry with fear, refuse to fight and run like cowards into the woods. It's just that the legionaries did it less often than most ancient soldiers!



A CAREER

Suitable recruits should be levied with great care by great men.

Vegetius

The minimum age for recruits is 17, and men are preferred who have experience of manual labour, or of a trade. The legions accept only Roman citizens, and that means they come from the urbanised areas of the empire. In Britain, the sons of soldiers are citizens and can follow their fathers into the legion, but other Roman citizens may have come to Britain, and in turn their sons are eligible. The auxiliary units recruit any suitable non-citizen - that is most people in a conquered province, or even a defeated tribe.

The recruit can look forward to a 25 year career, followed by retirement with land taken from defeated tribes and some money with which to set up a farm. Auxiliaries will gain Roman citizenship and perhaps a payment. In a world of poverty, of course, a Roman soldier is well paid, well accommodated, well fed and receives the world's best medical care.

Quickly he will want to try and improve his lot by gaining the status of **immunis**, gaining some skill that means he will not have to do guard duty, clean latrines or ditches. One man in the squad will be the squad leader (**caput contubernium**), but this doesn't provide any extra pay, and the role may have changed frequently, either on a rota, or as the **tesserarius** sees fit. This junior officer is something like a corporal, giving out passwords, dictating daily routine and relaying the orders of the centurion to the ten squads.

Another important rank is **signifer**. This man carries the century's standard in combat. He wears an animal skin from the back of his helmet and a small round shield slung around his shoulder. He is the century's accountant, handing out pay and taking out deductions (for the burial club, for the Saturnalia feast, and for any replacement equipment, clothes and even food).

The centurion's staff of three, also includes the **optio**, a position of great importance. The optio is the centurion's deputy, studying under him and able to take over command of the century should the centurion be wounded. Optios often bring up the rear of a battle formation, pushing men on, and in the fort are responsible for training and discipline. In this way he resembles the British Army's company sergeant major. The optio may have worn a distinctive ring and a unique crest.

If a legionary seeks further promotion, it will be either as the legion's eagle-bearer (**aquilifer**), or the image-bearer (**imaginifer**). Every legion has a gold eagle figure that forms its heart. Soldiers will follow the eagle anywhere, and ignominy will befall any legion that loses it. The imaginifer carries an image of the emperor. Both standard bearers wear animal skins over their helmets, either a bear, lion or wolf. These two men also assist the legate during religious ceremonies.

Anyone who can read and write might instead find himself promoted as an **actuarius**, a military scribe on the administrative staff. A legion needs a huge amount of record-keeping to function, and these clerks are assigned to different officers depending on their rank within the admin section. Some assist the tribunes, some the camp prefect, some the legate himself, others are seconded to the governor's residence at Londinium or Eboracum. Beneficarii are also record keepers, but they are seconded to customs posts, guard stations, road-houses and important places such as bridges or markets. A **beneficarius** is the closest Roman Britain has to a police officer. Although they do not routinely investigate crimes, they do mix with the population and try to ensure compliance with taxes, customs and local regulations. Beneficarii on official duties carry ceremonial, decorated spears.



The great goal of any soldier is to reach the rank of **centurion**. Some centurions are young equestrians from Rome, but many were grizzled legionaries who had joined as raw recruit years earlier. The centurion earns far more than his own men. He enjoys a far higher status and has his own suite of rooms in the fort, at the end of his men's barrack block. He can afford servants and has the close companionship of junior officers such as the tesserarius, signifer and optio, who all work with him. Centurions may have worn a transverse crest on their helmets but their belt, scabbards and helmet would all be silver-plated to show off their wealth. The equivalent modern rank would be a captain in command of an army company.

Centurions themselves are ranked according to seniority, and a new centurion might find himself in command of a less distinguished century. He might try to gain command of a more prestigious century, perhaps the best in the cohort, and then one of the centuries within the prestigious first cohort. The centurions who command these double-strength centuries were known as 'primi ordines', and are well-paid and experienced. Beyond rank this the veteran centurion may be given the exalted status of equestrian, and can now apply for the command of a cavalry ala! As an equestrian he is now free to follow the career path of these aristocrats ...

Auxiliary soldiers follow much the same career path, although it ends at centurion, and those centurions can never become equestrians. The rank of aquilifer or imaginifer is the cohort signifer, carrying the cohort's unique emblems at the head of the column.

FORTS

Roman forts are not defensive castles, but base areas from where the soldiers can move out to attack and fight on open ground. Auxiliary forts are established along roads, generally a day's march apart (20 miles) so they can support one another. Forts are usually of playing card shape, varying in size depending on the size of their garrison. A legionary fort is called a 'fortress' and is huge, around 500m long and built to house 5,500 men. The smaller forts might house a vexillation (detachment of legionaries), or a single auxiliary cohort or cavalry wing.

All forts are built to the same plan (see page 142). The fort has a fortified **gateway** in each wall, and these are connected by two long cross-roads. At the centre, where they meet is the principia (**headquarters building**). This building has offices around a courtyard, and at the back a long hall where the commander can address troops or officers. Off the hall are two offices and a shrine for the unit's standards. Below the shrine is a cellar housing all the money boxes of the unit. This is guarded day and night by a signifer and bodyguard.

Next to the headquarters building is the **commander's house** (praetorium). In a legionary fortress this is a huge villa with many rooms, mosaics, under-floor heating and courtyard. In a smaller auxiliary fort it is a nicely furnished courtyarded building with perhaps one heated room. Grouped along the shorter road crossing a legionary fort are the **houses of the tribunes**, the **baths** and the **hospital**. Auxiliary forts usually do not have these buildings. In the centre of the fort is the garrison's food supply that is housed in long **granaries**, raised off the ground to prevent damp. The men sleep in long barrack blocks, one to every century, and these are usually located at the long ends of the rectangular fort. The layout is ordered and well-planned. Some of these long blocks may instead serve as **stables** if the fort has a cavalry garrison. Along the inner walls of the fort there might be found bread ovens and workshops (fabrica).

Player-character soldiers will be very familiar with their **barracks**! Each block is built to house 80 men and consists of a long, narrow range of rooms that end in a suite of rooms for the centurion and his family. This arrangement mimics the layout of the legion's tents whilst on campaign. Each squad would erect its tent in line with all the others of the unit, the centurion had his tent pitched at the end of that line. Inside the fort the



same arrangement is followed, except that instead of a tent each squad of 8 men is allocated a pair of rooms, one behind the other and linked by a doorway. The front room opens out onto a colonnade and usually faces another barrack block across the street. This front room seems to have been used as an equipment store and perhaps a common room. Sleeping quarters were in the back room. The rooms are very small, a little over 2m square, and bunk beds were probably used to cram all the men into this room.

Fort defences consist of artillery platforms at the corner towers, and three or four lines of 6-foot deep, V-shaped ditches in front of the fort walls. The **walls** are around 15 feet high, with corner towers, gate-towers, and a guard towers along each stretch of wall. Sometimes the area in front of the **ditches** is dug with concealed pit-traps (known to the soldiers as 'lilies'). Each lily is filled with sharpened stakes - but their surprise value is only of use when the fort is first constructed, and especially on the edge (or within) enemy territory. Forts in more settled areas will fill lilies in.

The walls of a fort are initially formed by an earthen rampart, covered with turfs and then fronted by the ditches. Its towers and all of the buildings are of timber. When forts are rebuilt, and most were in Britain around 100 AD, they are rebuilt in stone, with a stone wall.

Lastly, the fort will very quickly gain a small village (**vicus**) outside its main gates. Here dwell the soldiers' girlfriends and families, traders, butchers, wine-sellers, bronze-casters, potters, courtesans and so on. It is a place of hangers on, eager to part the legionary or auxiliary from his wages! The vicus might include an inn, a public bath house, a market, food-stalls and plenty of craft-stores (cobbler, leatherworkers, carpenters, tailors, etc.) all providing goods and services for the troops. Off duty soldiers can eat a meal, spend time with a woman, drink and gamble, maybe have alterations made to their belt decorations, buy a new pair of boots and then spend some time in the baths. That's what wages are for!

THE NORTHERN WALLS

The emperors Hadrian and Antoninus Pius both had great fortifications built across the north of Britain to protect the province from Caledonian attacks. These walls were complex military systems, concentrations of force ready to attack or defend as needed. After 122 AD, any important military activity in the north of Britain will likely involve one of the walls and its garrisons.

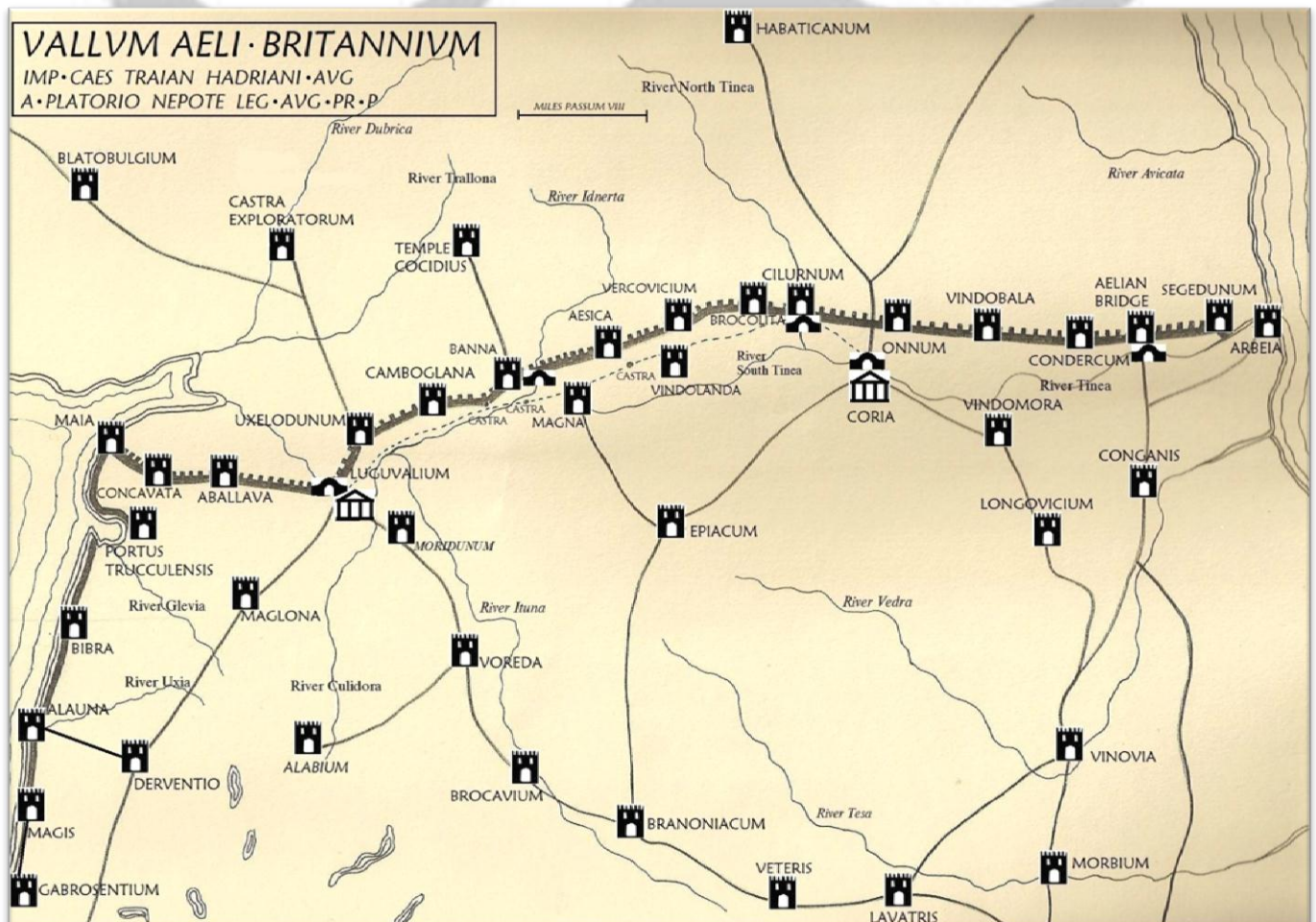
Hadrian's Wall (Vallum Aeli)

Hadrian's Wall may have been called Vallum Aeli ('Hadrian's Frontier', since Aeli was Hadrian's family name). Detachments from the legions came north to begin the construction of Hadrian's Wall and its forts in 122 AD, finishing it perhaps eight years later. The Wall is 74 miles long, stretching from the mouth of the Tyne westwards to the Solway Firth. The Wall stands 15 feet high and is 8 feet thick. There are mile-castles at regular intervals each of which include a defended gateway through the Wall. These small forts only hold garrisons of 16 men, and they check any civilian traffic through the gates. Two turrets were constructed in between the mile castles, used for observation and accommodation. A 10-foot deep ditch runs in front of the Wall, except where it has been built on the edge of cliffs - making any attempt by Caledonian spies to infiltrate the province difficult!

The following forts were established for the garrison of the Wall, most were actually physically attached to the Wall, allowing troops to march north into hostile territory, or walk out along the Wall rampart.

Forts on Vallum Aeli

<i>Fort Name</i>	<i>Modern Name</i>	<i>Hadrian's Garrison</i>
Segedunum	Wallsend	Second Cohort of Nervians
Pons Aelius	Newcastle	First Ulpian Cohort of Cugenri
Condercum	Benwell	First Cohort of Vangiones (split)
Onnum	Halton Chesters	unknown
Vindobala	Rudchester	unknown
Cilurnum	Chesters	First Cohort of Vangiones (split)
Brocolita	Carrawburgh	First Cohort of Aquitani
Vercovicium	Houseteads	First Cohort of Tungrians (split)
Aesica	Great Chesters	Sixth Cohort of Nervians
Magnis	Carvoran	Second Cohort of Dalmatians
Camboglana	Birdoswald	First Cohort of Tungrians (split)
Banna	Castlesteads	First Cohort of Batavians
Uxelodunum	Stanwix	August Petrian Wing of Gauls
Aballava	Burgh-by-Sands	The First Tungrian Wing
Congavata	Drumburgh	Second Cohort of Lingones
Maia	Bowness	unknown





Uxelodunum (modern Stanwix), at the western end, is the largest of the Wall forts and serves as the headquarters of the military complex. All the fort commanders report to Stanwix. Behind the Wall runs a military road, from coast to coast linking together all of the forts. To protect the road and the garrisons from rebel attacks from the south (Brigantian territory) a huge defensive ditch called the Vallum was dug. It is twenty feet across and ten feet deep, with six feet high ramparts on either side. The area between the Wall and the Vallum is a military-only zone, where troops can camp in safety, muster and march without fear of attack.

After 140 AD, parts of the Vallum were in-filled to allow more easy access through the mile castle gateways, and so the forts began to grow civilian settlements. There are so many settlements, and mile castles that civilian habitation has spread from one to the next, filling the military zone with bars, houses, inns and shops.

But the Wall itself is not more wonderful than the town behind it. Long ago there were great ramparts and ditches on the South side, and no one was allowed to build there. Now the ramparts are partly pulled down and built over, from end to end of the Wall; making a thin town eighty miles long. Think of it! One roaring, rioting, cock-fighting, wolf-baiting, horse-racing town, from Ituna on the West to Segedunum on the cold eastern beach! On one side heather, woods and ruins where Picts hide, and on the other, a vast town - long like a snake, and wicked like a snake. Yes, a snake basking beside a warm wall!

Rudyard Kipling, Puck of Pook's Hill

Antonine Wall (Vallum Aureli)

Hadrian's successor, Antoninus Pius, had his own frontier defence for Britain. The Vallum Aeli was decommissioned and a new wall, stretching from the Firth of Forth to the Firth of Clyde was constructed. It is possible that this new wall was called Vallum Aureli, after Antoninus' family name. The wall was an earthen rampart covered with turfs, with a massive ditch to the north of it, and all of the garrison forts were built from timber. There are no mile castles or turrets on the Vallum Aureli and the forts are located much closer together than on Hadrian's Wall. Some of the forts are quite small, and units garrisoning the wall have to be split up from their fellows. This new wall is not a customs post, it was designed to bottle the Caledonian tribes up where they can do no harm. With a Brigantian rebellion in 154 AD, however, the Vallum Aureli was abandoned and garrisons returned to Hadrian's Wall by 162 AD. Antoninus' wall and its garrison forts quickly became overgrown and weed-choked.

There are nineteen forts on the Vallum Aureli, though there is no clear record of their names in the Roman period. Veluniate (modern Carriden) is the headquarters of the garrisons on the fort, and is the most easterly point on the Wall. It has a vicus outside the south gate.

A SOLDIER'S LIFE

...the misery continued; there were still the ramparts to be built and the material for building them to be collected. The proper tools for digging and for cutting turf had been ... lost. There were no tents for the troops, no medication for the wounded. While the survivors shared out the mud-splashed blood-stained rations, the whole camp was filled with lamentation throughout that dreadful night, and all waited for the coming day to bring death to thousands more.

Tacitus, Annals

In Barracks

A squad of soldiers live together in their two rooms of the barrack block. Someone has been nominated as a squad leader (perhaps on rotation) and keeps everyone moving, and someone cooks for the group outside under the veranda. Someone will be detailed to grind wheat, make dough and take it to the fort ovens for



baking. Someone else will have the morning water-collection duty. People are coming and going all the time, working in the workshops or at the headquarters building, for the centurion or on guard duty. In the evening all the squads eat their meals under the veranda, perhaps chatting to neighbouring squads or the century over the street. New recruits train at the post or javelin targets all day; whilst those with a bit more experience get the afternoons off for other less monotonous activities.

In the Field

When the legion or cohort or century is on the march, armour is usually worn. Helmets can be slung on a cord over the shoulder, as can the shield. Equipment is hung from the T-stick (furca). Troops are trained to endure 20-mile marches in a day, fully loaded with equipment and armour. Whilst the men march, concentrating on keeping in step and staying upright, light troops, perhaps auxiliaries without kit to carry, will be checking for ambushes. Cavalry, if available, will also move ahead of the column and along the flanks.

Each night the unit stops and makes camp. Uniquely, it actually digs entrenchments every night (if in unfriendly territory - and most of northern Britain is unfriendly to Romans!). Still in armour, the squad shares out the construction tools carried by a squad mule, and gets to work digging its portion of the ditch, piling up soil on the inside to make a rampart, then covering it with the square turfs they cut before digging began. Three double-ended stakes are carried by the mule and these are lashed together to form almost a wooden tank-trap, that sits on the outer rampart, with points facing outward.

In the fading daylight one squad member lights a fire and cooks for his mess-mates, the others settle the mule and then pitch the squad's goat-skin tent. It will have been a hard day - but these are hard men.

The optio has told all the squads where to pitch their tents, in line with the rest of the century - the centurion's tent is at the end. Of course the squads will be pitching that tent too! It is larger than the squad tents, and will be shared by the centurion, his optio, signifer and tesserarius.

At dawn the tents are packed and breakfast eaten (cooked if time, cold rations if not). Equipment is checked and the fortifications dismantled and perhaps filled in (what a waste of effort, think the legionaries!). All of these stages are signalled by trumpet call, and little is left to personal choice. The camp is the fort - in miniature.

If there is combat and there are wounded, a tent may be on hand to serve as a field hospital. There the legion's surgeon will deal with those injuries that look survivable. He will have medics on hand to assist, and to triage the arrivals. An actuarius will be noting the identity, rank and century of each arrival on a wax tablet. Roman soldiers wore a lead dog tag and so identification will not be a problem!

Discipline

Discipline is severe. This is why the army so well-drilled and determined. Fear of discipline is often as great as or greater than the fear of the enemy! Every centurion carries a stick (vitis) with which he could beat legionaries. One famous centurion on the Rhine frontier was nick-named 'Bring-Me-Another' because of the number of sticks he broke during beatings. Beatings, floggings, fines and assignment to unsavoury duties are other ways men that can be punished.

Soldiers who fall asleep on guard duty can be executed, usually by stoning or being clubbed to death by their own men. Those who flee from battle might be executed by crucifixion, and if a unit flees the field it can be punished by decimation. This involves one in ten of the entire unit facing summary execution, the rest are



forced to set up their tents *outside* of the marching camp's ramparts. Execution needs the sanction of a senior officer.

Humiliation works almost as well. A unit might be issued with barley taken from the horses rations instead of good quality wheat. It's men could also be ordered to stand to attention outside the commander's tent wearing only their slack, unbelted tunics. The belt is the symbol of a soldier - to be seen without it reduces him to the status of a common man or a slave. Since discipline is so severe, there are many desertions in the Roman army and those men who run away two or three times, face execution.

ROMAN MILITARY KIT

For battle, the Roman soldier typically wears full armour and a helmet, carries a shield, sword, spear (or two pila if a legionary), a cloak, a pouch for money, a dagger, and a bag of some kind to carry a little food (and to store any booty picked up on the battlefield). The aim is to take everything for war - and nothing else except a bite to eat.

For a short patrol or more ill defined mission, the soldier would sling the helmet on a cord around his shoulders, and might take only one pilum, or a clutch of light javelins instead. He may also pick a smaller, more mobile shield (round, oval or hexagonal) than the curved and rectangular scutum. He would take a kit bag (loculus) with him, carrying more rations and extra equipment, such as a fire lighting kit, string, camp knife, wood axe etc. He aims to be able to survive away from the fort for 2-3 days. He either intends to sleep rough, using his cloak as a blanket, or two men together can share a rectangle of sewn goatskin set up as an improvised shelter.

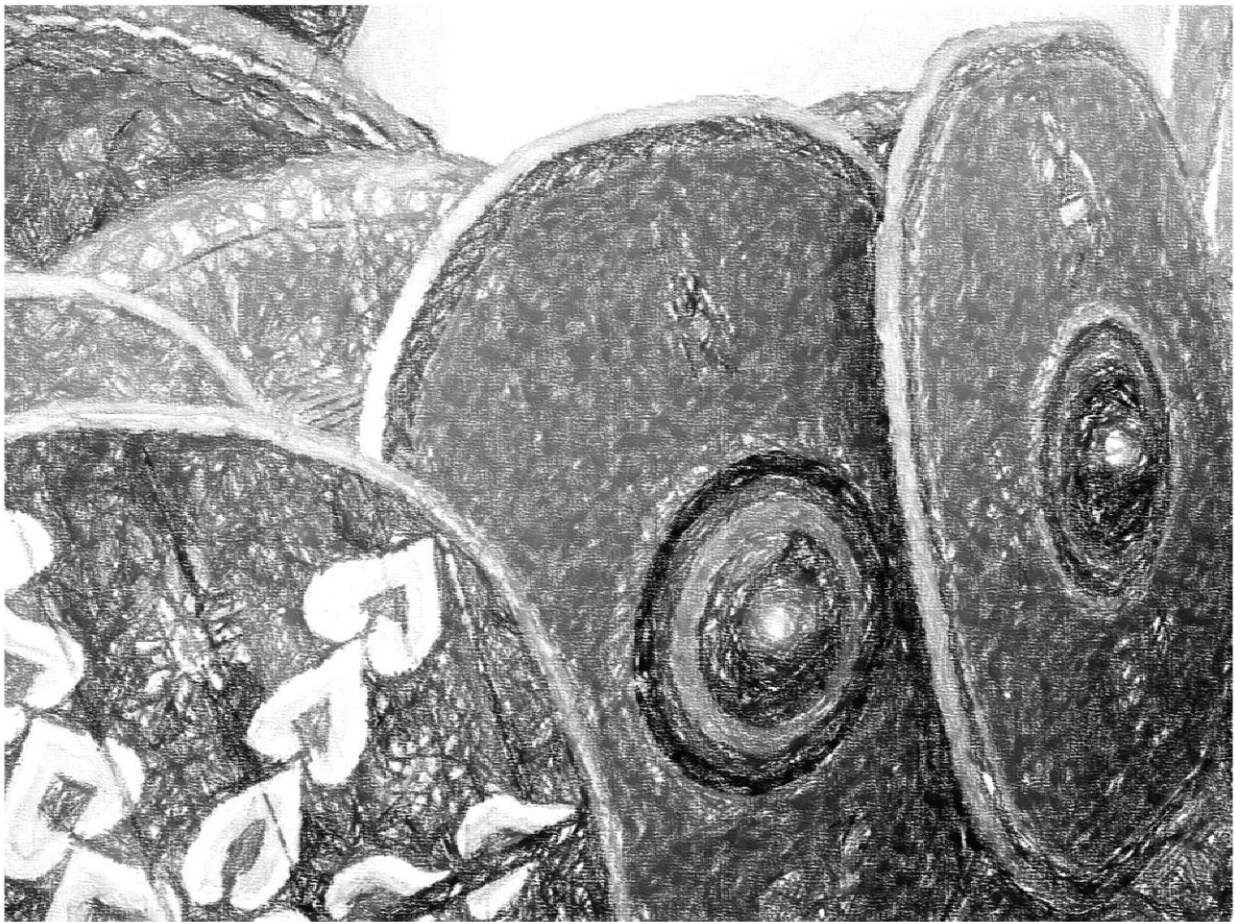
For extended scouting missions, where fighting is not as important as reconnaissance, the soldier might forgo the helmet and armour but still retain his dagger and sword. He will probably carry a small round shield, as well as a 'long weapon' such as a bow, pilum, spear or a few light javelins. In this way, supplies as well as camping and adventuring equipment can be carried that will keep him in the field for a couple of weeks. Leaving armour, large shield and helmet back at the fort keeps the scout mobile and fast-moving.

The PC group can always take along a mule which can carry all its camping equipment - but there is a drawback. A mule needs someone to look after it, either one of the PCs or a trusted servant or slave.

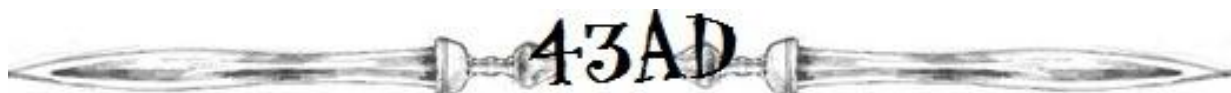
As an alternative to the mule, Roman soldiers could do away with the pack animal and carry everything they needed while marching in formation, themselves. PCs who want to take 'everything' with them can do the same. A T-stick (furca) is slung over the right-shoulder, tied to it is a blanket-roll, a satchel (loculus), a wineskin and both a cooking pot and patera (saucepan). Other items might be strapped to the furca as needed, and any spears or javelins can lay alongside it on the shoulder. The shield is held in the left hand, or carried on a shoulder strap. Moving from this marching set-up to a fighting stance takes only two rounds, since the furca can be thrown to the floor, the shield brought around, and the sword drawn or spear readied. However, unpacking or packing a furca, when an item has been removed or added, takes time! Allow two minutes of rope-tying and fiddling with the position of kit ... In armour and carrying the laden furca, the soldier trudges forward, concentrating on staying in line, keeping one foot in front of another, shifting the burden to ease the aches and pains. No-one with a furca can keep watch for the enemy, for traps or ambushes.

What goes in the kit-bag? For the legionary, a typical kit-bag will contain:

- Spare tunic
- Spare boots
- Food (bread, cheese, bacon, lard, fruit, plus hardtack)
- Camp Knife
- String
- Sharpening Stone
- Fire-Kit (Pouch contains tinder, flint, steel, candle stub)
- Wooden bowl
- Spoon
- Cooking Pot, Skewers and Saucepan (strapped to bag)
- Axe or reaping hook







V COMBAT

The stink almost drove Gaius back – sweat and blood, and greasy war-paint slathered over the enemy warrior's body beneath the rags. The head was hidden by a mask made from a boar's head, uncured and bloody.

Gaius' breath came in desperate gasps. His gladius lay somewhere in the undergrowth and his javelin was all he had left. The warrior's iron sword was nicked and gory from killing Gaius' comrades among the Hispanic auxiliaries.

Gaius leaned with his whole weight onto his javelin and stabbed it through the warrior's stomach. He yanked it out to the slurp of torn entrails and stabbed again and again, seeing the face of the dead in the boar's glazed eyes. Finally his strength left him and he let the warrior slide to the ground, its abdomen torn open and bubbling gore.

'What are you?' muttered Gaius. 'What are you people?' He kicked the boar helm off the warrior's head.

The face of a young woman, smeared with blood, stared up at him unmoving.

Gaius just looked at her for a long time.

Then he sunk to the ground and began to weep.

As with many films and books, critical events in the storyline often hinge on physical confrontation. In the ancient world that usually meant hand-to-hand fighting. This section details the system used to manage fights and other action-orientated manoeuvres.

Many, if not all, of 43AD's scenarios will feature combat to a greater or lesser extent. This is normal. The life and death excitement of hand-to-hand combat puts the existence of the characters in question and heightens the player's interest in his character's situation. Obviously too much combat becomes routine, and routine combat is boring. Fights should be fast paced and frenetic and if they simulate life in any way, should be short. A short, sharp fight packs a far greater punch than one that is an hour long producing the same results. Combat in this game should always add to the story, add to the drama, and never detract from it.

The optio swung his shield left and thrust the boss towards the man's face. He felt something connect then ... thrust his short sword into the man's guts, twisted and withdrew the blade.

Simon Scarrow, *The Eagle's Conquest*

TIME & MOTION

Fights are divided up into 'chunks' of time called combat rounds. In each round everybody involved gets a turn to attack. Essentially, when an adventurer meets an opponent in combat both antagonists roll 2d and add their respective COMBAT scores. The highest score wins that combat round and inflicts damage on his opponent. Large amounts of damage can have additional benefits, as chosen by the player. Once everybody has had a chance to attack, a new round begins. A round lasts perhaps 5 to 10 seconds. Characters should either fight, move or do something else and not mix these activities together.

Humans can generally walk 10 yards each round, and run at 20 yards each round. Many animals (wolves, wild cats, bears, etc) can run at 30 yards per round, while horses are able to move at 45 yards per round. Movement occurs throughout the combat round, although the GM may need to be flexible with this.



THE COMBAT ATTACK ROLL

There is one important consideration that the referee must address before allowing players to roll any dice for a martial attack: the COMBAT attribute. This is a secondary attribute of a temporary nature.

COMBAT is calculated by MIGHT to the COMBAT Bonus of the weapon currently being wielded (in the case of a shortsword, +2). Such a bonus only applies if the weapon is being used in an attack. This bonus is a numerical assessment of that weapon's efficiency, both in terms of damage inflicted as well as the reach and strike probability of the weapon. Weapon values vary and are given in the table below:

Hand-to-hand Weapon Table

<i>Weapon Type</i>	<i>COMBAT Bonus</i>	<i>Cost</i>
Burning Torch	+1	1
Club	+0	5
Dagger	+1	25
Handaxe	+1	25
Javelin #	+2	20
Longsword	+2	175
Pilum #	+1	125
Shield, Small (no attack)	+1	60
Shield, Flat (no attack)	+1	80
Shield, Curved (no attack)	+1	200
Spear	+2	30
Shortsword	+2	100
Staff	+0	5
Wood Axe	+2	50

This bonus for hand-to-hand only

Basically, when rolls are required both antagonists roll 2d and add their respective COMBAT values to the roll. A draw indicates that neither combatant got the better of the other and that no-one got hurt that round. When one character beats the other with a higher total score, however, he has proved his superiority that round and inflicted that many points of damage on his opponent's HITS. But first of all, the relevant Armour Value of the victim is checked on a number of d6 to determine whether the armour deflects the blow. If the armour deflects (any individual die result of '6') then any damage inflicted is completely nullified. Combat rolls continue until one side either escapes, retreats, surrenders or is too injured (or too dead!) to fight on. There are a couple of elaborations of this simple system detailed below:

There was a metallic ring, and frenzied exchange of clattering blows. With no advantage gained, the two resumed their circling motion

Simon Scarrow, *The Eagle's Conquest*



Combat Result of 0

A combat result of 0 indicates that neither combatant got the better of the other - the round ends in a stalemate with weapons clashing.

Combat Results of 1, 2 or 3

Combat results of 1, 2 or 3 are simply subtracted from the target's HITS score as already described. Alternatively they can be saved up. See below.

Combat Results of 4 or More

Combat results of 4 or more provide the player with an opportunity to select one of a number of Crippling Blows. The rolled damage is subtracted from the target character's HITS score as normal, but an additional bonus has been earned. The bigger the result the better the available Crippling Blows will be (see the section on Crippling Blows, later on).

Saving Combat Results

As a tactical option the winner of a combat round can opt to save some or even all his combat result to increase the level of any injuries inflicted in a subsequent round. This simulates the manoeuvre called a feint where the advantage is gained but not exploited immediately. Feinting requires the attacker to have uninjured legs since quite a bit of rapid manoeuvring is assumed.

These saved result points are instantly forfeited when the character loses a round of combat. This makes the tactic a risky one; you dare not save them too long - keep your feint stringing along. Note that combat result points saved in this way only add to the injury type available, and are never added to the Combat Attack roll. Most lowly NPCs and extras are not able to carry over their combat results in this way.

Rolling a 'Natural 12'

A natural roll of '12' (two-sixes) indicates that the player can roll another d6 and add it to his initial roll. This indicates a special success and allows characters with a low score to occasionally strike lucky.

Rolling a 'Natural 2'

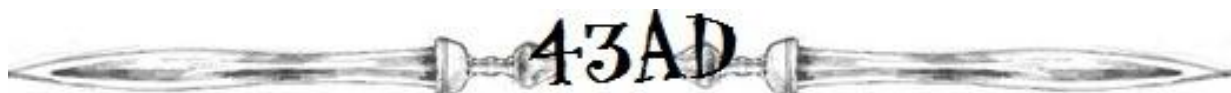
A natural roll of '2' (two -ones) indicates that the character has failed in his action, no matter what bonuses he can add on to that roll. A 'natural 2' is an automatic failure. If using a spear, it breaks ...

INFLECTING DAMAGE

With a sharp cry the man next [to him] went down as the bloody tip of a wickedly barbed spear burst through his calf. With a vicious wrench the Briton at the end of the spear pulled it back and the legionary fell onto his back, screaming.

Simon Scarrow, *The Eagle's Conquest*

Weapons inflict an amount of damage to a victim equal to the winner's combat result (the difference in the two combat attack rolls). If the winner of that round rolled a total of 12 and his opponent rolled only 7, for example, then the victor would inflict 5 points of damage to his opponent's HITS. This damage value is subtracted from the target's HITS score. The number of HITS sustained may incur some other penalty. These are Crippling Blows (both Wounds and Maims), being Badly Wounded, and Death.



Damage inflicted equal to 4 or more points gives the player the option of inflicting a Crippling Wound on his opponent. See Crippling Blows (below).

Collapsing

When a character's HITS score is reduced to 3, 2 or 1 points, he has suffered so much pain, blood loss and shock that he collapses, and is seriously unwell. All of his subsequent actions (of whatever nature) are rolled on 1d not 2d, and if a FATE roll is failed he falls unconscious for 2 dice minutes. The character loses 1 HIT per hour until dead, or until treated by someone with First Aid skill or healing magic.

Death

At 0 HITS a character dies and his spirit travels to the blessed fields of Elysium.

CRIPPLING BLOWS

Then before the barbarian could strike, Pyrrhus dealt him a tremendous blow on the head with his sword. So great was the strength of his arm and the keenness of the blade that it cleft the man from head to foot, and in an instant the two halves of his body fell apart.

Plutarch, *Life of Pyrrhus*

A character that beats his opponent's combat attack roll has proved his superiority and gained the upper hand. If a character has inflicted 4 or more points of damage on his opponent (after armour), then the referee may want to allow that player to select one of a number of Crippling Blows. Crippling Blows are essentially additional benefits or special attack moves the character can choose to inflict. They are rated on a scale 4-20 and this number indicates the minimum number of HITS that must first be inflicted to achieve a particular Crippling Blow. If a player wants to inflict some lesser blow - then fine! He can save the difference in points and use them to try and increase his damage next turn (see the section on Saving Combat Results, earlier). In other words he can save points now to inflict a really great injury later!

There are nine Crippling Blows called "Wounds" to choose from, one for each part of the human body. These are given a HITS rating that ranges from 4 to 8. Characters with lots of HITS to spend on a Crippling Blow can spend **double** the required amount of HITS to select one of nine Crippling Blows called "Maims". For example, our hero gains a combat result of 5 and sees that the 5 HIT Crippling Blow is a Head 'Wound' which might potentially knock his foe out! If our hero had gained a combat result of 10 he could have selected the 10 HIT Crippling Blow, the Head 'Maim', at a much greater lethality. A Head Maim temporarily incapacitates the victim and might knock him out for hours!

Fighting On!

A character who has suffered a Crippling Blow categorised as a Wound can spend **1 FATE** point to shrug off the penalties associated with that injury, while a character who has suffered a Maim can spend **2 FATE** points to shrug off the penalties associated with that injury. The blow still inflicts the same level of bloody trauma and wounding but the spent FATE point(s) allow the character to 'fight on'. The HIT loss associated with the injury is still taken, however, and the rules for Collapsing and Death still apply in full. As soon as the combat is over the referee then imposes the normal effects of an injury on the player character.



The Crippling Blows and their bloody effects are:

HITS	Location	WOUND Description/Effects
4	CHEST	<i>Chest slashed open and ribs cracked</i> Stunned next round
4	LEG	<i>Leg cut badly, slashed to the bone</i> No running
4	ARM	<i>Arm bloodied and muscle torn</i> Use arm at 1d effectiveness. Drop item held.
5	HEAD	<i>Head knocked badly, dizziness and lots of blood</i> Stunned 1 round. Roll FATE or knocked-out for 2d rounds.
6	BELLY	<i>Guts cut open, weak at the knees</i> Stunned 2 rounds
7	GROIN	<i>A stab to the vitals - extreme agony!</i> Stunned 3 rounds
7	HAND	<i>Fingers cut badly, weapon dropped</i> Drop item, disarmed. Only 1 HIT inflicted.
7	FACE	<i>Face slashed - blood, gore and pain blinds the victim</i> Blinded till treated. Stunned 2 rounds
8	THROAT	<i>Throat slashed and larynx damaged, no talking till healed</i> Incapacitated for 2 rounds

HITS	Location	MAIM Description/Effects
8	CHEST	<i>Ribs broken and lungs punctured, coughing blood</i> Incapacitated 1 round
8	LEG	<i>Leg broken and gouged to the bone</i> Cannot stand, no running
8	ARM	<i>Arm broken and smashed, hanging useless</i> Drop item being held, arm cannot be used till healed
10	HEAD	<i>Skull smashed - disorientation, blood and gore</i> Incapacitated 3 rounds. Roll FATE or knocked-out for 1-6 hours
12	BELLY	<i>Agonising slash to the gut leaves entrails hanging out</i> Incapacitated for 4 rounds
14	GROIN	<i>Vitals severed or maimed, agony and traumatic blood-loss!</i> Incapacitated for 5 rounds
14	HAND	<i>Hand severed. Tourniquet NOW!</i> Hand severed. Fight at 1d from now on (not 2d) till healed.
14	FACE	<i>Face smashed into a pulp, eye lost and face bloodied</i> Lose an eye. Fight at 1d from now on (not 2d) till healed.
16	THROAT	<i>Victim decapitated, OR throat opened up spilling a sea of blood</i>

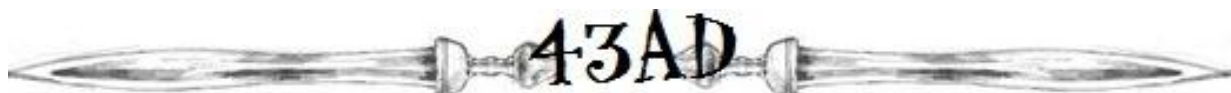
Definitions

Stunned: No attacking allowed, only defence. Roll combat attacks, no damage inflicted.

Incapacitated: Fall over. No actions can be taken at all. In extreme pain and shock.

No running: Cannot save combat results (i.e. feint manoeuvre).

Crippling Blow: A Wound or a Maim.



RECOVERING HITS

First Aid

Characters at 3 or less HITS and who have *collapsed* will die unless treated successfully by someone with First Aid skill. Characters *stunned* or *knocked out* can be returned to a normal waking state with a successful First Aid roll.

Recovery

Anyone who has simply lost HITS can recover them at a rate of 1 HIT per day, assuming a safe environment. Those who are **wounded** can wait one full day, then lose another HIT permanently, before they start recovering HITS at 1 HIT per day. Better to have been treated by a surgeon in the first day who can repair some of the damage with a CRAFT roll. There is no permanent loss. Those who are **maimed** can wait one full day, then lose 2 HITS and 1 MIGHT point permanently, before they start recovering HITS at 1 HIT per day. Better to have been treated by a surgeon in that first day who can repair some of the damage with a CRAFT roll. There is only the loss of 2 HITS.

SHIELDS

Although a shield is a defensive item it is included in the character's list of offensive bonuses for hand to hand (but not missile) combat. In this way it influences the chance of winning a combat round. All shields provide a +1 in combat, but cannot be used to attack without a weapon. The shields in these rules are:

Small Shield : Often circular, these shields provide no other benefit. They are used by tribal skirmishers and by Roman skirmishers, archers, trumpeters and standard-bearers. They provide no extra defence against arrows or other missiles.

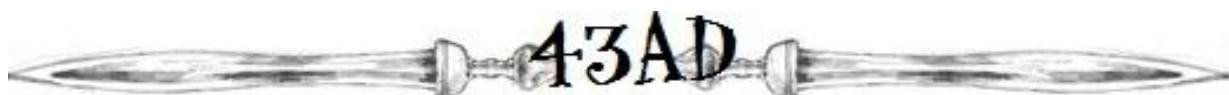
Flat Shield: Often oval, these shields are used by Roman auxiliaries, Roman cavalry and by legionaries on special detachment (often cross-country missions). The warrior's tribal shield is a flat shield, oval or tall and rectangular. It provides a penalty to any archers or other missile attackers of -1.

Curved Shield: This famous curved, straight-sided rectangular shield is complex to make (plywood construction) and expensive. It provides a defence against missile attacks, giving the attacker a -2 penalty on his roll. It's size makes it almost impossible to use with a long-sword, and difficult to carry over rough terrain. Reduce movement to 8m/16m per round and impose a -2 penalty during a chase.

Their size and straight sides mean the curved shields can lock together to create a wall without any gaps, a perfect protection against missile fire. Four or more can create a stationary or very slow-moving wall that gives any missile attacker a -4 penalty. The wall provides no extra defense against normal hand-to-hand combat, however.

ARMOUR

Armour can be worn by characters to help deflect the damage that they suffer during an adventure. Because different characters can wear different pieces of armour at different times, individual items of armour are given a numerical rating. The ratings for each piece of armour worn are added up to create an Armour Value.



Armour Table

<i>Armour</i>	<i>Armour Value</i>	<i>Cost</i>
Helm	1	120
Greaves	1	200
Manica	1	400
Mail Armour	1	800
Mail Doubling	1	180
Segmented Armour	3	800
Breastplate Armour	2	800

What effect does wearing armour have on the chances for survival? When it is determined that the character has been hit, the player takes a number of dice equal to the total Armour Value and rolls them. If any of the dice come up as a '6' then the attack is negated! Simple as that. The roll is made before a player or referee decides what to do with the points he has scored and where to allocate them.

Note that only one type of armour can be worn at one time, although 'doubling' is an added section of mail that can be worn on the shoulders on top of chainmail. Greaves are a pair of iron leg protectors reaching from the ankle to the knee. A manica is a leather and metal 'sleeve' protecting the sword arm from blows. It originated with gladiators in the arena but has also been adopted by legionnaires in the late 1stC AD. A shield does not have an armour rating, in fact it adds a COMBAT bonus to the characters attack roll instead (as long as he carries a weapon with him to inflict damage). Don't treat a shield as a piece of armour unless it acts as a barrier to incoming missile fire. Even then it just gives the attacker a penalty.

UNARMED COMBAT

Here the Spartans resisted to the last, with their swords, if they had them, and if not, with their hands and teeth, until the Persians coming on from the front over the ruins of the wall and closing in from behind, finally overwhelmed them with missile weapons.

Herodotus, *The Histories*

An unarmed fighter has no COMBAT bonus from a weapon, and does Stun damage when he hits. Stun damage is inflicted on HITS just like regular damage; and these Stuns are always added to any damage **already sustained**. In keeping with the normal damage rules, 1-3 Stuns can be inflicted immediately or held back as a feint. Stuns of 4 or more can also be used to purchase useful Unarmed Moves. Besides the effects of these Unarmed Moves, when an unarmed attacker has reduced an opponent's HITS to 0, that opponent is not killed but knocked unconscious for 4d minutes.

The Unarmed Moves (Basic costing 4-7 Stuns; Advanced costing 8-14 Stuns) are:

Basic Unarmed Moves

HITS	Basic Unarmed Move	Effects
4	Bloody Face	Stunned for 1 round
4	Throw To Ground	Suffer an extra 2 HITS; now lying on the floor
5	Kick In Gut	Stunned for 2 rounds
6	Disarm	Drop item. Disarmed.
6	Arm/Leg Lock	Victim struggling, all actions use 1d roll, not 2d roll. That limb is immobile (to continue the lock win MIGHT versus MIGHT roll each minute)
7	Head Lock	Victim immobile and in pain (to continue the lock win MIGHT versus MIGHT roll each minute)



Advanced Unarmed Moves

HITS	Advanced Unarmed Move	Effects
8	Smash Face	Stunned for 3 rounds
8	Throw Against Wall	Suffer an extra 4 HITS; now lying on the floor
10	Knock Out Combination	Groin strike followed by massive head blow; Knocked Out for 2d minutes
12	Use Enemy's Weapon	Winner can fight foe's friends by manipulating foe's weapon arm against his will!
12	Break Limb!	6 HITS worth of damage inflicted; leg or arm broken
14	Strangle	Inflict a number of HITS equal to MIGHT every round that strangling continues (to continue win MIGHT versus MIGHT roll at end of each minute)

MISSILE COMBAT

Then the Rhodians, who were posted at intervals in the Greek ranks, used their slings, and the archers shot their arrows, and no-one failed to hit a man (indeed one could hardly miss if one tried to) ...

Xenophon, The Persian Expedition

The use of thrown weapons, slings or bows is handled in a slightly different way to hand-to-hand fighting. When an character wishes to use a missile weapon his player must roll 2d, add the character's MIGHT score and the missile weapon's COMBAT Bonus to achieve a result of **12 or more**.

Technical Note

The bow is probably a composite bow made of horn, woods and sinew, common in the eastern empire. The javelin is a light throwing spear, while the pilum is the famous Roman javelin with a long iron tang and head that adds significant range and power to the throw. These iron tangs bend when they hit shields, or the ground, rendering them useless to the enemy.

Ruining The Aim

A number of factors, as well as range, might affect an archer's. These penalties are given in the table, below. Note that although a thrown weapon can be cast while on the run, the sling and bow must both be shot from a stationary position on the ground.

Hit by an Arrow - If hit by an arrow that inflicts damage, the adventurer must remove the arrow quickly or suffer the consequences! If left in, the adventurer suffers a penalty to all actions equal to the HITS it inflicted. So an arrow that hit for 4 points gives that adventurer a -4 to all his combat (and other) actions. Pulling it out without medical aid or healing results in a further 2 HIT loss.

Target over range	-2
Target over double range	-4
Target in partial cover	-2
Target moving	-1

Reloading

Bows and slings can generally be used once per round and reloaded in the interim. Quivers carry 12 arrows, bags of slingshot have a capacity of 20.



Melee & the Missile Weapon

When missile weapons are used in melee, problems arise. When a character tries to use a missile weapon at very short ranges (i.e. while in hand-to-hand combat) he must be told that there is a minimum range of 3yds for any missile weapon. If he wishes to fire at a distant target while being attacked in hand-to-hand then the attacker only has to roll over the archer's basic MIGHT score. Easy. Sitting target.

Another complication is hitting a target who is engaged in melee combat with a friend. The character wants to hit the enemy, but not his friend. He rolls to hit at -2, and if he misses, the archer will hit his friend on a combat result of 8 or 9. The damage done will be 1d + COMBAT bonus of weapon. Ouch!

Missile Weapons

<i>Missile Weapon</i>	<i>Range</i>	<i>COMBAT Bonus</i>	<i>Cost</i>
Bow	50yds	+2	200
Dagger, Thrown	10yds	+1	35
Javelin	10yds	+2	20
Pilum	10yds	+3	125
Sling	50yds	+1	10
Spear, Thrown	5yds	+2	30
Stone, Thrown	10yds	0	-

OTHER SITUATIONS

Fighting Multiple Opponents

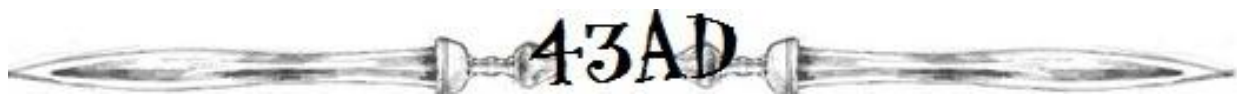
Fighting more than one opponent becomes a little more complex, but not much. When a lone character is fighting two or more antagonists, he rolls his dice once and decides which one he will try to hit that round. Then each of his opponents rolls separately to try and overcome that roll. Only the target selected will suffer any damage, however, and the adventurer himself can only attack one target each round. Any other successful rolls just indicate that a blow has been parried. Some creatures have multiple attacks allowing them to fight and wound more than one character each round. They cannot use these attacks to 'gang-up' on one victim. One attack per character - at all times.

Surprise

The GM must decide when surprise is achieved by the player characters, by non-player characters or by monsters. Obviously common sense plays a large part in this. Be fair. Surprise usually gives the surprising side a free round during which the monsters or characters can attack, flee or carry out some other action before the opposition realises what is going on and retaliates. In some circumstances, where the surprising monster or character is within striking distance of his opponent, a bonus of +3 on the to-hit roll can be awarded.

Fighting From Advantage

Player characters can and should exploit advantages that exist within the gameworld to maximise their chances of victory. These advantages include the following manoeuvres: *High Ground, Cover, Opponent fallen, Partially Blinded foe, Mounted versus standing, Retreating foe*. All of these (and many others too numerous to mention) make attacks easier and often more effective. The 'out-maneuvred' combatant must make an impromptu FATE roll to try to negate his opponent's tactical manoeuvre. If failed, then the manoeuvring combatant gains a +1 on his attack roll for each advantage that has an influence on the fight that round.



Cavalry

Infantry really do not like horses. One reason is the size and power of the beast. Another is the height advantage enjoyed by the rider. Cavalrymen move 45 yards/round, easily charging a small group of foot-soldiers and moving past them, away from danger. They fight 'from advantage', being higher than their opponents and on moving animals ... together these provide a +2 combat advantage over the foot-soldier. Only an opponent being charged who has a long weapon like a spear or pilum being used in hand-to-hand, can make a FATE roll to negate this advantage. Should the horse slow to a trot or a walk (if the rider loses the combat attack roll, or for some other reason) then the rider only has a +1 advantage and can be attacked with **any** weapon if a FATE roll succeeds.

How to Kill A Horse: Roll FATE to attack the horse charging you, failure indicates the soldier suffers 1-6 HITS and is knocked over. The rider still gets to roll for his combat attack roll and if he succeeds, of course, he strikes the foot-soldier. The horse can be attacked with **any** weapon.

MIGHT 8 HITS 20 1 Attack, Speed 60yds

Chariots

The rule above for being charged by horses also apply to being ridden down by a British chariot. The warrior on board (using only a spear or javelins) attacks with the cavalryman's +2 advantage and only an opponent being charged who has a long weapon like a spear or pilum being used in hand-to-hand, can make a FATE roll to negate this advantage. What makes chariots different is the fact

that the driver can make his own attack, crashing into and over a foot-soldier. Assume automatic success for the chariot-driver unless the foot-soldier makes a successful FATE roll to get out of the way in time. If not, then he makes a second FATE roll to either be knocked down and bruised (-1d6 HITS) or, if the roll is failed, trampled and run over (-2d6 +2 HITS). Infantry don't like chariots either, and try to find methods to defeat them! Jumping onboard could be tried as it rushes past. Be prepared to be attacked by the warrior onboard (and being hit stops you jumping...), as well as making a FATE roll. Failure here means you immediately go under the hooves or wheels (-2d6 +2 HITS damage).

Retreating

A character worried about his chances might want to forget about attacking his opponent and defend in full while he retreats. To do this he makes two consecutive combat rolls and if successful on either does no damage to his opponent. If both are successful he does, however, manage to flee the combat and find an opportunity for escape! Remember that the attacker might continue to pursue! The referee can only allow a retreat if there is somewhere to retreat to. It might be jumping from a balcony, stepping through a door, jumping out of a window or running down some stairs - but there must be some avenue of escape. A fighter could not retreat when duelling in the middle of open desert, for example.

The Off-Hand

When deprived of the use of his favoured hand through injury a character in a tight spot will have to resort to using his weapon in his off-hand. Under such desperate conditions the weapon offers **no Combat Bonus**. Such a character cannot feint either, and so cannot save up combat results for later use.

Two-Swords Flashing

There may be times when a player declares that a second weapon is being used in his character's off-hand in addition to his primary weapon. A second weapon held in the off-hand allows a character to **attack two opponents in one round**, contrary to the rules given above that restrict him to one attack but allow multiple defence rolls. This second weapon is wielded with a -2 COMBAT bonus, though.



Spears

Spears have a unique property. Essential big fighting daggers on long poles, they are able to reach an enemy who will struggle to fight back, that is unless they too are armed with spears. This inherent advantage gives a spear-wielding soldier a +1 in combat. However, this spear bonus only lasts until the spearman loses his first combat action roll, simulating the way in which a swordsman gets 'inside' the spear's fighting radius. He will regain his +1 bonus immediately after he succeeds in another combat attack roll, regaining the space he needs to use his weapon. Spears break on a natural roll of 'double 1'.

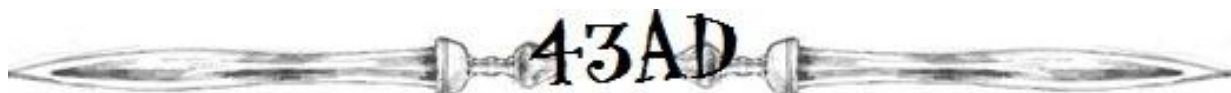
First Example of Combat: The Roundhouse

When the squad checks out a hostile rath, Quintus is ordered to search a roundhouse. He ducks inside, and is ambushed by a spear-wielding low level warrior (COMBAT+5, no armour, 10 HITS). The attributes and skills of Quintus can be found in the next chapter, but note that he carries sword, shield and pilum, has a helmet and segmented armour, AV 3, COMBAT+7 and 15 HITS. Quintus makes his Fate roll and so nullifies the ambush, he senses the warrior's attack!

Both fight simultaneously. In round one, Quintus rolls 17, the warrior 14, so Quintus wins doing 3 HITS damage. The warrior loses his +1 spear bonus. In the next round, shield's clattering, Quintus rolls 14 and the warrior 16, the warrior has gotten past Quintus' shield. His AV is 3 so we roll 3d6 and get 1, 4 and 2, none of which are a 6 so the warrior's spear does damage for 2 HITS (because damage is calculated as 16-14). Both have been slightly wounded now. Next the warrior tries to get the roundhouse fire in between himself and Quintus, but the Roman makes his FATE roll and he does not suffer the -1 penalty for such a disadvantage. In the third round Quintus rolls 15, the warrior 14, Quintus inflicts 1 HIT to the warrior who has now been reduced to 6 HITS.

In the next turn Lucullus, a comrade of Quintus comes barging in to investigate the sounds of fighting. When he sees the warrior, he instinctively raises his pilum and throws it (his notes state he is a 'killer'). Meanwhile Quintus rolls a 14, so does the warrior, a draw. Lucullus must recalculate his COMBAT to throw the pilum, since his score ordinarily uses his shortsword and shield. His COMBAT is MIGHT 4, with +3 for the pilum, total COMBAT+7. He might hit Quintus (see Melee & the Missile Weapon), but throws anyway. He rolls 11, hitting Quintus for 9 points of damage and reducing him to 4 HITS! We check his 3d6 armour roll, but it does not save him. The GM rules he has an 8 point Chest Maim (punctured lung and is knocked over and incapacitated, out of the fight).

Cursing his bad luck and circling the fire, Lucullus draws his shortsword and tackles the warrior himself. He has COMBAT+7, AV 3 and 20 HITS. The warrior regains his +1 spear bonus. The roll is 16 versus 15, he inflicts 1 HIT and prevents the spear bonus next round. In the subsequent round he inflicts another HIT, the warrior is down to 4 HITS. In Lucullus' third round he rolls 13, the warrior rolls 14, but the Roman's armour blocks the damage. The spear bonus is back in play now ... in the next round Lucullus rolls 14, the warrior 17, but again he rolls a 6 on one of his armour dice so all the damage is deflected. In the fifth round he rolls 15, the warrior rolls 13 ...those 2 HIT points of damage sends the warrior to 2 HITS, and he collapses, failing his FATE roll. Lucullus kills the squirming warrior with his own spear, then drags the dying Quintus out into the sunlight. How is he going to explain this?



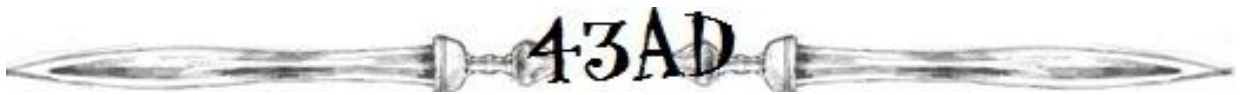
Second Example of Combat: Outside the Shrine

Two legionaries are sent on ahead to the shrine to find the witch, while the rest of the squad tackle a small warband. Lugodoc, naked from the waist up, unarmoured but armed with sword and shield stands blocking the doorway. He has an AV of 2 from his protective magic, COMBAT+9 and 18 HITS. First to reach him is Gnaeus, an archer out of arrows, attacking with shield and shortsword (COMBAT +5, AV 2, 13 HITS and a FATE score of 6).

In round one Gnaeus rolls 12, Lugodoc 16. Seeing a second soldier running towards the shrine, and due to arrive in two rounds Lugodoc saves the 2 points as advantage over Gnaeus next round. Gnaeus rolls 9, Lugodoc rolls 11, but with a double-2! Auto failure. The warrior also loses the 2 points of advantage he was saving up. The killer Lucullus arrives in this next round, both legionaries can now fight. Lugodoc will continue to target Gnaeus, but will only defend against Lucullus. Lugodoc rolls 16. Gnaeus rolls 11 and Lucullus 18. Gnaeus is hit, his armour doesn't protect him and he suffers 5 HITS damage and a 5-point Head Wound. Young Gnaeus has lots of FATE to burn and spends a point to ignore the effects (stunned for 1 round). Lucullus has gained a 2 point advantage, and holds it until the next round, knowing that only a big wound will take down this 18 HIT warrior.

In the subsequent round Lugodoc rolls 15. Gnaeus rolls 15 also, whilst Lucullus rolls 19. Lucky Lucullus decides to strike, adding his 2 point advantage to this round's 4 point success. His skill is Killing Blow, however, and with his final FATE point (he has been using his skill quite a lot!) he gains a +4 damage bonus for this attack only, pushing his final wound up to a 10 pointer! Lugodoc is reduced to 8 HITS, and Lucullus decides to select the Head Maim wound (he could have selected any lesser wound at no reduction in the number of HITS inflicted on the warrior). Lugodoc takes a shortsword in the side of the head, cracking his skull and incapacitating the warrior for 3 rounds. We roll 2d6 for his protective magic, a 1 and 3, no effect. He does make his FATE roll, though, so he is still conscious when Lucullus leans over him and sticks the sharp tip of his sword up inside the brave warrior's ribcage, ending the battle for the shrine.

Note that the GM didn't spend any FATE for Lugodoc in combat to Fight On, that's personal preference. He allows only the PCs to be able to spend FATE in this way. You may decide otherwise.



staff



pilum



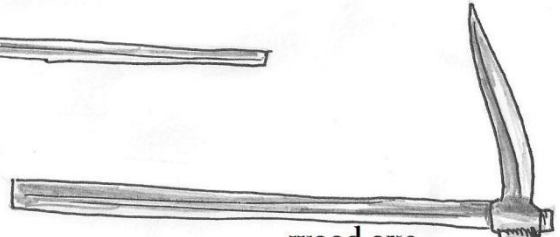
javelin



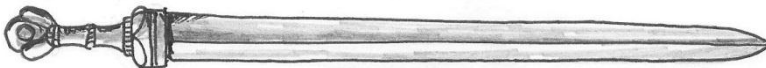
club



spear



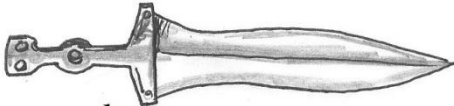
wood axe



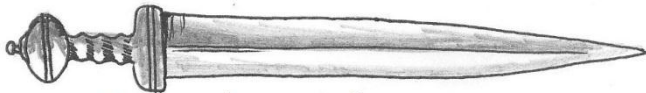
Celtic longsword



hand axe



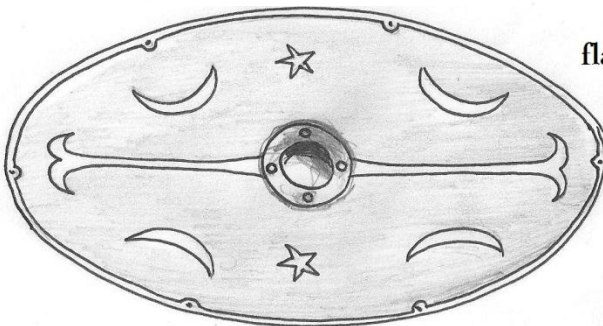
dagger



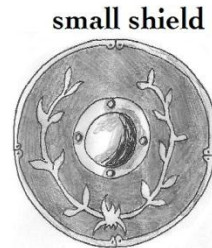
Roman shortsword



burning torch

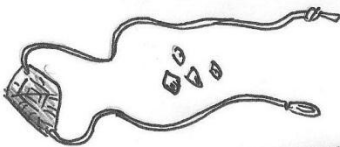


flat shield

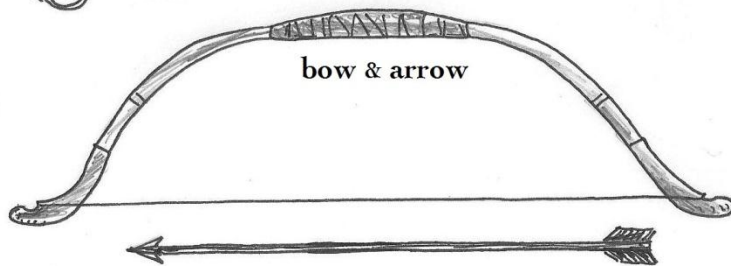


small shield

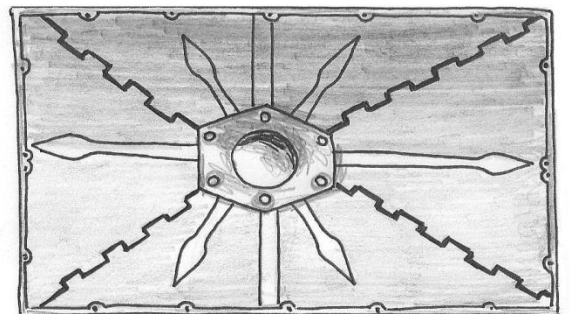
sling & stones



bow & arrow



curved shield





VI ACTIONS & ENCOUNTERS

Nicias saw governor Albinus for the first time and knew those were eyes that could twinkle as they watched a man drown.

'You're Greek?' asked Albinus, looking down a long, bent nose with those flinty eyes.

'Yes, sir.'

'Good, good. Not having some Gaulish dog taking a chisel to me. What city?'

'Megara.'

'A poor place.'

'It sufficed me.'

Albinus sat up on his reclinium. He was a strange combination of sagging girth from feasting and a skinny neck supporting a sharp avian face. 'Didn't stop you from legging it to Rome, did it? And then you end up all the way out here! Ha! Enjoying the rain? Found a girl without warts yet?'

'I haven't really looked,' said Nicias.

'They like boys in Megara, do they? Or is that Athens? All the same, I suppose.' Albinus indicated the block of marble in front of Nicias. *'What do you suggest? Bust in the style of Alexander, I think.'*

'I think full-length would suit you.'

'Don't have that much marble, boy, and I'm buggered if you're sculpting me out of bloody limestone the price that block cost me.'

'Full-length,' said Nicias. 'With your toga up, pissing on a British corpse.'

There was a very long pause.

Albinus' face broke open into a smile. 'Still got that Greek humour in you, then! Get started, lad, before my back acts up.'

Nicias took a deep breath, and began to chisel.

USING ATTRIBUTES

As a simple rule of thumb, any task can be resolved with a MIGHT, FATE, CRAFT or LEARNING roll. The GM needs to establish for himself a difficulty number that (as in combat) must be equalled or exceeded for success. Typically this will be 10, but occasionally easier tasks might be rated at 8, while more difficult tasks might be rated at 12 or even 14. The situations in the following sections roughly conform to this simple rule, but include a number of individual variations.

The uses of MIGHT have been detailed extensively earlier in the book, and FATE is covered in a later chapter. But what about CRAFT and LEARNING? CRAFT could be rolled to tie two ropes together in a hurry, to fix a cartwheel, to chop down a tree to block a path, to dig a pit trap before the sun sets, etc. Use CRAFT when the character is faced with a physical task that doesn't involve fighting or lots of athletic



movement or feats of strength. It is a measure of practicality, handiness and experience of manual labour - and it has far more uses than just 'building things'.

LEARNING is the counter to CRAFT. It measures formal schooling, education and knowledge as well as the gamut of social skills. I have kept 'intelligence' in the realm of the player in **43AD**. It is the player who tries to solve the puzzles, come up with a strategy, remember an informer's name and so on. LEARNING could be used to remember a fact about the Brigantian royal family, to recognise an NPC's hand-writing, to understand the implications behind a senator's speech, to know how Minerva differs from Juno. LEARNING might also be called upon when the character tries to bribe an official, or discern extreme nervousness in the wine-trader's beautiful daughter.

USING SKILLS

A skill has no number attached to it, like FATE, LEARNING or MIGHT. A character either possesses a skill or does not. The use of each skill is different and both Game Master and player must determine the exact use of a skill by checking the descriptions given below.

Acting: The character is able to mimic other accents, body languages and expressions. He can act as if he were someone else, with a different personality and emotions. He may have learnt this professionally in the theatre, or in the cut-throat world of politics. Any character may try a persuasion or deception, only the character with Acting can adopt a completely different persona and act it out.

Carry Burden: The character has plenty of hard experience as a bearer - someone who carries around loads on his back. It means he can comfortably carry far more than his body size would suggest. A strongman might be able to lift the weight over his head, but only a bearer could carry it across the desert all day! Those characters with Carry Burden skill get to double their MIGHT when calculating Load Capacity (see III Creating Military Characters).

Detect Lies: With this skill, a character can determine if the person he is talking to is concealing the truth, either by lying, or omission of facts. has lied in the last minute. It does not reveal the truth, however. For extremely subtle or skilled opponents, the GM might require a LEARNING roll.

Double Strike: The character can strike twice against the same character; effectively getting a free attack. This second attack is rolled as normal before damage for the first attack is accounted for, and is made at a -2 penalty.

Evade: The character can avoid and flee violent confrontations and attacks very easily. If he spends 1 FATE point he gains a +4 bonus on his COMBAT roll to avoid combat. And he only needs to make this roll once to retreat (see Retreating).

Evaluate: The character can immediately assess the worth of an item of trade or an item of treasure. He knows what this item should be worth on the open market in a typical city or town. It may not apply to one-of-a-kind items, exotic, magical or previously unknown items.

Far Throw: This skill allows the character to throw a throwing weapon an extra 10yds. The basic throwing range is only 10yds so the Far Throw skill allows the character to throw his weapons out to 20yds!



Field Surgery: A character with this skill can treat wounded or maimed characters within 24 hours and prevent them from losing points of HIT or MIGHT permanently. He can also treat all manner of poisons, diseases and maladies away from the battlefield. Finally, he can spend 1 FATE to heal 6 points of HITS during his treatment (once per person, per day, however). This skill requires the use of a set of bronze medical instruments, as well as a supply of linen bandages, a willing assistant and fresh water.

Find Direction: The character is always sure from which direction he has just come, can retrace his steps perfectly, and has an uncanny knack of being able to determine the direction north, with only the minimum amount of observable clues.

Fire Craft: Lighting a fire is often inconsequential. However, this character can light a fire in the rain or wind, keep it going and tend it. He is adept at cooking, camping and building ovens for pottery or bread making. He can look at an old campfire in the wilds and tell you how many people sat around it, and often what they were doing there. As long as he has means to light a fire, it is an automatic action, whether camping in Caledonia or trying to burn down the wooden palisade of an enemy dun!

First Aid: The character with first aid can assist victims knocked out or stunned, reviving them in one round. Characters at 3 or less HITS and who have collapsed will die unless treated successfully by someone with First Aid skill who spends 1 FATE point.

Forgery: The character has extensive experience spotting or creating forged documents, anything from wax seals to written orders on papyrus. Sometimes it's the quality of the ink, the consistency of the wax or the wording that gives it away. Roll LEARNING to detect a forgery, or to create one (GMs keep this latter roll secret until the document is read!).

Hard To Kill: The character is hardened to pain and wounding, he has an in-built armour value (AV) of 1. He shrugs off damage on a roll of '1' on 1d6.

Healing Herbs: Knowledge of useful herbs that can be used as medicines and antidotes. This knowledge includes their preparation and application, as well as their identification. The character can spend four hours searching for herbs, and rolls FATE. A success means that 1-3 useful herbs have been found. It takes half an hour to process a herb, and it is then ready for application to a patient, or for storage for up to a month. A remedy can restore 1-3 HITS or stop bleeding, or specific herbs can be located to treat certain ailments.

Hiding: The character is expert at concealment and ambush. He is able to literally cover his tracks to prevent pursuit and can hide behind or within many different features to avoid detection. When someone attempts to spot the character the searcher gets an automatic -2 to his roll. A common use for Hiding is to ambush passing characters and gain complete surprise.

Killing Blow: The character has trained to hit certain parts of a target's anatomy in hand-to-hand combat. He knows just where to strike for most damage, whether throat, eye, groin or heart etc. This precision attack costs 1 point of FATE, but provides the character with +4 on the damage that he inflicts (if the attack is successful). This bonus is good only for that single attack.

Killing Shot: The character has trained to hit certain parts of a target's anatomy in missile combat. He knows just where to strike for most damage, whether throat, eye, groin or heart etc. This precision attack



costs 1 point of FATE, but provides the adventurer with +4 on the damage that he inflicts (if the attack is successful). This bonus is good only for that single attack.

Mend: The character with this skill is somehow able to fix something that needs fixing NOW! A broken wagon axle, a torsion ballista, a door lock, a smashed shield and so on. He needs minimal tools and few raw materials. Even without those two essentials, he can still mend the object upon spending a single point of FATE.

Mountain Travel: Movement through hills is carried out as if simply 'cross country', travel through mountains is carried out as if moving through 'hills'. The character can act as a pathfinder, and lead others through the mountains at the same rate. In addition, the character with this skill is familiar with the dangers and types of animals typically encountered in mountainous country.

Open Lock: The character is an expert at picking locks. Locks are very expensive in Roman Britain, used only by wealthier families, some very rich merchants and royalty. Locks are big and heavy. To use this skill a tool is required, either pre-prepared or improvised. A CRAFT roll is required to successfully pick a lock.

Organise: The character is trained to solve problems, to be efficient, to maximise resources and minimise waste! A character with organise can always seem to speed up any team effort, always find a way to stretch resources just enough, can scrounge desperately needed items, and always find some way to cut corners. It may take some thinking time (or calculating time if that is more appropriate) but he can usually do it.

Read Tracks: Fresh tracks and spoor can be identified and interpreted, allowing a tracker to assess the possible direction and number of an animal type. Certain terrain, time and bad weather will all badly degrade animal tracks. Humans, too, leave distinctive and tell-tale tracks that can betray direction, speed, numbers, burden carried and even how long ago they were made. A FATE roll may be required if the tracks are poor.

Seduction: The character is attractive to all women. This has immense benefits when it comes to making friends and creating allies, but also has immense drawbacks. Spurned or jilted lovers may be vengeful. Note that important female NPCs may not always be taken in by the character's charms. The GM should roll the PC's FATE secretly. Of course, all the other members of the PC's squad will hate him!

Seek Audience: The character is familiar with court etiquette and ritual and is readily able to 'play the system' to use the right amount of flattery and demand to get to see a high-ranking personage. A very useful skill! Want to persuade a slave to let you see his master, or the gate guard to let you into the fort because you have information for the prefect? Use Seek Audience, the GM may sometimes ask for a LEARNING roll.

Shield Smash: At the expenditure of 1 FATE point, the character can invoke this skill. On his next successful attack he does no damage, but smashes his opponent's shield to bits, reducing his Combat Attack score by 1.

Silent Movement: The character can creep about in total silence, making him a great thief or assassin! He cannot run or perform any other exertions, but must move slowly and cautiously. Note that this skill is



not some magical power. If the character is walking on pebbles then he cannot rationally avoid making a noise ...

Streetwise: The character has experience with crime and the criminal underworld in one or more of the towns of Roman Britain. FATE can be rolled to establish a contact in a city with members of a criminal gang (perhaps thieves or assassins). Bribes are standard for such contacts. Rolls can also be made to make a variety of illegal deals within this underworld culture, to find certain people or be introduced to an important figure.

Trap Knowledge: The character is able, on a CRAFT roll, to detect and disarm traps of many kinds, from spring-loaded poison traps on chests, to dead-fall pits lined with sharpened stakes (something the Romans called 'lilies'). He can also manufacture and set these kinds of traps. Typically a CRAFT roll is required.

Turn A Profit: The character is a wheeler-dealer, a merchant who has plenty of experience in barter and trade. An unskilled character can sell an item at one of two prices: half price if used, or one-tenth if broken and in need of repair. The character with Turn A Profit can usually improve on these prices, and can get full price for a used item and one-quarter of the price for a broken, but repairable, item. When this character tries to sell something as new, he will rarely lose money, nearly always turning some kind of profit or (at the bare minimum) breaking even. Outside events may, however, affect the sale and cost the merchant valuable profit.

Two Attacks: The character is able to make two attacks in a single turn as long as these attacks are directed at two separate targets. One of the attacks is always made at -2.

Warcry: The character can work himself into a terrible frenzy with a ritual war cry that might scare his opponent and give himself courage. A warcry must be screamed while engaging a fresh opponent, and costs him 1 point of FATE. It provides him with a +2 to hit against any opponent(s) for 1-6 combat rounds.

Work Horse: The character can use this skill to teach a horse some useful 'tricks', of a realistic nature. Perhaps coming at a whistle, hold at the very last moment when told so, be very still, overcome its fear for some things, not panicking when wounded, attacking other horses at a command, etc. This skill also allows someone to have a calming effect on horses and their cousins. The number of tricks a character can teach his horse is equal to his LEARNING score, many take a good deal of time to teach.

OTHER ACTIONS

Chasing and Running

Humans walk at 10 yards per round and run at 20 yds per round. Monsters and animals walk at human speed, but have their own run speed (noted in their description). It's easy to see who will outdistance another during a chase. Often it is easiest to boil a chase down to a single roll. The character makes a MIGHT roll to gain on, or flee from, an opponent. Subtract 2 if the opponent runs at 30yds/rd, subtract 3 if the opponent runs at 45yds/rd and subtract 4 if the opponent runs at 60yds/rd. The GM can add other bonuses, too, based on the situation. Fleeing from a cavalryman, for example, the character might run into woods, thus gaining an extra +2. The fleeing character might have a good head start, giving him a +1, and so on.



Climbing

Characters face a whole host of vertical challenges! Pits, cliffs and fortress-walls are just some of the things that a character might wish to scale. A character can climb 6 feet per round. To climb a typical obstacle he must roll 2d6 every round, add his MIGHT score and achieve a score of 10 or more. Failure indicates the character is in trouble and is stuck! Roll again at -2. If this is failed he falls from midway up the climb!

Falling

Anyone falling 10 feet or more suffers 1D6 damage, plus 4 points of damage for every additional 10 feet past the first.

Jumping

A character can jump 3 feet vertically or 6 feet horizontally with a run up. To jump a distance up to double this, the adventurer can make a MIGHT roll. If his result is 10 or over then he succeeds.

Darkness

The absence of light seriously inhibits the actions of a character. Every action he takes (including combat) suffers a penalty of -4 and his vision is restricted to only a few yards. A burning torch will give one hours worth of light that will illuminate an area up to 30 feet across (10 feet if placed or dropped onto the ground), a candle will also last an hour, but illuminate only 10 feet. Metal oil lanterns will burn for three hours and, like torches, illuminate an area up to 30 feet across (6 feet if placed or dropped onto the ground). The houses of the wealthy can be illuminated with small clay pots of oil that have their own wicks, but these devices are impractical for use in the great outdoors. Most poor people sleep during the hours of darkness.

Drowning

Any character can hold his breath under water for 2 rounds. For every round after the second, he must roll his MIGHT. This third round requires that the player exceed 10. The fourth must exceed 11, the fifth must exceed 12, the sixth must exceed 13 and the seventh and subsequent rolls must exceed 14. Failure indicates choking or drowning, with the adventurer suffering 4 points of damage per round.

Persuasion & Deception

An character might want to convince another character to do something, or lie to another character. To determine if these attempts succeed or not, the player must roll his adventurer's FATE. A typical persuasion or 'con' requires the player to equal or exceed 10. Allow a bonus to this roll if the character offers an appropriate bribe.

Poison

The threat of poison can come from many places, in a poisoned cup of wine, from a secret needle guarding a treasure or from the fangs of a cobra. A typical poison will do 1 point of damage as soon as it enters the character's bloodstream, and he must make an immediate FATE roll or suffer full damage. If this is the case, each minute after it enters his bloodstream it will do an additional point of damage up to a maximum of its Potency, which is typically 2d+8. If the FATE roll succeeds then the victim only suffers 1d6 more points of damage and feels a bit unwell.

Searching

Adventurers may need to search an area for traps, for clues or for a lost item. The Game Master asks each player where his character is searching, and then makes a FATE roll accordingly. A typical 'hidden object'



(whether a secret door, pit trap or gemstone) requires the character to succeed in a FATE roll that equals or exceeds 10. The GM may want to make this roll for the player, thus keeping the result a secret - his character would not know if failed to find something that he didn't know existed. Especially small or very well hidden items should be more difficult to find (add a penalty of -1, -2 or -3).

Concealment

In a contest of stealth, one character attempting to hide from another, the character looking out for the other must make a FATE roll and attempt to equal or exceed 10. If he succeeds he spots the concealed character. The referee should of course conceal this roll from the players, since the adventurers should not be aware that they did not see someone if the player fails his roll. Note that if the object or person being hidden has the benefit of deep shadows or darkness, then the character will suffer a -2 penalty. Characters with Hiding get an additional -2 bonus.

Moving Silently

Any attempt to remain silent while moving is always difficult, and the character attempting this must roll his FATE to overcome a difficulty of 10. This technique can be used to sneak up on someone from behind, thus giving the character the advantage of surprise (see below). Characters with Silent Movement do not need to roll.

Surprise

The GM must decide when surprise is achieved by the player characters, by non-player characters or by monsters. Obviously common sense plays a large part in this. Be fair. Surprise usually gives the surprising side a free round during which the monsters or characters can attack, flee or carry out some other action before the opposition realises what is going on and retaliates. In some circumstances, where the surprising monster or character is within striking distance of his opponent, a bonus of +3 on the to-hit roll can be awarded.

TRAVEL

...there were hair-curling stories about the road at night. Spectral legions who marched in eerie silence at your side, and when the moon rose, vanished. Eyeless wanderers who approached ... begging for a drink, and whose faces, when they raised their heads, were so hideous that all who saw them perished at the sight

Rosemary Rowe, The Germanicus Mosaic

Adventures often require travel. In the province of Britannia, travel is made easy by the army's network of straight roads that link fort with fort and allow rapid deployment of forces to any new trouble-spots - and let's face it, in unruly Britannia, anywhere might suddenly become a trouble spot!

Civilians travelling to another town or to a vicus will need money, a bag or two (to hold equipment and rations), a good cape, some hobnailed boots and a friendly house at the intended destination. There are few inns, and so travellers often stay with friends, acquaintances, colleagues or (in extreme circumstances) family relations. They will be expected to pay a little toward their own upkeep.

There *are* inns on the roads, typically 15 miles apart, but many of these are government run mansios (postal stations) that will provide travellers with board and lodgings for a hefty fee (double the normal rate). Mansios are fully equipped to service the military couriers and their horses, who use them. Within towns there may be several courtyarded inns, with stables, a heated room or two for well-paying guests,



and a common room/dining area. Meals are available, as are basic entertainments (mixing with other guests, drinking, gambling etc.). Some may have courtesans on the payroll upstairs, and in small stop-overs, these may even include the innkeeper's wife and daughters.

Every 5 miles or so on busy sections of roadway are government mutatio, rest-stops providing little more than stabling, a smithy and a fresh mount for the military couriers. With continual remounts, they can reach Londinium from Eboracum in only 10 hours (a journey of 200 miles that would take a normal mounted traveller over a week to complete).

Although the Roman army is responsible for law and order, there are dangers from bandits and thieves. A traveller alone is in peril, and it is more common for a party to travel together - deterring brigands. Along the roads are occasional mansios, shrines, shops and inns as well as watch-towers, manned by auxiliaries from a nearby fort. The watch-towers act as symbols of power, but also as security stations, deterring brigands from moving along the roadways.

Hand-carts, wagons and carriages trundle along the roads, pulled by horses and by oxen. Donkeys carry heavy loads in panniers, and of course there are many folk walking to town with their goods on their back. Wealthy individuals may be carried in a litter by their house slaves, though not for a great distance. And there are no Roman chariots on these roads, such things are only seen in the circus at Camulodunum (the only circus in Britannia). A wealthy family travelling together might hire a carruca dormitoria, a large covered wagon in which everyone can sleep, which saves on the cost of staying overnight at an inn.

Travel Times

<i>Method of Travel</i>	<i>Typical Speed</i>
Walking	15 miles/day
Military Unit Marching	20 miles/day
Horseback, Civilian	20 miles/day
Horseback, Courier	100 miles/day*
Wagon	10 miles/day
• Speeds are on a Roman road. • Travelling across-country, reduce distance by $\frac{1}{4}$. • Travelling across rough country (woods, hills), reduce distance by $\frac{1}{2}$. • Travelling in mountains or swamp, reduce distance travelled <i>to</i> $\frac{1}{4}$ of that stated. *Remounts every 5 miles, rider must rest one full day after. Speed can be doubled at risk to horse and rider. Courier speeds only possible on a well-travelled Roman road.	





CHARACTER IMPROVEMENT

Although player characters begin **43AD** as competent and seasoned Roman legionaries, they may still learn, develop and grow, gaining in status and gaining new skills. Skills in **43AD** are of great value since there are not many of them. In addition, each provides a unique ability that is totally unavailable to characters who do not possess it. A starting character may begin the game with up to three skills, but no more. To gain any more he must either join a religious collegia (IX Religion), or gain promotion to a junior officer's post. His MIGHT, HITS or FATE may also be increased, but for that, a character must make great sacrifices to the gods.

The ultimate goal of any legionary is to prove one's mettle and make it up through the ranks to the position of centurion. Centurions receive a fortune in pay compared to that of a common soldier, with a status in Roman society to match. They become in-effect, minor nobles, with a fancy house, slaves and servants and of course the respect of the troops below them and the generals above them.

Legionary						
Optio	Artificer	Actuarius	Signifer	Beneficarius	Medicus	Tesserarius
Centurion						

The diagram (above) shows how a legionary must first gain promotion to an intermediary level of officers before he can make it to centurion. These junior officer positions are all relatively equal, and a candidate for the centurionate must first have served as at least **four** of the officers listed in the chart. It does not matter what order he takes those posts in, it does not matter which ones he leaves out.

Gaining Glory

To gain promotion to a position, a PC must gain accolades, awards and decorations from his superiors. Glory may be gained after each mission, successful or not. To gain promotion the character needs an accumulated total of **15 Glory**. Each promotion after that requires another 15 points of accumulated Glory.

Each **individual** Glory award may be high enough for a decoration, presented to the PC on the parade ground. These have no real game effect, but are always worth sestertii in a crisis. On parade, the soldier will wear his armilla, torcs and phalerae. If more than one torc or phalera, they are hung from harnesses over the armour. Centurions are often bristling with these awards!

<i>Character Participation</i>	<i>Glory Award</i>
<i>Participation in Failed Mission</i>	<i>0</i>
<i>Participation in Successful Mission</i>	<i>5</i>
<i>Participation in Very Successful Mission</i>	<i>8</i>
<i>Outstanding Contribution</i>	<i>3</i>
<i>Saving a Comrade from Certain Death</i>	<i>3</i>
<i>Killing a Notable Enemy in Combat</i>	<i>4</i>

<i>Glory</i>	<i>Decoration</i>	<i>Cash Value</i>
<i>8</i>	<i>Armilla (bracelet)</i>	<i>60</i>
<i>10</i>	<i>Torc (neck ring)</i>	<i>200</i>
<i>14</i>	<i>Phalera (patterned disc)</i>	<i>300</i>



The Junior Officer Positions

Actuarius

An actuarius is a legionary who also works as a military scribe, handling papyrus records and wax tablets, taking down orders and filing information away in the headquarters building.

Skill: Forgery.

Artificer

An artificer is a legionary who also works as a military engineer, responsible for helping plan and build walls, defences and siege works. His ability to defend a fort with concealed traps provides the artificer with his skill. **Skill:** Trap Knowledge.

Medicus

A medicus is a legionary who also works as a surgeon in the hospital, or on campaign. He will be assisted by regular legionaries serving as wound dressers. **Skill:** Field Surgery.

Optio

An optio is a fighting legionary who also deputizes for the centurion, and acts as a sort of company sergeant major. He spends a good deal of time working closely with his centurion. **Skill:** Double Strike.

Tesserarius

This legionary is a guard sergeant, ensuring the century has the proper passwords, checking sentries and arranging for small fatigue parties. **Skill:** Shield Smash

Beneficarius

The beneficarius is a legionary who also acts as a police official or customs inspector amongst the local civilians. On official business he carries a symbolic decorated spear. Beneficarii can be detached for long periods far from their home base. **Skill:** Detect Lies

Signifer

The signifer is responsible for the century's standard, carried on a pole onto the battlefield, but usually kept safe in camp within the shrine of the standards. The signifer carries out some administration and accounting duties, and in full-scale battles is right at the front leading on the men. **Skill:** Two Attacks.



NON-PLAYER CHARACTERS

The player characters are not the only inhabitants of ancient Britannia. Although the population is diverse, there are two fundamental types of non player character (NPC) in **43AD**: the Named and the Unnamed.

Unnamed Characters

The Unnamed NPCs are all those extras, spear-carriers, faceless hords, and shop-keepers. They have no great impact on the course of events and are well below the PCs in terms of scores and general ability. They form an entire population of other folk, craftsmen and government officials, hunters, thieves, beggars, scribes, merchants, sailors and others. These people cannot easily compete with the player characters in terms of attributes and abilities. They are, quite bluntly, not as important. Without significant combat ability, these non-player characters are lesser individuals. The GM can utilise them as he wishes within the adventures, and can make good use of these characters to create a feeling of continuity within a campaign. Because of their lower status, these NPCs have much lower scores. There are two main subdivisions within the category of Unnamed NPC: Commoners and Professionals.

Commoners are farmers, craftsmen, tribal peasant, townsmen and labourers, nomad herdsmen, fishermen and anybody else without significant education, and living in relative poverty who uses his hands and his body to earn his living. A commoner has these attributes:

MIGHT	1
FATE	2-6
HITS	7-12 (1d+6)
CRAFT	2-6
LEARNING	1

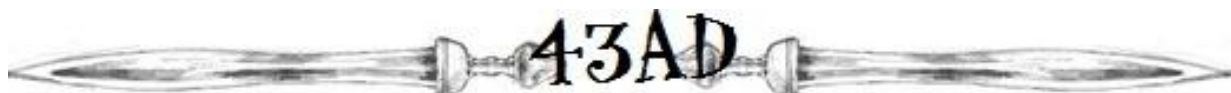
Professionals are members of the Roman elite, members of the educated class trained by rhetoricians and philosophers, as well as less wealthy townsmen able to enjoy an education and enter a professional career such as doctor, scribe, government clerk, architect, teacher etc. A professional has these attributes:

MIGHT	1
FATE	2-6
HITS	7-12 (1d+6)
CRAFT	1
LEARNING	2-6

Referees can now simply roll up a suitable NPC as the need arises within an adventure. Need to know the attributes of that wagon-drover? He's a commoner, so roll his FATE, HITS and CRAFT. Don't bother with a name, these NPCs are typically 'nameless'. Alternatively, the referee can utilise an even faster method of NPC creation. To really cut-down set-up or in-play time to a minimum where NPCs are concerned, the referee can simply decide whether the character is a commoner or a professional and roll 1 die. He re-rolls a result of '1'. This single result equates to the NPC's FATE, HITS and either CRAFT or LEARNING score. This creation method is entirely optional. Note that HITS must be added to 4 before play is joined.

A fast creation NPC might simply be abbreviated in the referee's notes to **Wagon-Drover (Commoner 4/8)**. The number 4 represents his FATE and CRAFT, 8 is double that and represents his HITS. His MIGHT and LEARNING are automatically 1 and so need not be included in the notes. Alternatively: **Tax Collector (Professional 6/10)**. The number 6 represents his FATE and LEARNING, 12 is double that and represents his HITS. His MIGHT and CRAFT are automatically 1 and so need not be included in the notes.

A common NPC is the **Tribal Levy Warrior 2/8**. His CRAFT and LEARNING are 1, HIS MIGHT and FATE are 2. He has a spear +2 and a knife and shield. His COMBAT is +5, his AV 0.



Named Characters

As if it were an epic novel, the **Named NPCs** are primary characters, either allies or enemies of the player characters, and probably equal in stature, ability and detail to them, too. Members of the legions can be created quickly and easily using the list-pick method found in chapter III Creating Military Characters, or the character templates can be used (below). The Game Master is encouraged to use the templates upon which to base the game statistics of his NPCs. Templates are included for Roman soldiers and tribal heroes as needed. These are basic templates that can be changed, tweaked or radically altered to suit a particular situation. Lists of sample legionaries and tribal warriors can also be found below. References to 'Honour' are relevant only if the supplement **Warband** is being used. If detailed rules for the creation of British heroes and tribal druids are needed, then refer to that **43AD** supplement.

Tribal Named Characters

<i>Tribal Levy</i>				[COMBAT+5]
MIGHT 2	CRAFT	2	SKILLS Evade, Hiding	
FATE 2	LEARNING	1	WEAPONS: Spear +2, Shield +1, Sling +2	
HITS 8	ARMOUR	-		
PROTECTIVE MAGIC: 1pt				

<i>Low-Level Tribal Warrior</i>				[COMBAT + 6]
MIGHT 3	CRAFT	2	SKILLS Hard to Kill	
FATE 4	LEARNING	1	WEAPONS: Spear +2, Long Sword+2,	
HITS 12	ARMOUR	2d	Shield+1, 2x Javelins +2, Helm	
PROTECTIVE MAGIC: 2pts				

<i>Average Tribal Warrior</i>				[COMBAT + 7]
MIGHT 4	CRAFT	1	SKILLS Killing Blow, Evade	
FATE 4	LEARNING	3	WEAPONS: Spear +2, Sword+2,	
HITS 16	ARMOUR	2d	Shield+1, 2x Javelins +2, Helm,	
PROTECTIVE MAGIC: 3pts				Chainmail

<i>Witch</i>				[COMBAT + 1]
MIGHT 1	CRAFT	1	SKILLS Healing Herbs	
FATE 3	LEARNING	3	WEAPONS: -	
HITS 16	ARMOUR	-	SPELLS Charm, Defixion, Brew Charm	
				Potion, Call the Dead

<i>Veteran Druid</i>				[COMBAT + 3]
MIGHT 1	CRAFT	2	SKILLS Detect Lies	
FATE 4	LEARNING	5	WEAPONS: Dagger +1, Spear +2	
HITS 16	ARMOUR	-	SPELLS Ban, Disguise, Dancing Harp	
PROTECTIVE MAGIC: 2pts				Oracle



Old Druid

[COMBAT + 4]

MIGHT 1	CRAFT	5	SKILLS Healing Herbs
FATE 6	LEARNING	5	WEAPONS: Dagger +1, Sword+3
HITS 17	ARMOUR	-	SPELLS Beast-tongue, Magic Fire
PROTECTIVE MAGIC: 3pts			Dancing Harp, Bless, Curse You

Hunter /Guide

[COMBAT + 5]

MIGHT 3	CRAFT	4	SKILLS Read Tracks, Silent Movement
FATE 2	LEARNING	1	WEAPONS: Dagger +1, 5 x Javelins +2
HITS 19	ARMOUR	-	

Roman Named Characters

Centurion

[COMBAT + 8]

MIGHT 5	CRAFT	2	SKILLS Two Attacks, Shield Smash,
FATE 2	LEARNING	2	HardKill, Field Surgery, Detect Lies
HITS 20	ARMOUR	5d	WEAPONS: Shortsword+2, Dagger+1
			Chainmail+D, Helm, Shield+1, Greaves

Young Tribune

[COMBAT + 5]

MIGHT 3	CRAFT	1	SKILLS Seek Audience, Seduction
FATE 4	LEARNING	6	WEAPONS: Shortsword+2, Dagger +1
HITS 18	ARMOUR	3d	Breastplate, Helmet

Gangster

[COMBAT + 6]

MIGHT 5	CRAFT	1	SKILLS Streetwise, Hard to Kill
FATE 3	LEARNING	1	WEAPONS: Dagger +1
HITS 14	ARMOUR	1D	

Powerful Roman Politician

[COMBAT + 1]

MIGHT 1	CRAFT	1	SKILLS Organise, Forgery
FATE 6	LEARNING	6	WEAPONS: none
HITS 12	ARMOUR	-	

Assassin

[COMBAT + 6]

MIGHT 5	CRAFT	3	SKILLS Killing Blow, Silent Movement
FATE 3	LEARNING	2	WEAPONS: Dagger +1, Poison
HITS 15	ARMOUR	-	

Doctor

[COMBAT + 1]

MIGHT 1	CRAFT	1	SKILLS First Aid, Field Surgery
FATE 4	LEARNING	5	WEAPONS: none
HITS 17	ARMOUR	-	



Street Urchin

[COMBAT + 1]

MIGHT	1	CRAFT	1	SKILLS	Hiding
FATE	6	LEARNING	1	WEAPONS:	Knife +0
HITS	6	ARMOUR	-		

Influential Roman Lady

[COMBAT + 1]

MIGHT	1	CRAFT	2	SKILLS	Seduction, Seek Audience
FATE	5	LEARNING	2	WEAPONS:	none
HITS	10	ARMOUR	-		

Magic for Characters

There are rules and guidelines for the casting of magic spells in chapter X Using Horror. To create an NPC spell-caster, a druid or a witch, the GM should consider them to be professionals, with MIGHT and CRAFT 1, LEARNING and FATE between 2-6 and HITS of between 8-13. Tweak these as needed, adding a point of CRAFT or MIGHT if needed, etc. Add one skill appropriate the character's personality or situation. Next, allocate the witch or druid with a number of spells based on their age, only two if young, 3 or 4 if more experienced. Lists of spells for druids and witches is provided in chapter X.

Finally, allocate **Protective Magic** for tribal warriors and druids; 1 point for someone young, 2 for someone experienced, 3 for a veteran. Only tribal warriors and druids have access to protective magic, which allows them to temporarily increase their Armour Value in battle.

A Band of Challenging Tribal Warriors

Name	Attributes						Skills	Kit	Protective Magic	Combat/AV
	MIGHT	FATE	CRAFT	LEARN	HITS	HONOUR				
Catos	4	4	1	1	15	5	Silent Move, Killing Blow	Helm, Chainmail, Spear, 2 x Javelins, Shield, Sword	2	8/2
Senovara	5	4	1	1	16	1	Hiding, Find Direction	Spear, Knife, Shield, Sling	1	8/-
Esca	2	4	1	1	13	6	Read Tracks, Find Direction	Helm, Spear, Sword, 2 x Javelins, Shield	2	6/1
Vellaunos	5	3	1	1	13	6	Killing Blow, Read Tracks	Helm, Spear, 2 x Javelins, Sword, Shield	3	9/1
Lucos	6	4	1	1	18	4	Warcry, Killing Blow	Sword, Shield	3	10/-
Selgos	4	6	1	1	17	2	Hard to Kill, Warcry	Spear, Sword, Shield	3	8/-
Lugodoc	6	6	1	1	17	4	Evade, Hard to Kill	Sword, Shield	2	10/-
Dubnos	3	5	1	1	18	5	Work Horse, Hiding	Helm, Chainmail & Doubling, Spear, 2 x Javelins, Shield, Sword	2	7/3
Badvoc	4	3	1	1	20	4	Silent Move, Hiding	Sword, Shield	2	8/-
Broccanos	3	5	1	1	19	6	Far Throw, Hard to Kill	Helm, Chainmail, Spear, 2 x Javelins, Shield, Sword	3	7/2



A Squad of Legionaries

QUINTUS

MIGHT 4	FATE 3	CRAFT 1	LEARNING 2	HITS 15	COMBAT/AV	7/3
Legionary	Character: New Recruit		Origins: Italian Farmer/Labourer			
Appearance: Tall, slim, clean shaven with fair hair					Sestertii: 70	
Background: A stereotypical young Roman, brought up to believe in Rome’s given right to rule the known world. Proud, stern, self disciplined and devout who joined up to make his parents proud. But hasn’t drawn much blood or seen much death or defeat yet. “The right way is the Roman way.” He clashes with one of the optios in the legion.						
Skills: Carry Burden						
Kit Choice: Dagger & Shortsword, Segmented Armour, Helmet, Pilum, Curved Shield						

LUCULLUS

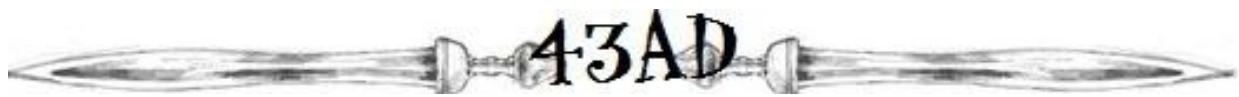
MIGHT 4	FATE 4	CRAFT 1	LEARNING 1	HITS 20	COMBAT/AV	7/3
Legionary	Character: Killer		Origins: Hispanic Craftsman			
Appearance: Short, lean hungry look , stubble with dark hair.				Sestertii: 120		
Background: Joined up because the legions pay steady money! Lucullus is stern to cruel, and very superstitious. Death is his trade, the spray of warm blood on his face brings him sadistic satis-faction. "Why are we standing around, lets get stuck in." He once made a senior tribune look stupid - making an enemy.						
Skills: Killing Blow, Evaluate						
Kit Choice: Dagger & Shortsword, Segmented Armour, Helmet, Pilum, Curved Shield						

AULUS

MIGHT 4	FATE 3	CRAFT 1	LEARNING 1	HITS 17	COMBAT/AV	7/2
Legionary	Character: Killer		Origins: German Landless Poor			
Appearance: Tall, stocky man, clean shaven with mousey hair and a very old scar from above his left temple running to the left cheek.				Sestertii: 30		
Background: Aulus joined to find a soldier who committed a crime against his family. He is a heavy drinker and carries a hate deep in his heart for a grievance done. He can turn from the life and soul of the party to a wild-eyed monster if the wrong word is said by anyone. "I'll have his head!"						
Skills: Killing Blow, Warcry, Find Direction						
Kit Choice: Dagger & Shortsword, Chainmail, Helmet, Spear, Flat Shield						

GNAEUS

MIGHT 2	FATE 6	CRAFT 1	LEARNING 1	HITS 13	COMBAT/AV	5/2
Legionary	Character: New Recruit		Origins: Syrian Landless Poor			
Appearance: Tall, lean , clean shaven with dark hair, eyes of a hunter that follow you around.				Sestertii: 20		
Background: Joined up to escape bad debts. He is proud, clever and publicly devout. “Would you like to put some money on that?” He is in trouble with a local gangster who has spread bad rumours about him.						
Skills: Find Direction, Killing Shot						
Kit Choice: Dagger & Shortsword, Chainmail, Helmet, Bow, Quiver & 12 arrows, Small Shield						



DECIMUS					
MIGHT 3	FATE 3	CRAFT 1	LEARNING 1	HITS 14	COMBAT/AV 6/2
Legionary	Character: Rogue		Origins: Greek landless poor		
Appearance: Short, stocky , clean shaven with dark hair.				Sestertii: 110	
Background: Joined up to avoid bad debts. Quick witted, clever and not too honest. “I’ll look after your purses boys as you go into battle.” A local merchant is an enemy, he has swindled him out of lots of money in the past.					
Skills: Find Direction, Turn a Profit, Open Lock					
Kit Choice: Dagger & Shortsword, Chainmail, Helmet, 3 x Javelins, Small Shield					

MANIUS					
MIGHT 4	FATE 2	CRAFT 1	LEARNING 1	HITS 18	COMBAT/AV 7/2
Legionary	Character: Callous Survivor		Origins: Celtic free slave		
Appearance: Tall, stocky , clean shaven with red hair, scar on neck.				Sestertii: 90	
Background: Manius needed money and joined the legions. He is quick tempered, moody on drink and honest. “Last one in is a sissy!” He's made an enemy of another soldier.					
Skills: Hard to Kill, Silent Movement					
Kit Choice: Dagger & Shortsword, Chainmail, Helmet, Spear, Flat Shield					

FORTUNATUS					
MIGHT 3	FATE 5	CRAFT 2	LEARNING 2	HITS 15	COMBAT/AV 6/2
Legionary	Character: Thinker		Origins: North African landless poor		
Appearance: Short, thin , unshaven with dark hair and smashed and broken nose, nasty scar on left temple.				Sestertii: 40	
Background: Joined in order to earn money for his starving family. Jolly, always joking, but very superstitious. Often in the middle of the fight, slightly reckless with his own safety . “Boys I have found wine!" One of the 'more by-the-book' soldiers really hates Fortunatus with a passion.					
Skills: Find Direction					
Kit Choice: Dagger & Shortsword, Chainmail, Helmet, Bow, Quiver & 12 arrows, Small Shield					

OLD APPIUS					
MIGHT 6	FATE 5	CRAFT 1	LEARNING 2	HITS 17	COMBAT/AV 8/3
Legionary	Character: Old Veteran		Origins: Italian farmer/labourer		
Appearance: Tall, stocky man , stubble with dark hair peppered with grey.				Sestertii: 60	
Background: Appius' father was a soldier too. He is stern, sceptical and morose, a non-believer in the Gods. Death is his trade through he takes no satisfaction in it anymore but he knows little else in life. “Wait lads, hold the line ” He served under a centurion who backed from a fight, but Appius stepped up and led his squad forward. That centurion is in the legion and hates Old Appius.					
Skills: Carry Burden					
Kit Choice: Dagger & Shortsword, Segmented Armour, Helmet, Pilum, Curved Shield					



ANIMALS

Since Roman times, many native species have been driven to extinction, while other species are later imports. The larger animals of the Roman period, living in woodland and on heaths, include foxes, wolves, bears, wild-cat, poisonous adders and wild boar. Wild goat, hares, hedgehogs, deer (both roe and red), polecat, badger and red squirrel pose less of a threat to hunters and travellers. Beaver and otter live in many of the rivers, whilst the salmon and pike (Britain's biggest fish) are also to be found in rivers and lakes. Of the larger birds, rooks, ravens, golden eagles, buzzards and hawks rule the skies. Animals **not** found in Roman Britain include: racoons, chipmunks, possums, grey squirrels, swans, fallow deer and rabbits! Pheasants were introduced by the Romans as a game bird, and may have spread to most areas of upland Britain by 100 AD.

Animals are described by two values: MIGHT and HITS, the first is a measure of physical ability and combat skill, while the second measures stamina, as with human PCs. Note that player characters **cannot** save their Combat Effects when fighting animals. Animals are not armoured, although some are able to carry out more than one attack in a single round. Humans walk at 10 yards per round and run at 20yds per round. Animals walk at human speed (10 yds per round) but run at the speed noted under their description.

Bear

MIGHT 10 HITS 20 2 Attacks, Speed 30yds

Bears inhabit the forest-covered mountains and are loners, who may attack humans if roused to anger.

Wild Boar

MIGHT 7 HITS 14 2 Attacks, Speed 30yds

Wild boar are hunted by nobleman for sport, they are vicious wild pigs living in scrubland and forests, and they can kill a man with their long tusks.

Deer

MIGHT 6 HITS 8 1 Attack, Speed 60yds

Deer live in woodland and flee from humans.

Goat

MIGHT 2 HITS 4 1 Attack, Speed 30yds

The wild goat or antelope will only attack in the most unusual of circumstances.

Horse/Donkey

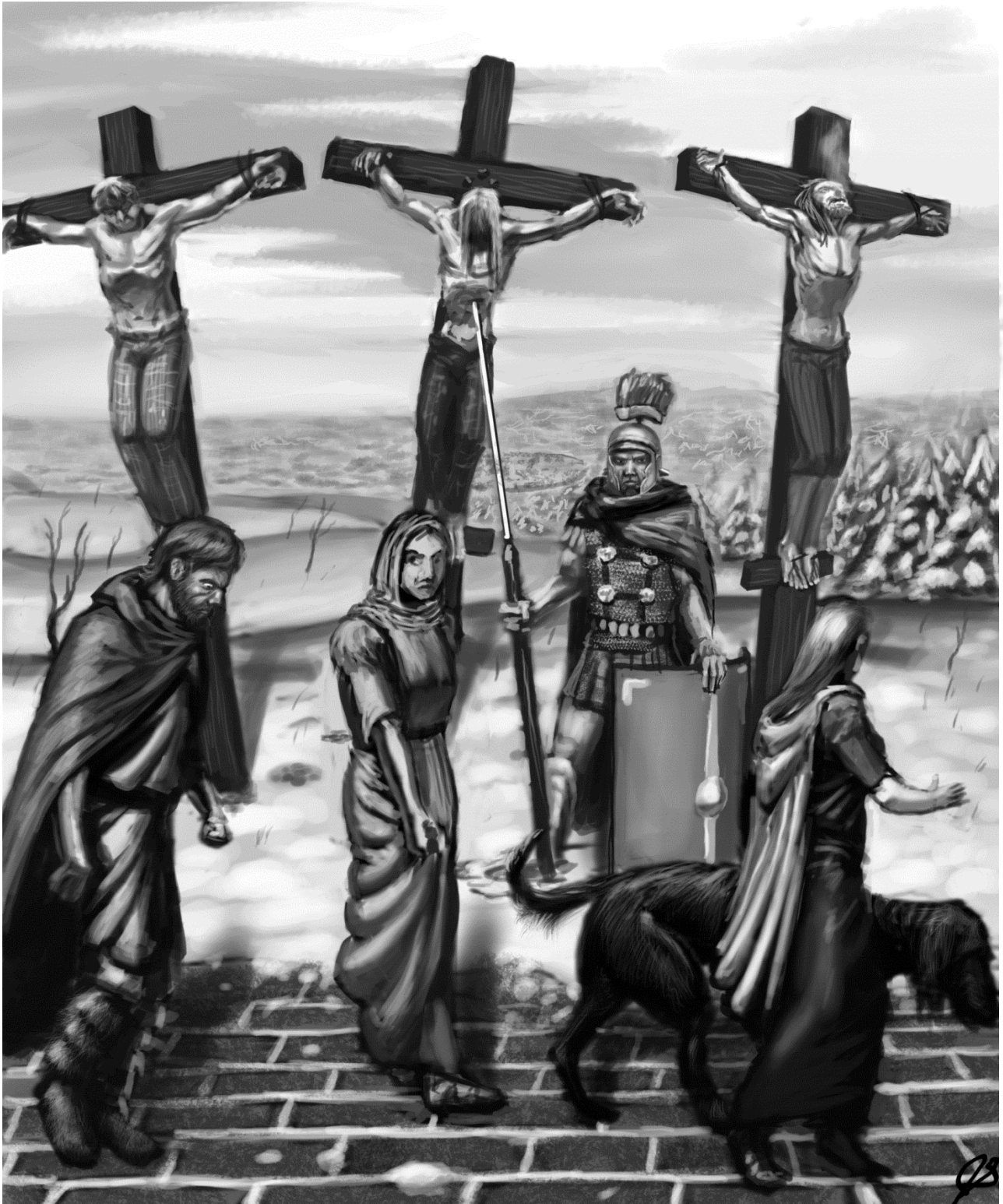
MIGHT 8 HITS 20 1 Attack, Speed 60yds

Both horses and donkeys can be found in Roman Britain. They rarely attack unless severely provoked.

Wolf

MIGHT 8 HITS 12 1 Attack, Speed 30yds

Wolves operate in small packs, rarely attacking humans unless desperate.



VII ROMAN OCCUPATION

Nestled among the mud streets and huts of Camulodnum, Gretta's house was well-furnished inside with imported furniture and pottery that represented more wealth than Lugda had ever seen.

'Good, I've been waiting for a new girl,' said Gretta. 'How old are you?'

'Fifteen,' said Lugda.

Gretta pointed to a small room with a pile of blankets on the floor. 'That's your room,' she said.

'Don't take any money, that's done beforehand. They know the rules so be accommodating. Learn a bit of Latin, too, they like that. But don't talk too much.'

Gretta was older but far more attractive than Lugda. Her hair was the kind of elaborate knot that needed a slave to make properly and her dress covered just enough bust to make her seemly. Lugda wondered if Gretta had once started out here, just like Lugda. Maybe Lugda would one day be like Gretta.

'The washroom is through there,' Gretta was saying. 'The soldiers stink but that doesn't mean we can't have standards of our own, don't you agree?'

'Yes,' said Lugda.

'And should they leave anything, a coin or a ring or something, you bring it here.' Gretta led Lugda to the threshold of a dark room where Lugda could just see a large table below an image carved from a panel of wood on the wall. 'If you can gather some of their seed, all the better. But be discreet. As far as they're concerned they're here for you, we are not here for them.'

'Is it a temple?' asked Lugda. 'To their gods or to ours?'

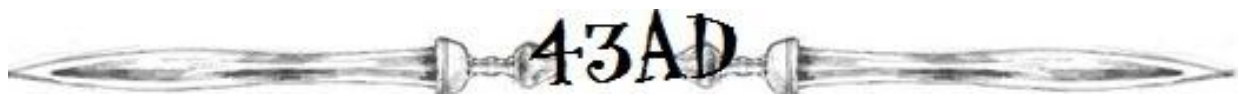
'The final rule,' said Gretta, fixing the girl with a stern eye. 'No questions.'

THE ROMANISATION BEGINS

The Roman conquest of Britan did not happen overnight and in fact it was never really completed. It took the armies many decades of conflict, diplomacy, road and city-building to push the northern border of this new province up into modern-day Scotland. The first gains were made by the general Aulus Plautius in 43 and 44 AD. He became governor over this new province, a stretch of territory from Kent to the border of modern-day Wales.







New governors arrived over time, and many took the legions further north, defeating the tribes there, forcing them to abandon their hillforts. They established new towns in the richer areas, with a series of forts for the auxiliary troops to protect them. A new road network followed this expansion, always linking the forts and the cities to the new territories. The tribal nobles and their warriors became landed gentry and adopted Roman ways, they became the new town senates and so retained some of the power they had enjoyed before the Roman invasion. Further north, as the province reached Brigantian territory in the 70's, towns and villas became rarer. Travellers heading north entered a military zone, a region of forts that continued to expand northwards until by 100 AD, the border lay between the Tyne and Solway rivers: the line of Hadrian's Wall. The map below shows these expansions and conquests.

WHO IS IN CONTROL?

The **governors** of Britain are members of Rome's elite senatorial class. During their careers, senators vie for many different political offices. The governorship of a province is one of the highest of these offices; because Britain is garrisoned by three legions (of which the governor is in total control) it is commanded only by men of outstanding political achievement. The governor (official term: *legatus Augusti propraetore*) usually serves for 3-5 years and is based at Londinium (the provincial capital from 60 AD). The governor controls all military matters, and is also the dispenser of justice within the province. The capital is also the seat of the **procurator**, the emperor's finance secretary, who manages the provincial treasury. Procurator and governor do not always see eye-to-eye (following the Boudican uprising, for example). Both have a small hard-working staff, run by a centurion (*princeps praetorii*) made of military clerks (*beneficarii*), slaves and freedmen. To assist the governor in his duties, a huge fort was built within the walls of Londinium by emperor Hadrian. The legionary troops detached there are at the governor's and procurator's disposal.

Campaign Suggestion

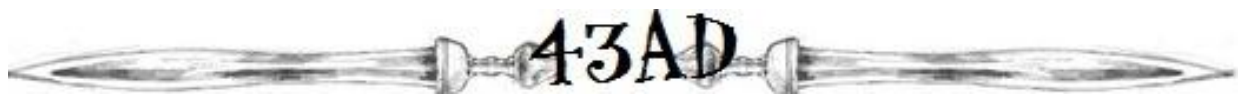
The PCs have been sent to the Londinium fort to serve the governor. They find that, amongst the normal duties of protection, message taking, tax collection and customs inspection, they are engaged in a covert war against the agents of the procurator. Londinium is currently split between these two factions. What secret does the governor have that the procurator wants to expose so badly?

The procurator collects taxes, pays the army and manages all imperial estates, such as lands, villas and mines. Mines are a very important source of revenue within a province. Perhaps the greatest perk to being a citizen is exemption from many taxes, the burden falls heavily on the local non-citizen Britons.

Literate soldiers from the admin section of legions (the *beneficarii*) also do duty on the governor's staff. These well-trained bureaucrats run the imperial postal service, collect the army's grain requisitions and organise the collection and transport of supplies and equipment for the army. *Mansios*, or government post stations, operate as bases from which these *beneficarii* work. The stations can range from small houses on roadsides, to large fortified complexes, with suites of rooms, under floor heating, baths, stables and offices... They serve as temporary billets for officers passing through, as collection points for taxes and supplies, and also relay stations for couriers on horseback.

That the Roman people should be subject to other people is contrary to divine law; the immortal gods have willed it to rule all nations.

Cicero, Phillipic 6.19

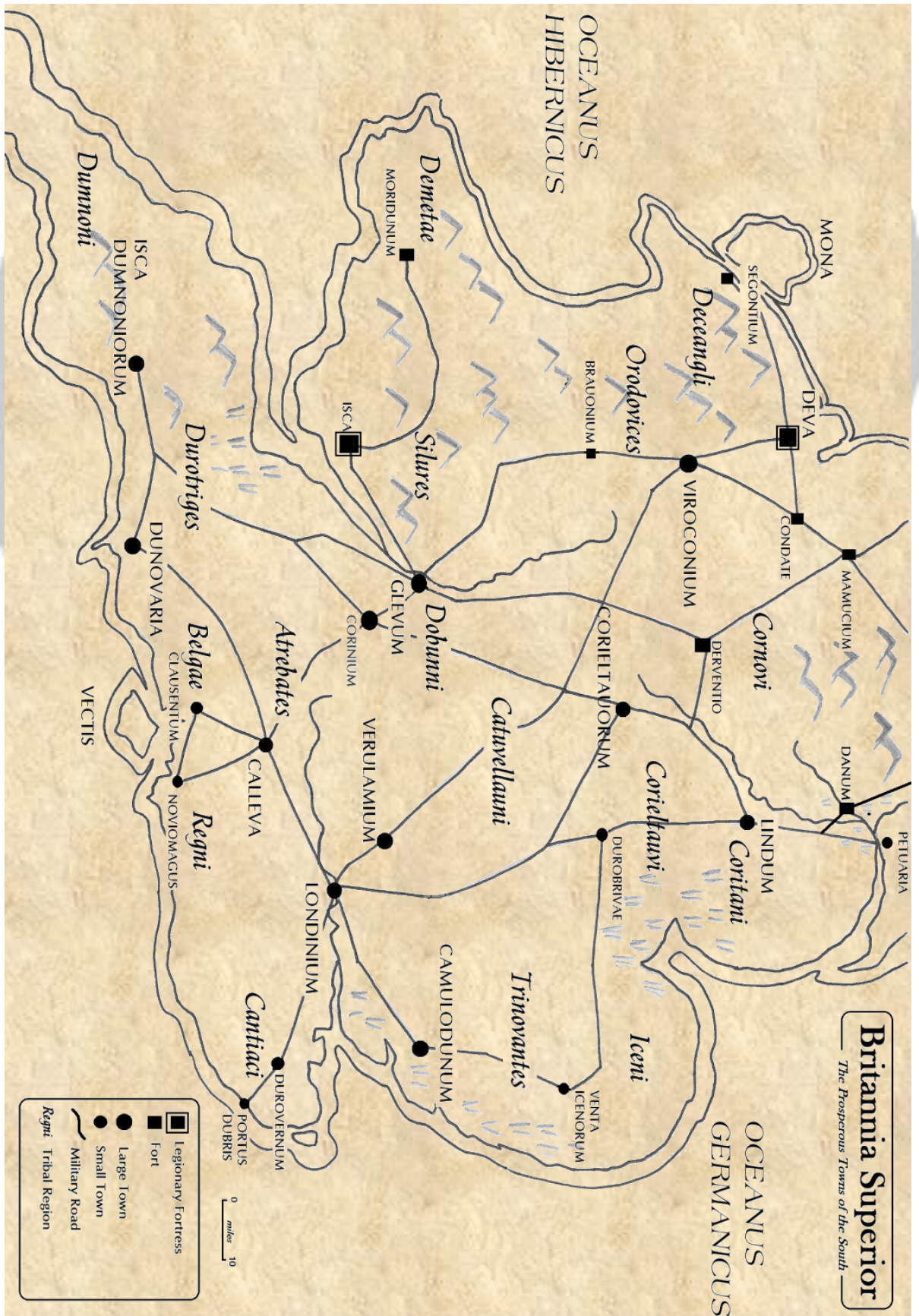


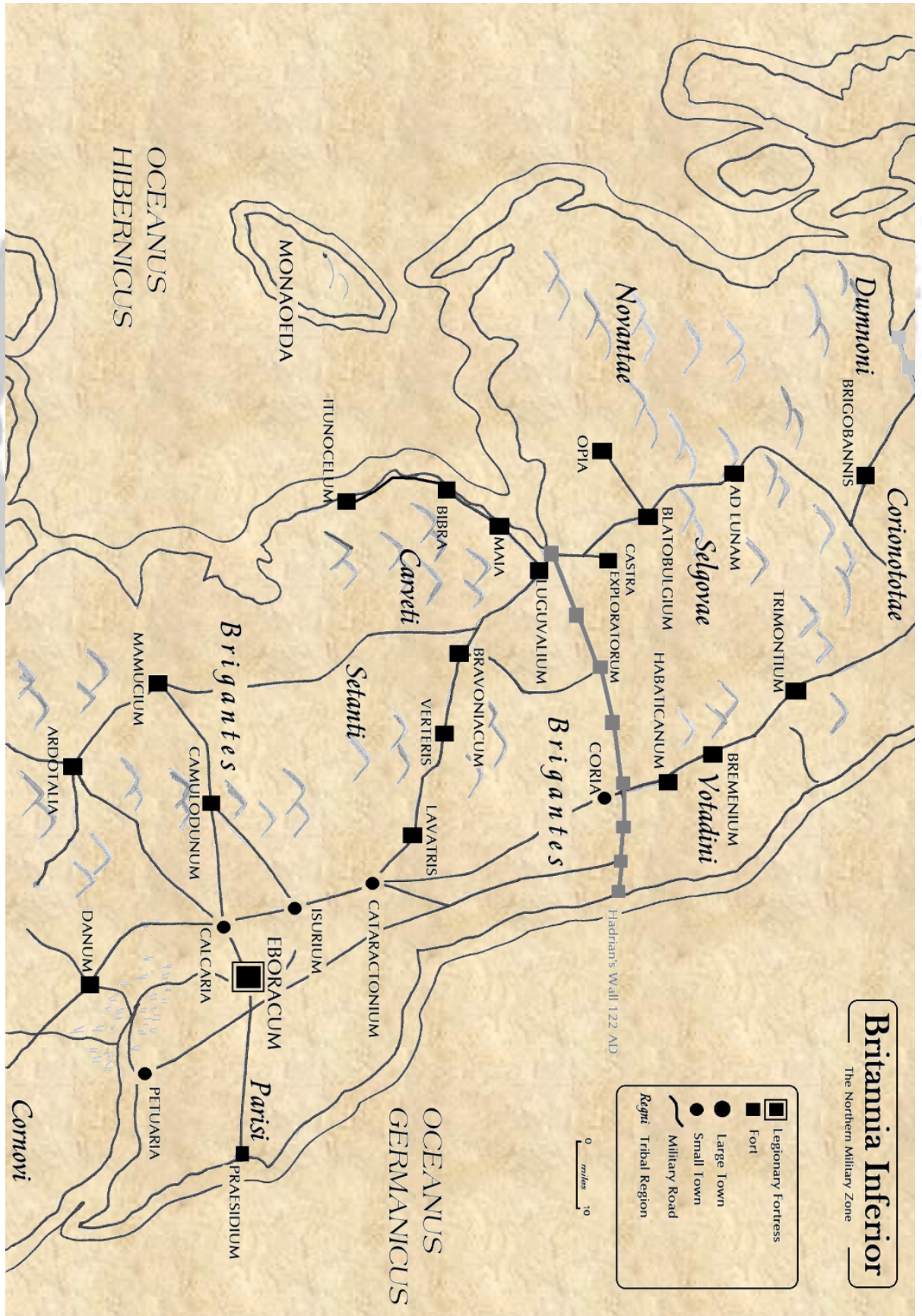
Governors of Britain

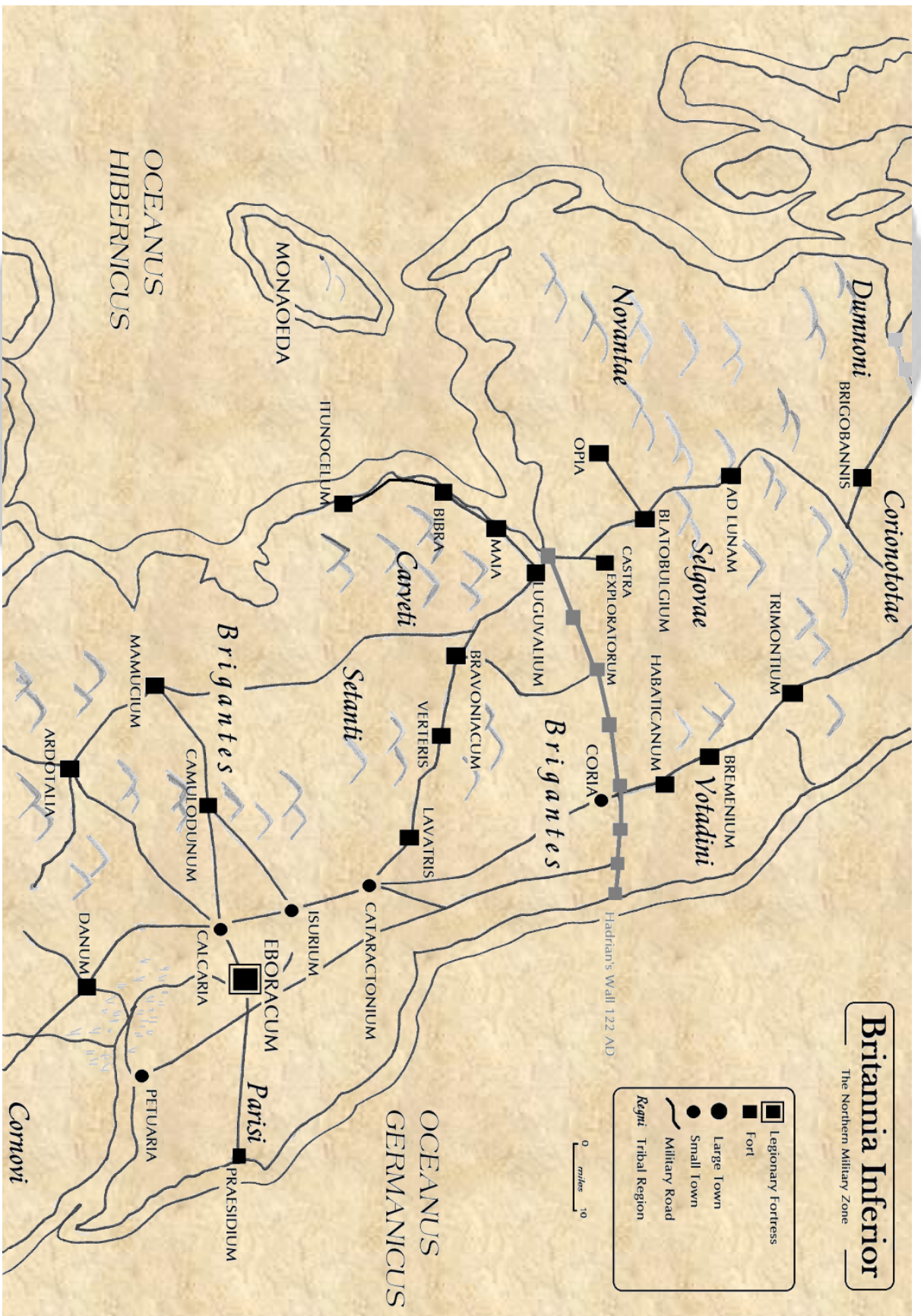
<i>Governor of Britain</i>	<i>Term of Office</i>
Aulus Plautius	43 - 47
Ostorius Scapula	47 - 52
Aulus Didius Gallus	52 - 57
Quintus Veranius	57 - 57
Gaius Suetonius Paulinus	58 - 62
Publius Petronius Turpilianus	62 - 63
Marcus Trebellius Maximus	63 - 69
Marcus Vettius Bolanus	69 - 71
Quintus Petillius Cerialis	71 - 74
Sextus Julius Frontinus	74 - 78
Gnaeus Julius Agricola	78 - 84
Sallustius Lucullus	84 - c. 89
Unknown	c. 89 - c. 96
Publius Metilius Nepos	c. 96 - c. 97
Tiberius Avidius Quietus	c. 97 - c. 101
Lucius Neratius Marcellus	c. 101 - c. 103
Unknown	c. 103 - 115
Marcus Appius Bradua	115 - 118
Quintus Pompeius Falco	118 - 122
Aulus Platorius Nepos	122 - c. 125
Trebius Germanus	c. 127
Sextus Julius Severus	c. 131 - c. 133
Publius Mummius Sisenna	c. 133 - c. 135
Quintus Lollius Urbicus	c. 138 - c. 144
Gnaeus Papirius Aelianus	c. 145 - c. 147
Unknown	c. 147 - c. 154
Gnaeus Julius Verus	c. 154 - c. 158
Longinus	c. 158- 161
Marcus Statius Priscus	c. 161 - c. 162
Sextus Calpurnius Agricola	c. 163 - c. 166
Unknown	c. 166 - 175
Quintus Antistius Adventus	c. 175 - c. 178
Caerellius Priscus	c. 178 - c. 181
Ulpianus Marcellus	c. 181 - c. 185
Publius Helvius Pertinax	c. 185 - c. 187
Unknown	c. 187 - c. 191
Decimus Clodius Albinus	c. 191 - c. 197
Virius Lupus	197 - c. 201
Marcus Antius Crescens Calpurnianus	c. 202
Gaius Valerius Pudens	c. 202 - c. 205
Lucius Alfenus Senecio	c. 205 - c. 207

Emperors of Rome

Emperor of Rome	Term of Office
Julio-Claudians	
Augustus ('Octavian')	27 BC-14 AD
Tiberius	14-37
Gaius ('Caligula')	37-41
Claudius	41-54
Nero	54-68
Year of the Four Emperors	
Galba	68-9
Otho	69
Vitellius	69
Vespasian	69-79
Flavians	
Vespasian	69-79
Titus	79-81
Domitian	81-96
Nerva	96-8
Trajan	98-117
Hadrian	117-38
Antonines	
Antoninus Pius	138-61
Marcus Aurelius	161-80
Lucius Verus	161-9
Commodus	180-92
Pertinax	193
Didius Julianus	193
Severans and their rivals	
Septimius Severus	193-211
Pescennius Niger	193-4
Clodius Albinus	193-7
Geta	211-2
Caracalla	211-7







THE TOWNS

As parts of Britain were conquered, the tribal kingdoms were turned into administrative units, and the tribes were encouraged to move to lowland settlements, either British oppida that could be converted into Roman towns, or into purpose-built Roman developments. Most hill-forts and duns were abandoned, and this has made administration and control easier. Leading the way were old legionary fortresses that were transformed into *colonia* (towns in which the inhabitants all enjoy full Roman citizenship); these are Camulodunum (Colchester), Lincoln (Lindum), Eboracum (York) and Gloucestre (Gloucester).

Towns (the term 'cities' is avoided in 43AD) have their own government. Each has four annual magistrates: two *duoviri iure dicundo* for legal judgements, and two *aediles* for building and finance (with the assistance of two *quaestors*). They are elected from the local council (*ordo*) by the townsfolk. The council is a body of about one-hundred wealthy local men, and these councillors (*decurions*) seek the honour and status the position gives them, and freely finance urban projects such as sewers, fountains, temples and games. Towns also maintain a college of six *seviri*. The *seviri* are priests of the imperial cult elected from the wealthy freedmen of the town (freedmen are slaves who have been given their freedom by their master, or by the state). Service with the *seviri* (as with the councillors) proves one's loyalty, and enhances one's status.

Urban Status

Colonia

Coloniae are the most prestigious towns, with full Roman citizenship and a government modelled on Rome.

Municipia

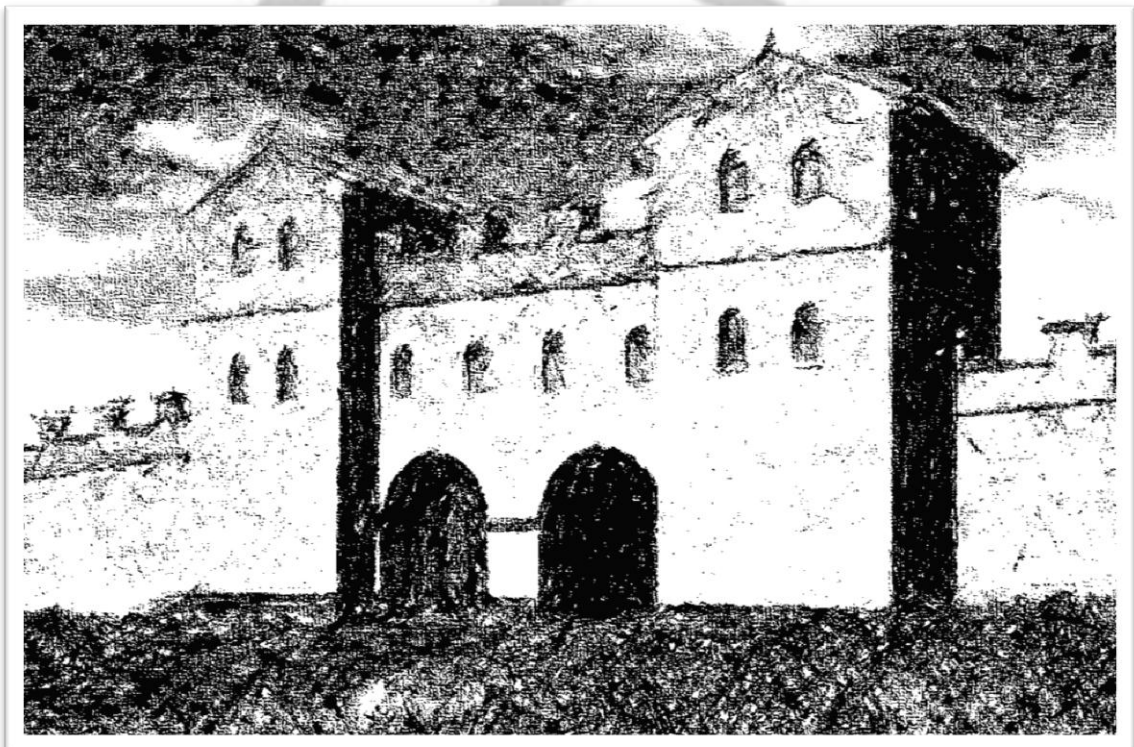
Municipia also model their constitutions on Rome, but enjoy only partial citizen's rights.

Civitas

The *civitates* are the administrative regions, that were once Kingdoms. Each has a town of local Britons that acts as a regional capital.

Vicus

An informal unplanned settlement, often outside a fort that may have a rudimentary council or headman.





The civitates are both administrative regions and their capitals. The Kingdom of the Parisi, for example, once conquered, became the civitas of the Parisi, with a small regional capital at Petuaria (Brough-on-Humber). These civitates also have councils and magistrates. Old duns are abandoned, for the most part, but raths continue to be farmed. The tribe continues in existence, but it has no chief, instead its elders sit on the council of the regional capital. There are many small towns (vici) all across the province, along important roads, at bridging points, clustered outside the main gates of forts, at mines and other industrial centres - these are unplanned little places, hick towns that come under the jurisdiction of the local army command, or the nearest large town.

As the years passed, the coloniae and municipia developed and expanded, with more public buildings erected every year. By 100 AD very few had walls, but most had a forum, basilica (town hall), public baths, amphitheatre, shops, large town houses, a water supply and one or more Roman temples. It was probably the governor (and emperor) Clodius Albinus who had the cities of Britain fortify themselves with earthwork defences in 196 AD. Most towns have only a few thousand inhabitants, though Lindum and Glavum and some regional capitals, have up to 5,000 people living inside them. Tacitus, writing about the Boudican revolt, estimated that the two biggest cities, Camulodunum and Verulamium, had 15,000 inhabitants - whilst Londinium, growing ever bigger could boast 30,000.

Life inside the Town

Town-dwellers live a more crowded life than farmers but this life is still essentially a struggle for survival. Most towns-people engage in a craft rather than farm. They work for the wealthy businessmen or rent little shops with large ground-floor windows opening onto the street. Goods are displayed outside or hang up within and at night wooden shutters slide down into grooves on the threshold, and are bolted tight. Many craftsmen sleep above their shops.

Oxen, ponies, donkeys and litter-bearers always crowd the narrow streets of any town, along with petty traders and many others trying to make an honest living, from every settlement comes the smell of animal dung, human sewage and cooking fires. Most towns will have one or more markets held daily in the forum, a place of many sights and smells where established traders sell wares that they purchase from the country villas and where local craftsmen sell their wares. Fresh in from the fields will be farmers and their families selling any surplus vegetables and fruits that they might have. People also congregate at the rectangular water fountains at busy street junctions, are at the city gates.

The town itself is divided into districts defined by trade, a silversmith's district, a potter's district, a temple district, a merchant's district - and so on. The town's specialist industry always groups itself together like this. The workers are often bound together within guilds (collegia) to protect themselves and provide mutual aid. The town's public amenities will vary, but nearly all will include a forum - a public square where the two main streets cross, used for meetings, ceremonies and markets. Here men gather to find work, hear rumours or stories, campaign for office, find workers to hire, sell or buy wares, or just meet up with friends. A forum has long colonnades surrounding it which contain shops and offices, as well as, on one side, a basilica (town hall). A basilica is both a public meeting hall and a law court, and is a huge and impressive building. In or near the basilica is the rectangular-shaped curia (or town senate house), used for meetings by the town's ruling men-folk.

While gladiators can often fight in the forum or a temporary wooden arena, some towns have permanent gladiatorial arenas. The bigger towns also have gladiator training schools, often sited close to the amphitheatre. All the large towns can boast luxurious public baths with steam rooms and hot water and



every town has temples, many of which are open to the public and adjacent to or very near to, the forum. Nearly all temples in Britain are of a distinctive local type, square buildings with red-tiled, pointed roofs and a covered veranda running all around. Classical temples are rare, and extremely expensive to build.

The people of Britannia are able to relax and amuse themselves in a number of different ways. The wealthy often give dinner parties or elaborate banquets, complete with numerous courses and entertainment in the form of dancers, acrobats, poetry reading, musicians, wrestlers, gladiators - even courtesans. Public entertainment consists mainly of the theatre, which hosts touring productions of comedies and tragedies (all the actors are male). However, only Durovernum (Canterbury), Verulamium (St. Albans), Camulodunum (Colchester) and Petuaria (Brough) have theatres. The Romans have, of course, introduced a less wholesome entertainment - gladiatorial combats. Many cities have arenas specifically for this grisly sport. Gladiatorial fights are very popular, often some wealthy noble will sponsor an entire day's worth of fights. The different origins of combatants and the numbers of styles of fighting are seemingly endless. Most gladiators are slaves, though some are freemen and participate willingly. Rome's most popular sport, chariot-racing, was indulged in a full-scale, full-on circus at the old provincial capital of Camulodunum.

The final great past-time of the civilised Britons is spending time at the baths. Towns have public baths where customers can swim, bathe, plunge into hot water or sweat in a steam room, they can gossip with friends, nibble on fast-food, lounge around, gamble, read, write and exercise. The larger baths often incorporate an exercise field, offices, a library and colonnades for strolling or sitting in the shade. Private bath-houses can also be found in very large houses and villas, palaces, and forts.

Cemeteries are always found outside the walls, usually along a road leading away from the town. The old British custom of exposing the dead, before cremating the rotting remains, has been replaced with burial. Out in the streets there is no lighting, and the winding streets are pitch-black and treacherous. Robbers and gangsters are common dangers. The wealthy are carried about in litters by their slaves, and the way is lit by more torch-bearing slaves.

Houses

Although most town houses are tiny affairs with just a couple of rooms, some are more splendid places to live. These are virtually windowless (to stop thieves) and all the rooms on both floors face into a central courtyard or garden. Men and women lead separate lives and live in separate parts of these wealthy abodes. The slaves, too, have their own rooms on the upper floor. A doorman (often a slave) usually admits people into the house, where they will emerge directly into the courtyard. Such a house would include a ground floor kitchen (with a raised cooking hearth), women's quarters, men's dining room (often with mosaic floors and couches), a family gathering room (often with a central hearth), and a bathroom with basins or terracotta bath, and drain. Every house has its altar to the household gods, and the grandest rooms are decorated with home-woven tapestries and rugs. Indoor lighting is normally achieved with clay lamps (using wicks and imported olive oil).

Status and Respect

Most people in Britain are provincials, with the status of *non-citizen*. Some are *citizens*, honorary citizens of Rome, most of whom have never been there. Citizens may have come from well-developed parts of the empire, from Rome itself, or from the army (either a retired legionary, or a retired auxiliary - who is given citizenship on discharge). Citizenship is prized. In this game the citizen is exempt from taxes and can take any lawsuit to the governor of the province, and even to the emperor himself! A provincial who mistreats or abuses a citizen is in for trouble, the court will always look in a citizen's favour, for fear the



citizen will appeal to the governor or the emperor to seek redress. A provincial throws himself at the mercy of his tribal elders in the local regional capital. Citizens of Rome renounce their connection to a tribe and do not seek redress there, or honour price. They are Roman in law, culture and belief.

Of course not all citizens or non-citizens are equal! Below the free men of Britain are several groups of people who do not enjoy the same status, rights or wages. Women are always poorly treated, as are slaves and other menials (including gladiators, prostitutes and criminals, for example). Above the freemen, who work in the fields to cultivate wheat, barley, onion, cabbage, flax or turnip (and his town-dwelling equal, the craftsman), is an entire strata of educated families able to turn their sons into accountants, scribes, doctors, clerks, priests, merchants, farm managers and other educated professions. Above these are the real aristocrats, the town gentry able to sit on the town council (ordo) and affect public life through their vote. To qualify, these families must have lots of property, land, money and political 'muscle'. Although still obliged to follow the dictates of the provincial governor, the ordo still has a number of municipal powers.

Civil cases are heard in the law court (the town basilica). The court is managed by the two elected magistrates, the duoviri, who pronounce judgement. Almost all cases are civil cases, one plaintiff bringing a case to the court against a defendant. This is a society where people know one another. Theft, injury, non-payment of debt and other criminal offences, are all brought to court by the victim or his family against the perpetrator. Weapons are not allowed to be carried by civilians, unless they are spears or bows used specifically for hunting.

The educated and wealthy (known as honestiores) are always treated with a good deal more respect and favour in law courts than 'everybody else'. For the wealthy who are found guilty, punishments such as fines and exile are more appropriate. For everyone else there are confiscations of property, flogging, mutilation, service as a slave-gladiator or galley or mine slave, or execution (by wild animal, beheading or crucifixion). Public order is kept by the local garrison of the army, usually auxiliary troops such as cavalry or spear-carrying infantry.

Slaves are in continual supply while the army moves north into Caledonia, but slaves also inter-bred. The slave is treated as property by his or her master, and can be flogged and punished with little impunity by the master. Hadrian introduced laws to curb 'excessive' cruelty against slaves, and murder is not tolerated. Slaves can be freed by their masters, and these freedmen often enter the merchant class. Some become wealthy and rise in rank and status. Emperor Claudius' own secretary, Narcissus, was a freedman. Freedmen have become an important urban social class, capable of achieving great heights - Roman 'yuppies' that defy social convention and have no bones about making money. They cannot, however, sit on a town council or be elected to a magistrate's office.

THE VILLAS

After the conquest of Britain, many tribes were receptive to Rome and Roman culture, or they were pragmatic, and wanted to 'get somewhere' in the new regime. Celtic warriors began to replace their roundhouses with rectangular cottages, and began using imported Roman pottery. These grew over time, to include more rooms, a joining corridor, and a veranda running along the front of the house (now a villa). Built on solid stone bases, the villas are built of timber, faced with fine plaster and roofed with thatch or more increasingly, tile. To compete for office in the local town or regional capital, and to sit on the ordo (town council), the old British nobility (once calling themselves 'heroes') have now to embrace Roman culture.



Villas grew steadily, the more 'wealthy' and 'Roman' that a British nobleman appeared, the higher his status within the civitas and the town. It almost guarantees power. With noblemen spending more and more time in their equally luxurious town-house, bailiffs or stewards are hired to handle the running of the estate in their absence.

The villas would later grow to huge proportions, but in the first and second centuries are modest country houses, complete with farm out-buildings, slave quarters, barns, working yards, stables and corn-drying ovens. Some boast their own bath-houses separate from the main building. Farmers apply for tenancies and farm the villa's lands to make a living. The villa has become an agricultural processing centre, with its own craftsmen, herdsmen, bee-keepers, and slaves. It is no accident that the English word village is derived from the Latin 'villa', each villa has become a self-contained agricultural community, a thriving business that the nobleman and his family neatly cream the profits off of. Technically the tenants are free to come and go, but find themselves tied into the villa economy - it is hard to 'up-sticks' and move.

Villas can be named after the paterfamilias, the old man of the noble family, or perhaps a distinguished ancestor. It might instead be named after a landmark or important agricultural product. The villa owner will act as leader in any ceremonies, and as priest in any religious rites. He will also preside over marriages, funerals and punishments - of which there might be quite a few!

Villas are only built by the tribal nobles of the more southerly British kingdoms. Tribal heroes in the other kingdoms shun Roman culture and most refuse to build Roman villas, often because there is little incentive. There are almost no Roman towns in Dumnonia, the West, the Wall zone, Brigantia (all except the civilised Parisi) and Caledonia. Without towns there are no villas.

CLOTHING & APPEARANCE

Roman colonists and Britons adopting Roman culture, have all adopted Roman fashions. The typical Roman fashion for men involves a baggy tunic, tied with a leather cord or piece of woven fabric (an unbelted tunic can only be worn privately, indoors). Everything else is optional! The native trousers quickly became popular, and the open caligae of the legions was very quickly changed for the calcei, or enclosed leather boot, used by farmers and other workers. Anyone who works outside has hobnails hammered into the soles of their shoes for added grip.

A cloak is essential. Cloaks are also indoor wear, in the evenings, the rich change into fancy dining tunics and put on dining cloaks. The rough British weather encourages the adoption of the Birrus Britannicus, a thick woollen cloak with a deep hood. Some of these hooded capes are made of waterproof goatskin.

The toga is an elaborate woollen garment, a drape of white cloth that wound around a man and was held in place by elaborate folds. Difficult to put on without the help of a slave, and very costly, the toga is the clothing of a rich man. It is impractical, and little physical activity can be performed while wearing it. In Roman Britain, the only people likely to be wearing togas are British aristocrats trying to make their mark, and other high-born citizens who have travelled from Rome or other civilised provinces. Togas are the 'formal' suit of the day, worn by wealthy men for banquets, funerals, marriages, celebrations, worship, legal work and state occasions. In the army, anyone of centurion rank or above would own a toga. Wealthy men also wear signet rings, that they use to impress their family signature on wax seals.

Men often follow the fashion set by the emperor, and in the first century AD this was generally clean-shaven, with short-cropped and sometimes curled hair. Hadrian introduced the beard to Roman fashion and it caught on quickly!

Women also wear tunics, but these are fuller, and are longer, reaching to the ankles. They are fastened at the shoulders by two brooches, or by a row of decorative buttons. Over this the wealthy woman is supposed to wear a stola, an unflattering, undyed woollen tunic to indicate her loyalty to tradition. Many do not. A long cloak called a palla is worn as a covering, it is wrapped around the body and draped over one arm (or tucked back into itself if the woman is poor and has to work for a living!) The palla is always worn in mixed company to hide the body, and to pull up over the head like a shawl. No respectable woman will leave her head bare in public. It is rare for women to wear hooded cloaks, but some do while travelling. No woman will ever wear the man's rectangular cloak.

Married women always wear their hair up, and follow the fashion set by the empress (as seen on the imperial coinage!). Rings, bracelets, ear-rings and necklaces are all worn by women. They also have access to perfumes and cosmetics (if their wealth permits).

Away from the towns and the vici, in the raths and the fields, the old costumes continue to be worn, long-sleeved tunics in many colours, trousers in checks and stripes, and short cloaks. British culture continues to thrive away from the forum and the bath-house.



THE CALENDAR

The calendar used by the Romans is sophisticated and fairly accurate. It uses a familiar system of 12 months, with an extra day added in Februarius every four years (the leap year). The Imperial names for these months are: *Januarius, Febrarius, Martius, Aprilis, Maius, Junius, Julius, Augustus, September, October, November, December*. Months contain a number of days equal to the modern Western months.

The early Roman calendar did not use the current system of seven-day weeks, but instead numbered days of the month in relation to certain phases of the moon. The Kalends was the first day of the month, the Nones was the 5th or 6th and marked the first quarter of the moon, the Ides was the 13th or 14th of the month and marked the full moon. The days of the week are named by Greek astrologers after the heavenly bodies: *Moonday, Marsday, Mercuryday, Jupiterday, Venusday, Saturnday, Sunday*. There are no weekly 'days of rest' but Rome recognises well over one-hundred festival days each year and citizens of the empire take the opportunity to relax and have a holiday or not, as their situation dictates. Some festivals are recognised only in Rome, a few are recognised across the empire (and even beyond).



Roman Festivals

Compitalia (3-5 January) - A festival of the spirits of the crossroads, marking the end of the farming year. Shrines were erected at roads linking farms together, and the shrine was open-sided to allow the spirits (lares) to pass through. A plough was hung from the shrine, and in the houses hung a wooden doll (for each free person) and a woollen ball (for every slave).

Lupercalia (15 February) - Fertility and purification were the goals of the Lupercalia which celebrated an ancient shepherd god, Faunus. It commemorated the wolf who suckled the twins Romulus and Remus.

Feralia (21 February) - This was a public festival to honour the dead, food was taken with much ceremony to tombs of relatives.

Bacchanalia (16-17 March) - These were a series of Dionysian festivals held in honor of the god Bacchus. The Bacchanalia were notorious, with drunkenness, sexual excess and revelry, but also plays, songs and music.

Liberalia (17 March)- This festival was a celebration for the Roman god Liber. Celebrated with sacrifices, crude songs and garish masks hung from trees.

Veneralia (1 April) - Venus' feast day.

Cerialia (12-19 April) - Festival for Ceres, with gladiatorial games on the last day. One ritual involved letting foxes loose with burning brands tied to their tails.

Floralia (28 April-3 May) - The Floralia was a festival devoted to Flora, the Roman goddess of flowers and plants. Bread was baked in the shape of breasts and phalli, this festival was all about fertility and sex.

Lemuria (9 May) - The name Lemuria indicates the time during which the *lemures*, or "hungry ghosts", wandered the earth. Householders rose at midnight and walked around the house barefoot throwing beans over their shoulder, these were for the ghosts to eat.

Festival of Mercury (15 May) - Mercury's feast day.

Festival of Hercules (4 June) - Hercules' feast day.

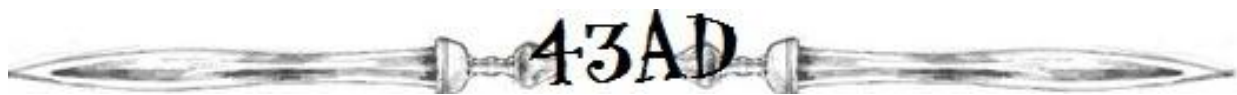
Festival of Minerva (19 June) - Minerva's feast day.

Festival of Juno (1 July) - Juno's feast day.

Neptunalia (23 July) - Neptune's feast day.

Festival of Diana (13 August) - Diana's feast day.

Volcanalia (23 August) - Festival in honour of Vulcan.



COINS & THINGS TO BUY WITH THEM

The Roman coin used as a monetary standard is the large brass **sestertius**. The tiny gold coin called the **aureus** is worth 100 sestertii, but is little used outside of official transactions and gift awards. There are coins of other denominations used in everyday transactions and the

100 Sestertii = 1 Aureus

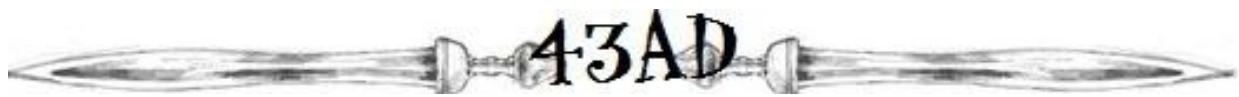
4 Sestertii = 1 Denarius

1 Sestertius = 4 Asses

most common of these were the small silver **denarius** (4 sestertii) and the ubiquitous copper **as** (¼ of a sestertii). The prices below are guidelines, altered by quality, location, age, scarcity and the buyer! Push up prices where required. In a city with frequent trade prices will remain unaltered, but at small towns further inland, roadside inns or some remote vicus far from the main roads, prices may be double, triple or even more. Consider how much effort it took to get the item to its location and increase the price accordingly.

Price List (Goods)

<i>Item</i>	<i>Price</i>
Tunic or Dress, Very Good	60 sestertii
Tunic or Dress, Average	16 sestertii
Tunic or Dress, Coarse	10 sestertii
Shoes, Leather	32 sestertii
Boots, Hobnailed	60 sestertii
Cloak, Good	100 sestertii
Cloak, Average	40 sestertii
Cloak, Poor	10 sestertii
British Cape (Thick, Hooded Cloak)	200 sestertii
Cloak Brooch, Bronze	15 sestertii
British Trousers	80 sestertii
Loincloth	4 sestertii
Slave	1000-2000 sestertii
Horse	720 sestertii
Donkey	400 sestertii
Four-Horned Saddle or Panniers	200 sestertii
4-Wheeled Cart	360 sestertii
Dish, Pottery	8 sestertii
Oil Lamp	5 sestertii
Wooden Bowl or Plate	2 sestertii
Wooden Spoon	1 sestertius
Wooden Bucket	10 sestertii
Iron cook pot, small	45 sestertii
Fishing net	35 sestertii
Wicker Fish Trap	25 sestertii
Small Fishing Boat	520 sestertii
Wool Blanket	10 sestertii
Fire steel	1 sestertius
Leather Bag with Strap	20 sestertii
Pouch or Woollen Bag	5 sestertii



Waterskin	10 sestertii
Iron Canteen (for oil)	20 sestertii
Tarpaulin, Goatskin	80 sestertii
Tarpaulin, Canvas	40 sestertii
Hemp Rope, 30 feet long	30 sestertii
Iron Tool (axe, spade etc.)	50 sestertii
Knife, Small	20 sestertii
Knife, Kitchen	30 sestertii
Oil (sextarius)	4 asses
Wheat (modius)	4 sestertii
Fish, for family meal	3 asses
Vegetables, for family meal	2 asses
Beef (librum), for family meal	8 asses
Fish Sauce, garum	3 asses
Pork or Mutton, for family meal	4 asses
Loaf of bread (librum)	1 as
Wine, Excellent (sextarius)	4 asses
Wine, Average (sextarius)	1 as
Celtic Beer (four sextarii)	2 as
Amulet or figurine of a god	40 sestertii
Dedicatory altar	480 sestertii

Price List (Services)

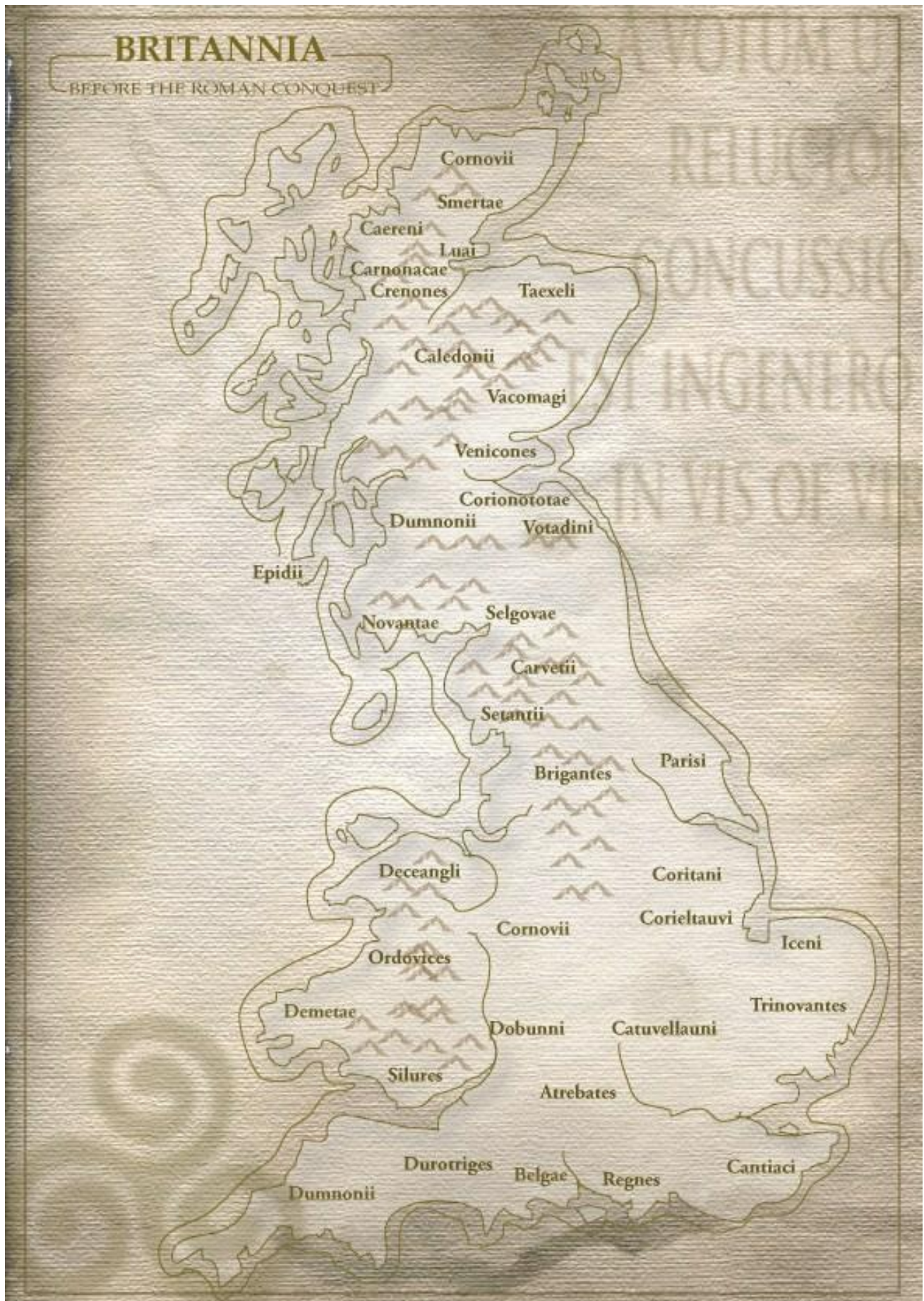
<i>Service</i>	<i>Price</i>
Visit Public Baths	1 as
Laundry, per garment	4 sestertii
Meal and wine, in tavern	4 asses
Wagon charges, 1700 libra load, 10 miles	5 sestertii
Visit courtesan	8 asses
Inn, private room, with a meal	5 sestertii
Inn, shared room, without a meal	4 asses
Stabling, one horse or donkey	4 asses
Letterwriting	3 sestertii
Lawyer pleading a case	40-460 s
Musician to entertain	2 sestertii
Mourners, job lot of six, all wailing	16 sestertii
Feast for 12 people, with catering	50 sestertii
Fine for minor criminal act	25 sestertii
Surgery	30 sestertii
Medical house-call	4 asses
Decent haircut and shave	3 asses
Wage, skilled craftsman, per day	20 sestertii
Wage, labourer, per day	4 sestertii
Sacrifice performed by a priest	20 sestertii



The Cost of Living: A family of four people require 120 modii of wheat, 120 sextarii of oil and 720 sextarii of wine, costing 200 denarii per year. Approximately 40% of this will be consumed by the man of the house. He eats around 2 libra (2 loaves) of bread each day. One modius of wheat is required to produce 16-20 loaves of bread (one loaf weighs one librum).

HISTORICAL SUMMARY

<i>Situation</i>	<i>Important Governor</i>	<i>Important British Leader</i>
The Invasion 43-47 AD		
Four legions have landed in Kent. They must defeat the Kingdom of the Catuvellauni to stand a hope of success. Following a victory, the Second legion marches into the west to defeat the tribes there.	Aulus Plautius is the Roman general. After the battles he becomes Britain's first governor.	Caratacus and Togodumnus are princes of the Catuvellauni.
Tough Resistance in the West 47-60 AD		
New governors arrive but find the situation is deteriorating, rebels in the west are fighting a guerrilla war, refusing to be conquered and threatening the newly formed province of Britannia.	Ostorius Scapula takes the legions into the west, and after hard fighting defeats Caratacus.	Caratacus flees to the mountain kingdoms of the west.
The Iceni Revolt 60-61 AD		
The province is secure, but a brutal regime in the east ignites a revolt that burns three cities to the ground before ending in a huge battle.	Suetonius Paullinus is the governor who must defeat this vast army of rebels. Once defeated he institutes a vicious campaign of reprisals.	Boudica, Queen of the Iceni, is the leader of the revolt.
Fighting Northwards 70-100 AD		
While-ever there are free tribes in the north, the province is in danger. The new governor has been commanded to conquer these northern tribes once and for all.	Julius Agricola marches all the legions deep into Scotland, and fights a decisive battle at Mons Graupius.	Calgacus leads a confederation of Caledonian tribes. He is forced to fight due to a Roman scorched earth policy.
The Walls 122-150 AD		
The conquests of Agricola (see above) are lost, and the new emperor decides to establish a permanent fortified frontier in northern Britain.	The emperor Hadrian is in Britain in 122, but his colleague Platorius Nepos oversees the building of the Hadrian's Wall	There are no main antagonists at this time, but the period resembles a tense 'Cold War' situation.
The North Fights Back! 180-211 AD		
Chaos has erupted in Britain when the garrisons are used to fight a civil war in Gaul. The new emperor comes to Britain to restore order, and then marches deep into Scotland to wipe out those pesky Caledonians - once, and for all!	Septimus Severus, his two sons and his wife come to Britain and set up the imperial court at York.	The Caledonian King named Argentocoros may have led the Caledonian confederacy.



VIII THE TRIBES

Lacking timber, they crucified him on a conveniently shaped tree. They anointed him with honey so the insects wound around him like advancing armies, chewing him up as if he was land to be devastated or a city to be razed.

He did not go under. He was proud. He would not let them see him weep or wail for mercy.

They came on the first morning to cut strips from him, smear them with dung and cram them into his mouth. They burned him at dusk, running brands across his back and shoulders. He saw the sun going down and heard them bid it farewell as they waited for him to break.

He thought that they flogged him later, though he could not be sure by then. He overheard them speaking of the bad death, the one where they pulled your soul out through your back and left it splayed out there for all to see. But he did not beg them to show mercy. He had never begged. Never.

Finally, he was curled up naked on the grass. A woman was bent over him, carefully wiping away the blood that had crusted across his chest and face. Dogs were licking the blood from the foot of the tree behind him.

'Rest now,' said the woman. 'We are satisfied. Now you can call yourself Brigantes!'

The tribes have co-existed in Britain for uncounted ages. They are not tightly structured political entities like modern nations, but are much more akin to a confederation of related clans.

Clans

A Roman might relate, to a stranger, his name, his hometown, his occupation and his province. A Briton will relate his name (as well as his father's), his clan and his tribe. These clans form the basic building block of the tribal society, they are large related family units focussed on one part of the landscape. Without a clan, a man is almost dead to the world, the clan gives him meaning, occupation, identity and allies in war and law. Members of a tribe are inter-related and inter-dependant, and clans within the tribe are far more likely to help each other out than to bicker and fight. Marriages are made between clans, and sons of of clan chief are fostered by neighbouring clans.

LIST OF TRIBES

Southern Britain	Middle Britain	Northern Britain	<i>(contd)</i>
Catuvellauni	Carveti	(Scotland)	Selgovae
Trinovantes	Cornovii	Caledoni	Smertae
Iceni	Corieltavi	Caereni	Taexali
Atrebates	Parisii	Carnonacae	Vacomagi
Belgae	Brigantes	Cornovi	Venicones
Cantiaci		Creones	Votadini
Durotriges	Western Britain	Dumnoni	
Dumnoni	(Wales)	Decantae	
Regnes	Deceangli	Ebudae	
Dobunni	Demetae	Epidi	
	Ordovices	Luai	
	Silures	Novantae	

The head of a clan is called the clan chief, or hero. He is a warrior, owing loyalty to the tribal chief. He is fiercely competitive and carries weapons into battle. Amongst the round-houses of the rath (the village) that of the hero is the largest.



Tribes

Far from facing up to the Romans with a unified force, the tribes of Britain are very different in temperament, in traditions and views. They share a common culture, however – and interact through an elaborate series of alliances, marriages, gift-giving rituals, trade and warfare.

Tribes do compete with one another. They are led either by a council of elders, or more often by a chief or king who resides at the dun – which is a central place, or hill-fort. Some tribes have allied together for mutual protection under the leadership of an over-chief (a 'High King' or 'High Queen'). The title of tribal chief or king may sound grand, but rarely does he hold the total authority of the noble families and clan chiefs below him. This is almost a consensus society. The tribe of the Dobunni, for example, was split between those who wished to make peace with Rome, and those who wished to fight. The king has to find a way to keep the tribe together, or he must decide which faction to represent. The chiefs of the wealthiest clans, the druids and his own entourage will all offer him advice. When a king loses the support of his clans they can lawfully remove him, and elect another male member of the family to the kingship. A good leader keeps his fellows happy with plenty of plunder and gifts for everyone!

Occasionally, there are times when tribes unite against a common enemy – but these times are rare. Caesar's invasion of 55 BC, and Severus' invasion of Caledonia in 208 are examples of this. Such confederations rarely last long. Remember that the kingdoms are alliances of clans, rich and poor, designed to protect them from the interferences of rival kingdoms.

...nothing has helped us more in fighting against their very powerful nations than their inability to co-operate. It is seldom that two or three states unite to repel a common danger; thus fighting in separate groups, all are conquered.

Tacitus, Agricola

SETTLEMENTS

In 43AD, as in the novel *The Eagle of the Ninth*, the term rath is used to describe a small collection of round-houses that are the home of a clan (whether defended or undefended). Likewise, the term dun is used to describe any local tribal centre, used either by the tribal chief, or by one of the richer noble clans of the tribe. It is a market or redistribution centre. Rathes and duns come in all shapes and sizes however! The size of a clan or tribe will determine the overall size of a rath or dun.

When a dun is approached, word will probably already have reached the occupants that strangers are in the area. If not, a doorman, keeping look-out from wooden tower over the gate will spot them. He will demand to know their names and lineages and will take their weapons from them, holding them in the tower until the visitors leave. He will not ask their business, but will announce them to the chief of the dun, who may or may not want to meet them. Hospitality will be granted for three days, and this means the strangers will share a round-house at the dun, and if the chief is willing to meet with them, they may find themselves sharing his round-house. The open space within the dun is filled with animals, craftsmen hard at work in the sunshine, and various agricultural activities. Children and dogs run about. Huge piles of firewood are protected by thatched roofs. Time-worn paths are muddy and rutted. There may be a rectangular hut in the dun, a shrine to the local god, and of course a well. Without a well, there will be large wooden cisterns to collect rainwater. Every dun will have rubbish pits set apart, for bones, broken pottery and industrial waste, as well as cess pits, screened by a fence of willow for the modest.

Hill Forts: The hill-fort is the predominant type of dun in Britain. A hill-fort is the top of a hill, defended entirely by a steep ditch and a built-up earthen bank topped with a stout palisade. Large hill-

forts may have two, three or even four lines of these defences. They follow the contours of the hill used, and can be of any shape. The hill-fort is often the residence of the Tribal Chief, but the Tribe may have several hill-forts and use them collectively for defence or as cattle-markets, as needed. Many also house small rectangular shrines to an important Tribal deity. The round-houses in a hill-fort belong to craftsmen, important members of the Tribe, advisors, family, heroes, representatives from the Clans, and so on. The Chief and his immediate family dwell in a series of particularly fine round-houses.

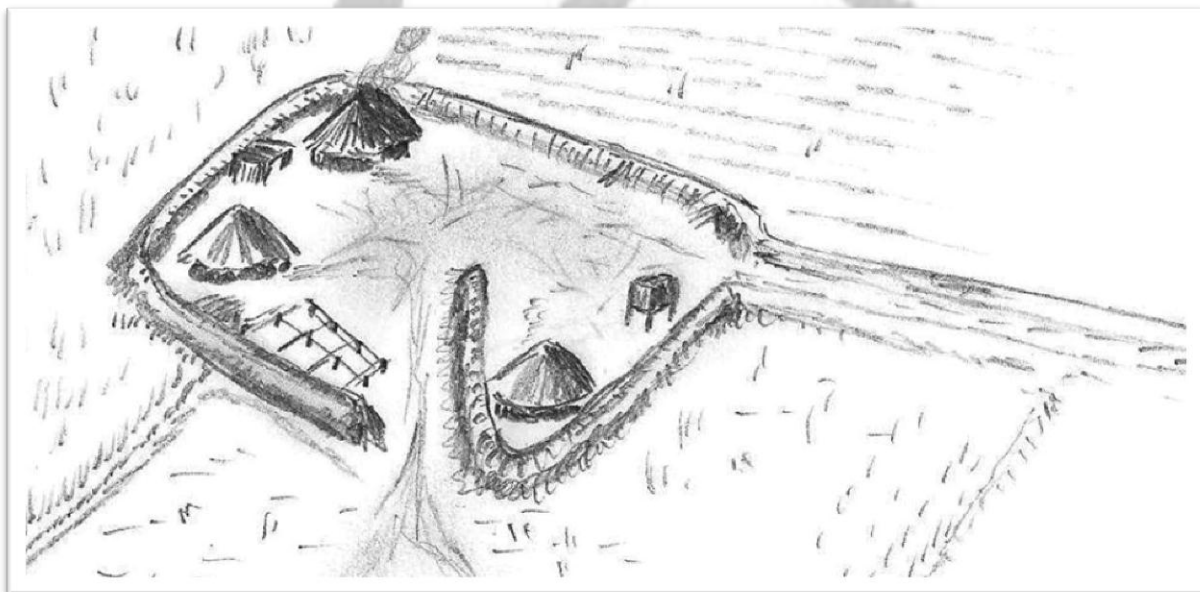
Oppida: Recently replacing hill-forts in the south of Britain, oppida are more accessible to merchants, sited close to track ways or rivers, and being on flat ground. The oppida is still a heavily defended dun with earthworks, but has a much clearer internal layout that is needed for the intensive commercial activities that go on there.

Stone Forts: These are large forts built on flat ground, hills or even islands in lakes. These duns are not defended by the slopes of hills or earthen banks, but with well-made walls of dry-stone interlaced with timber. They are found in Caledonia. The stone forts serve as Clan or Tribal centres in a land with few trees, but plenty of bed-rock!

Brochs: Brochs are tall, dry-stone towers inhabited by several clans. A double wall is utilised as a space for stairs, and smaller stone dwellings clustered around the tower are often protected by a stone wall. The Broch of Gurness on Orkney could hold up to 40 families. These impregnable duns are towers that show incredible sophistication, but are perfectly suited to the harsh climate of the far northern climate.

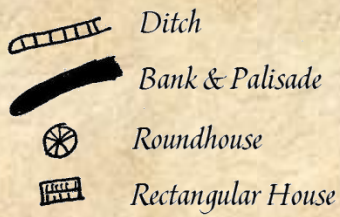
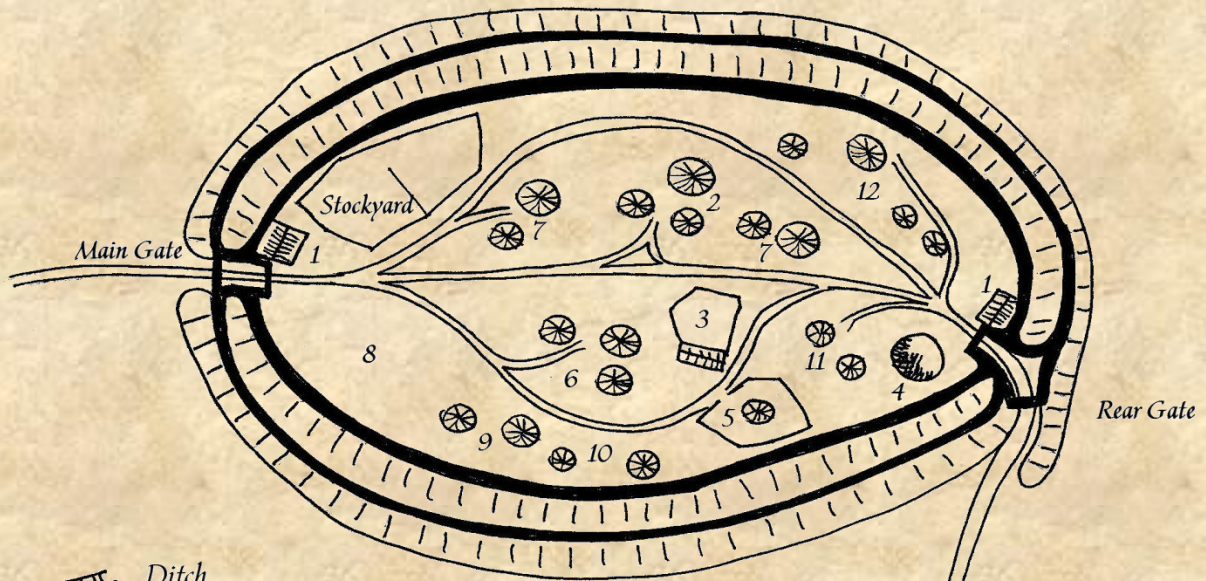
Crannogs: Crannogs are natural or artificial islands in lakes, used as habitation by a clan that live in a dun (either a broch or stone fort) on that island. Some crannogs are imply large roundhouses, suspended over the water by timber piles driven into the lake-bed and reached by a timber walk-way. Crannogs are found across the region, usually where-ever there is a suitable lake! The dwellers utilise the resources of the lake, and depend upon the water for defence. Inhabitants use dugout canoes or stone causeways to reach the mainland.

Rath (homestead): A rath is defined here as a homestead, a small collection of round-houses, surrounded by farmland or pasture that provides shelter and upkeep for a single clan. The homestead may be defended by a ditch and rampart or nothing at all. Perhaps a timber palisade may be present on top of the rampart, or instead of it, or a dry-stone wall may enclose the rath.



TRIBAL DUN

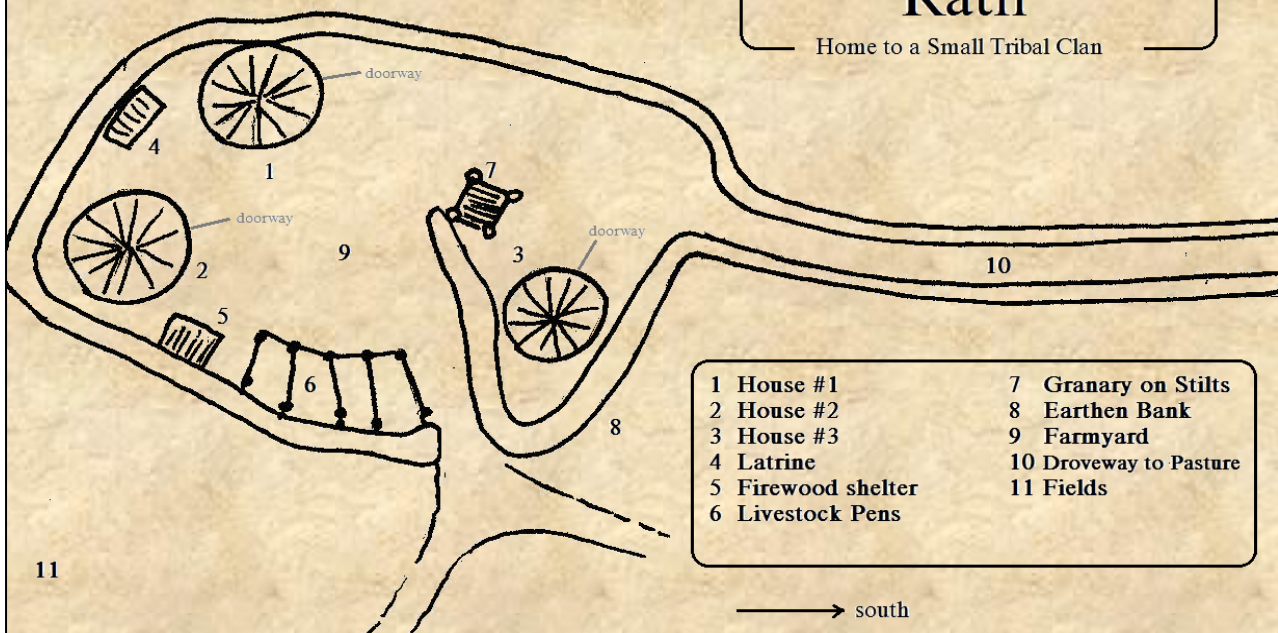
Home to a Wealthy Clan of the Tribe



- | | |
|------------------------|------------------------------|
| 1 Guard House | 7 Warriors Houses |
| 2 Clan Chief's Houses | 8 Camping Ground |
| 3 Stables | 9 Peasant Houses |
| 4 Ancient Burial Mound | 10 Servants/Slaves Huts |
| 5 Temple | 11 Guest Houses |
| 6 Craftworkers | 12 Farmers'/Crafter's Houses |

Rath

Home to a Small Tribal Clan



- | | |
|--------------------|------------------------|
| 1 House #1 | 7 Granary on Stilts |
| 2 House #2 | 8 Earthen Bank |
| 3 House #3 | 9 Farmyard |
| 4 Latrine | 10 Droveway to Pasture |
| 5 Firewood shelter | 11 Fields |
| 6 Livestock Pens | |



HOW A CLAN SURVIVES

The clan is an economic unit, an extended family that pulls together, shares out the effort and works the land. Each autumn, if the harvest is a good one, a clan is able to produce enough grain to feed itself. It also produces some dairy produce, eggs and a little meat from sheep and pigs kept on the clan's land. The sheep also give the clan women wool to spin with. From the pigs slaughtered food is salted and stored, fat is turned into tallow lamps and the hide is used for shoes, bags and belts. Cattle are reared and kept for milk and cheese, they are a source of tradable wealth for the clan and not quickly killed for meat. Any local sources of clay, such as riverbanks, can be utilised by the clan to produce their own coarse pottery. Roundhouses are a communal effort and several clans might join in to build and thatch one.

There are many things a clan cannot produce, however. Axes and other tools are by far the most important, but belt buckles, brooches, salt, good cloth dyes, jewellery, wine, fine pottery, cauldrons and so on must come from the tribal dun. To get these things, the clan sends surplus wool, cloth, grain and cattle to the chief as a gift. Alternatively they send their produce to the dun of a noble clan, of high status, with access to expensive trade goods. This surplus equates to buying power. Given as a gift to the tribe's chief or a noble clan chief, it will be reciprocated with a gift - something the poor clan cannot manufacture itself. A cow is essentially a form of currency and is easy to send to a British nobleman. It walks to the dun on its own, can be easily counted and is easy to store (you have a field?). As a unit of currency, the cow makes a lot of sense!

In the south, where crop production is much more important than stock herding, and where the economy is becoming ever more sophisticated, bars of iron ('taleis ferreis') are used as the standard measure, these iron currency bars are more portable in this manner. Each can be hammered into a sword by a blacksmith. In reality the clan's actual agricultural surplus will be in bushels of wheat, in cattle and in textiles. But all of these resources are valued according to the current value of an iron-bar.

When player-characters are trading goods, they can compare prices using the iron-bar or cow, but can then trade fairly using that yardstick. They don't actually *need* to barter three cows from their clan for a chariot and two ponies. Anything on the list can be used, as long as the recipient wants what you have to trade, and even then he might know someone else who he could trade it to next.

<i>Item</i>	<i>Relative Value</i>
Chariot	3 Cows
Chariot Pony	1 Cow
Slave, adult	1 Cow
Sword & Scabbard	3 Cows
Amphora of Wine	1 Cow
Milk Cow	1 Cow
Helmet	4 Cows
Spear	1 Cow
Wooden Shield	1 Cow
Bronze-Faced Shield	2 Cows
Riding Horse	3 Cows
Plough Ox	1 Cow
Modius (16 pints) of Grain	one twelfth of 1 Cow
Gold Ring	6 Cows
Cape (Hooded Cloak)	2 Cows

Bronze Cloak Brooch	one quarter of 1 Cow
Silvered Cloak Brooch	1 Cow
Bronze Torc	1 Cow
Gold-plated Torc	4 Cows
Bronze Bracelet	one half of 1 Cow
Iron-Bar	1 Cow
Tunic/Dress/Breeches	All 1 Cow each
Iron Tool (Axe etc.)	1 Cow
Good Knife	one half of 1 Cow





HONOUR & GIFT-GIVING

Think of the ancient British tribe, without shops or any type of free economy, without a lack of common markets or a system of open trade. For goods to flow from one group to another some social mechanism is needed. In tribal Britain this mechanism is gift-giving. There is no real trade in existence apart from the super-sophisticated kingdoms of the south-east. Instead, gifts cement the bonds of loyalty that hold a kingdom together. This is a tax, but a tax that is not purely economic, it establishes networks of obligation - it holds society together.

Heroes can also give a gift to a chief whenever they have surplus or treasure, and wish to convert it to finished goods. These gifts can be taken to the dun and offered to the chief at any time, and the hero will receive in return a finished item as a reciprocal gift. If he needs a particular finished item, he can make this known, and his gift will often then come to him in this form. The chiefs and kings, after all, control all craft and production at the dun, and monopolize such industries by supporting these specialists as patrons.

Gifts should always be roughly similar in value, or the giver risks the threat of looking like a cheap-skate and having a reduction of 1 Honour. This doesn't apply where a recipient is obviously far less wealthy than the giver, but the recipient must at least give something back (whether a bronze bracelet or a big bowl of stew!).

Honour is the true currency of the tribal system. The heroes thrive on honour, live by it, always seek to defend it and enhance it. Nothing else matters to the Tribal heroes. The Irish term for honour is *enech*, meaning in actual fact face, and it is useful to remember the hero is obsessed with 'saving face', looking the part, being thought of by his community as a brave warrior, a man of his word, a man who does not fail, never gives up or never gives in.

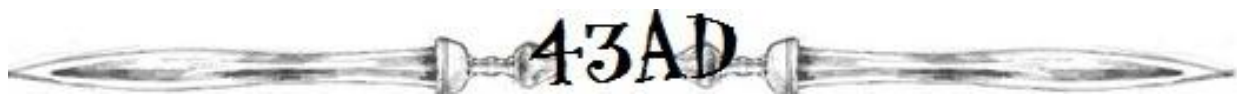
THE DRUIDS

In **43AD**, the druids are the priesthood of the tribes, an arcane and bewitched priesthood. The Romans fear them because the Druids fear nothing. They have seen the monsters that guard the gates to the Otherworld and they have seen the dead return. There is no fear in death for members of this strange cult.

And for the purposes of the game, it is a cult. The druids are loyal to one another and not to an individual tribe. During their long career they may attach themselves to a tribe as advisor and priest, but they may move on. Druids meet together in sacred woodland shrines (*nemeton*), they are not highly organised, but they are one body with one purpose. They try to keep the monsters in the wild lands at bay, the awful and malign creatures of the Otherworld. The gods are distant and aloof, it is the supernatural beings of Britain that hold such a great terror for the tribes and that need to be contained.

The druid order, following the god *Lugus*, serves the kingdoms in this endeavour. Wherever they go, the druids are treated with utmost respect, even by clan chiefs and kings. No-one will harm a druid or threaten him, every household, rath and dun will extend the laws of hospitality for a druid to six days. In this way druids are always welcome and in return for such hospitality, may look into a problem that the rath or dun has been having with some supernatural phenomenon.

Druids do not dress in long white robes. They are the strange misfits of British tribal society, breaking convention and not particularly paying much attention to their appearance. They may be dressed in rags,



impressively dyed clothes, or perhaps a cloak of raven feathers. While many look respectable, some may wear scores of locket, amulets and charms around their necks, or dozens of bronze bracelets and neck rings. Some of the wilder druids don't quite look ... normal. They are druids - unbalanced, unhinged and they see the world quite differently. In the far north a sinister group of Druids has been established. Called the Black Druids, its members are the evil antithesis to the honourable Druid.

TRIBAL LAW

Law in Britain focuses mainly on redress. A clan hero, a chief or a king is appealed to by an injured party, and this leader must make a ruling - what redress is the victim entitled too from the lawbreaker? There are no prisons and little in the way of capital punishment, and so punishment is generally in the form of payment. A family can seek 'damages' for anything from an assault on their youngest son, to their crops being trampled by a clan's herd, to their mother being killed during an argument. The punishment remains the same, but the value (the 'honour price') placed on each crime varies. Only the crimes of kin-slaying and the murder of a guest are beyond any honour price, these always result in the death sentence. Anyone refusing to pay up an honour price could face the *glam dicin* or Druid's Ban - equivalent to exile.

Honour price varies both with the seriousness of the crime and the status of the victim. Typical honour

<i>Honour of Victim</i>	<i>Honour Price (in cattle)</i>
Farmer	1
Craftsman	2
Minor Hero/Clan Chief	3
Noble/Tribal Hero	4
Rich Noble/Major Hero	5
Wealthy Noble/Great Hero	6

prices for a serious crime (perhaps injury) are given in the table. Insults, slights, theft and damage to property should lower the price a little; murder (accidental or not) should probably double the honour price. In law any children that a man fathered, are his, and there is no stigma to this. Marriage involves a feast, but no oath-taking, vows or special ceremony. The woman moves into the man's clan and the couple are considered bound by marriage.

CLOTHING & APPEARANCE

The British men wear long-sleeved tunics of wool, sometimes woven with colourful checks. The more vibrant and colourful tunics belong to the wealthy heroes, poorer folk use cheaper dyes that aren't so effective. Trousers are also worn, and a cloak is essential in damp or cold weather. It is fixed with a bronze brooch which tells everyone what your status is. Great heroes have them plated with silver or gold. Leather shoes are simple. No man can hold his head up high unless he has combed his moustache and attended to his hair, different tribes might have unique hairstyles. In battle the hair is traditional washed with lime, making it white and stiff - it is then spiked up, imitating the bristles of a boar. Men also wear bracelets and torcs, distinctive Celtic neck rings, some elaborately and beautifully made. The torc he wears again indicates his status.

Women wear a woollen dress rather than a tunic, but still wear bracelets, necklaces and cloaks. She will pay great attention to her appearance, whether she is a queen, or a farmer's wife. When there is little or no wealth in coinage or in buildings, wealth of any level is worn and displayed.

FAMILY LIFE

The eldest male is head of the household, dispensing both wisdom and justice. He hopes for boys from his wife, boys who will work hard in the fields or tending cattle. If the household is that of a hero, tradition dictates that the boy will be fostered out to another noble family from the age of 6 or 7. This helps to form close alliances between clans and between tribes. The boy would continue to be fostered until *aimsir togu*, 'the age of reason', around 17 years old. He could return home, marry, or stay with his foster parents. Often strong bonds of affection are made between the child and his foster parents, affection that may last for the rest of his life.

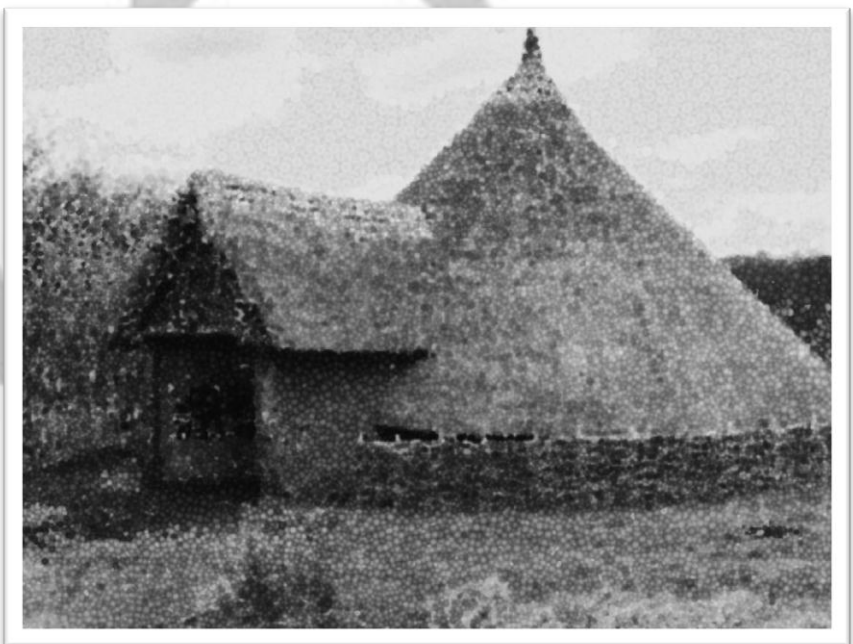
Daughters are trained to spin, dye and weave, as well as cook, clean and mend. They often help with farming activities also. Women in British life are given far more respect and freedom than their Roman counter-parts and can receive very lavish funeral rites if from a wealthy family, or a chief or queen. Traditionally, a new chief of the tribe is elected by his peers from the blood-relatives of the previous chief. It may be his son, his nephew, a cousin or grand-son. Occasionally there are no suitable candidates, and instead a woman is chosen from the bloodline to stand as chief.

THE ROUND-HOUSE

The centre of family life is the round-house, a substantial timber-built structure with a single doorway, no windows or chimney, and a heavy thatched or turf roof. The low walls of these houses are made of wattle and daub - woven sticks, with the gaps filled with a mixture of mud and manure. The round-house is the focus of family life, and can sleep a dozen people. Two or three would cluster together to house all the members of a clan.

The Fire: A fire burns in a central hearth, with pots and cauldrons either hanging from a beam, or sitting on stones around the hearth. An iron spit may also sit across the fire, balanced on a firedog (an iron frame with dog-head decoration). The fire is used for cooking, it is the centre of the farm, and smoulders continuously. The fire also provides some light in the evening and the smoke rises and dissipates through the thatched roof. Cheeses and meats to be smoked are suspended in the roof, they will last all winter up there.

Meals: Typical meals might include vegetable pottage, pease pudding, porridge, soups, grilled fish, roast venison, lamb stew, marrow bones, ox tails, wild boar cutlets, chicken, nettle or dandelion puree, tripe or pork chops. These are all served with lots of bread. When an animal is killed, everything is eaten - tribes live too close to hunger to simply throw offal to the dogs. Beef was rarely eaten, as cattle were the unit of currency. Common vegetables included cabbage, onion, leek, turnips and beetroot. Beer is a common





drink, brewed by every clan, using heather, pine shoots, all manner of berries or even seaweed for flavouring. Apple cider is also a popular British drink, as is mead (an alcoholic drink fermented from honey). Meat is a luxury, vegetables are a daily food, along with bread. However, few bread ovens exist in Britain. Instead, dough is slapped onto stones around the fire to produce flat bread. The grain will have been ground earlier in the day by womenfolk on a rotary quern. Everyone eats from wooden bowls with spoons, and drinks from wooden or horn cups.

The Feast: The feast is a social occasion, particularly within the hero's round-house where guests will be entertained. The best pottery will be on show, along with all of the elaborate metalwork of the feast (cauldrons, firedogs, chains, tripods, hooks, etc.). Status and wealth can be displayed here, particularly if exotic Roman goods are available. Bronze and silver dishes, wine and olive oil along with the amphorae they came in, all show that the hero has been awarded great gifts. Storytelling and music is often performed at these feasts by the chief's bard. He knows many songs, myths and tales, and is capable of creating new ones to fit the situation or to record events and fights that the chief and his warband have participated in. In this way these exploits enter the tribal history and will be told generations hence - fulfilling the great desire of all heroes to be remembered forever.

FESTIVALS

There are four major festivals celebrated on the Island of the Mighty: Beltaine, Lughnasa, Samhain and Imbolc. The ancient Britons probably used a lunar calendar, with the folk of the Tribe counting through the days and months with the phases of the Moon.

Beltaine - Beltaine is celebrated on the full moon in early May. It involves the setting of bonfires in pairs so that the tribe's animals can be driven between them, purifying them ready for the coming season. Belenus, the Shining Hero, the sun-king, is being celebrated in this festival. Boughs of the rowan tree or hawthorn are hung over doorways, and decorated with ribbons, eggshells, flowers and garlands. Phallic poles, danced around by maidens are also erected by the tribe, and this fertility ritual is very powerful. The poles are usually hawthorn or birch, and rivalry over the tallest and most elaborately decorated pole can take place between tribes. Beltaine is all about celebrating the rise of Belenus - the new king, powerful and ready for the summer.

Lughnasa - This festival is held on the full moon at the start of August. Lughnasa is the festival that commemorates the death of Lugus, and Lughnasa is the 'Mourning of Lugus'. The Old King is celebrated with funeral processions, with animal and human sacrifice and with offerings to the dead, particularly to dead heroes. There are also great performances of hero myths and the retelling of epic genealogical poems. The one month festival of Lughnasa takes place at the height of summer, and is always a propitious time for marriage. It is a harvest festival, and it is a celebration of the cutting of the stalks, the threshing of the husks and the baking on a fire. The Old King is killed in three ways. Human sacrifices to Lugus, volunteers or prisoners of war, are murdered in three ways.

Samhain - Samhain is celebrated on the full moon in early November and is a festival of the dead to mark the end of the harvest season. The week is filled with preparations for the darkness of winter; slaughtering animals, preserving the meat, stacking wood and peat by the fire. A feast is held, and it begins with the ritual dousing of the family hearth fire, together with its re-lighting. A bench is set in front of the hearth for 'the dead' and stories told of ancestors and the lost heroes of the tribe. This is a fearful time, when the gates of the Otherworld open wide and the spirits of the dead are abroad at night.



Imbolc - Imbolc is devoted to the goddess Brigantia, and is held on the full moon in early February. She is said to walk the land on Imbolc eve. It recognises the first signs of spring, with lambing season and an end to the dark of winter. Brigantia is the Maiden and a Flower Goddess, brave and strong she brings fertility to the tribes after the reign of the barren Crone. A new-born lamb is decorated and venerated in the rath or dun, and young girls drink the first ewe's milk. Following this they will join all the unmarried women of the community in a single round-house, staying up all night, and receiving a procession of male visitors looking in on 'Little Brigantia'. This is a corn dolly made by the girls, and decorated with ribbon and cloth and spring flowers. The festival focuses on the women of the tribe, and it renews the fertility of the land. Brigantia walks across the fields, bringing up new shoots and opening flowers. Some women lay strips of cloth outside in the night, and in the morning hope the goddess has stepped on them. These strips are said to have healing properties.

BRITONS AT WAR

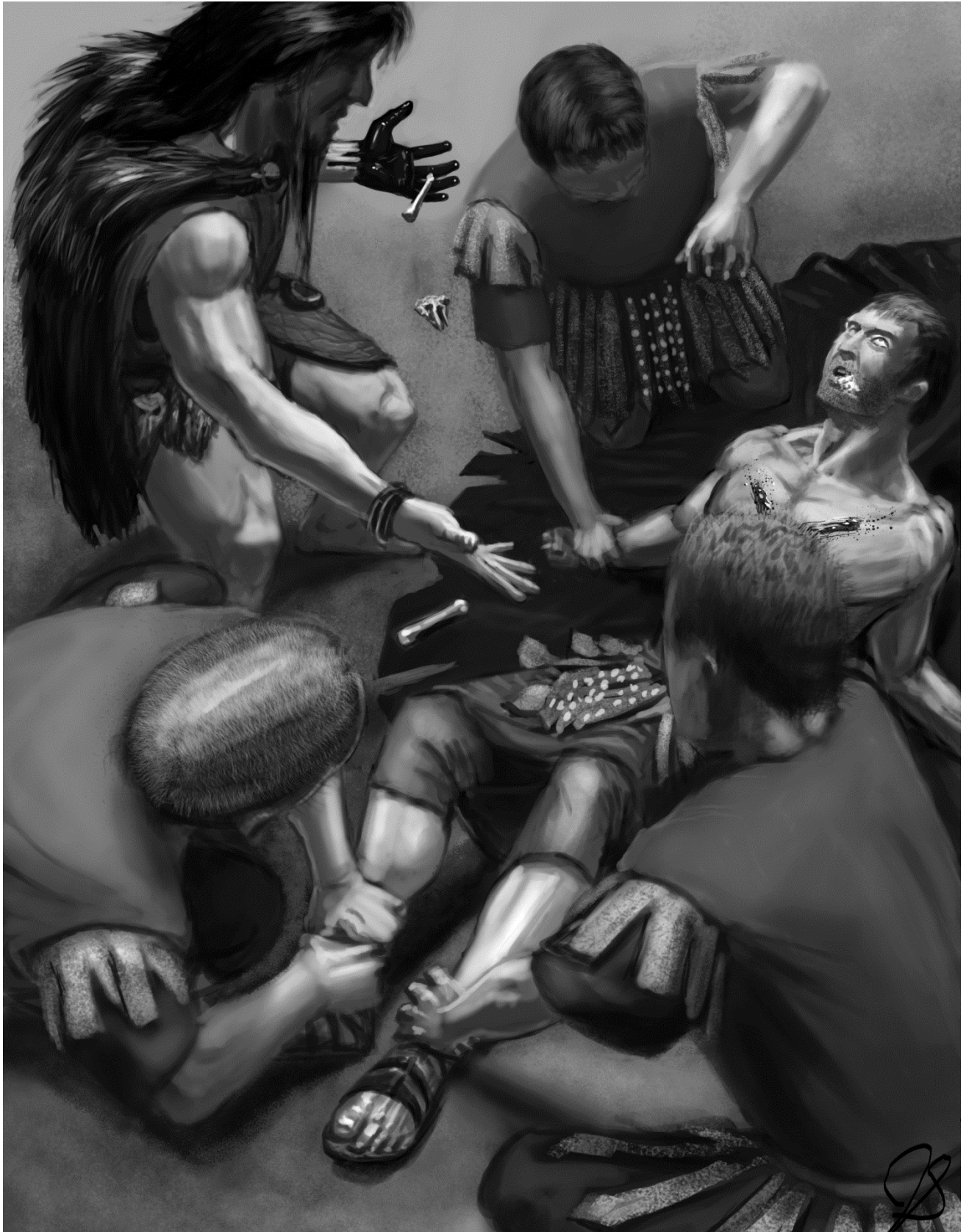
*Wearing a brooch in the front rank, bearing weapons in battle,
a mighty man in the fight before his death day,
a champion in the charge in the van of his armies:
there fell five times fifty before his blades,*

Aneurin, Y Gododdin

The hero earns most of his honour on the battlefield, and so war is something good to be sought out and actively participated in. Much of the fighting that takes place between tribes is at a very small scale; tens or scores of men raiding a rath or crossing into enemy territory to steal cattle or kill a rival. Larger conflicts, when the entire fighting force of a kingdom is mobilised, are still not epic in scale, but consist of several hundred heroes, followed by as many freemen with spears and shields that they can muster. A small tribe might muster 500 heroes, all told. If each hero is accompanied by 5 freemen from his clan, then the king would be leading a total force of 3,000 men, 500 of which would be trained heroes, the rest an untested force of 2,500 levy spearmen. Very large and powerful kingdoms might be able to put five times that many men into battle.

Before the battle, heroes will show how brave they are by taunting and threatening the other army, shouting insults and attempting to frighten the opposition. Those with chariots thunder up and down in front of the lines, showing off before the battle began. The chariots can make charges at the enemy line, showering the army with javelins before speeding back to their own lines. Once the carynx, the tall animal-headed horns, brays the war signals, the two lines of Britons charge. There are few tactics involved, and even if a king had created some wonderful battle plan, the heroes, eager for heads and honour and booty, would not have followed it! Chaos reigns, the tribal levy loyally follow their clan heroes into the fray. At some point, one side gives way and flees ... cavalry and chariots then begin the pursuit and cut down fleeing warriors, while the heroes linger with the dead, taking heads to display outside their roundhouse. This approach to warfare will not fare well with the discipline of the legions.

Combat does not always take place on this scale, duels are frequent, especially when a loss of honour is at stake. By defeating the source of that dishonour in combat (typically to first blood, chiefs do not like to see their heroes kill each other off) a hero can regain lost honour. If a hero finds the cur that slept with his wife, he can best him in single combat, and get his 1 point of honour back! Or he can ask for a ruling from his Chief, gain a cow or two, perhaps as an honour price, but forgo that lost honour. Fights are always fought fairly, and no-one will intervene in such a fight.





IX RELIGION

There was little to burn in the cave so the soldiers had just piled branches up in the entrance and set light to it. By now the inhabitants were either dead from the smoke or poised to beg for surrender.

'About bloody time,' grumbled Arvinus as the flames died down. 'Got a couple of warm whores waiting for me at camp.'

'Wouldn't want to keep your sisters waiting,' retorted Tullius. The band of soldiers kicked the ashes aside as they advanced through the cave entrance. Tullius lit a torch and the carvings on the walls caught his eye. Hands, lots of them, chipped into the floor as well. Hares and birds. Trees, their branches picking up crude human figures.

'What do you reckon it means?' said Tullius.

'It means they're bloody savages, that's what.' Arvinus pointed at the pit in the cave floor. Several bodies, covered with soot, were curled up together where they had died. 'Got 'em.' Tullius wandered deeper into the cave. At the back was a heap of helmets – Roman helmets, split and battered. Handfuls of coins were scattered around them. Coins and bones.

'Look at this,' said Arvinus. Tullius turned to see a figure huddled in the corner – a boy, perhaps nine or ten, his mouth and nose covered in ash. He was struggling to breathe.

'You know what I love about Britain?' said Arvinus.

'What's that?'

Arvinus drew his sword. 'No civilians.'

Men and women are not alone on earth. They are surrounded by gods, by spirits and by malevolent entities dwelling in the dark recesses of the wilderness. Almost everyone believes in the gods, that they exist and that they can influence the course of human events in big ways and small ways, all of the time.

USING FATE

Titus Flaminius, son of Titus, of the Pollia tribe from Faventia, 45 years old, with twenty-two years' service, soldier of the Fourteenth Legion Gemina. I served as a soldier and now here I am. Read this and be more or less lucky in your life. The gods keep you from the wine-grape and water when you enter Tartarus. Live decently while your star grants you time for life.

Roman Inscriptions of Britain 292, from Viroconium, 1st C AD

FATE is a Saving Throw

FATE can be used to resolve some incident that relies on luck, fate and the unknown 'will of the gods'. Leaping a chasm, surviving poison, spotting an ambush in the woods - all are dependant on a FATE roll. Treat it as a catch-all luck skill. Roll 2D6 and add the FATE attribute - on a 10 or more the attempt succeeds. The Game Master may set the difficulty at 12 for some rolls.

FATE Can Also Be Spent

FATE can also be used to call on the gods for divine aid. A prayer uttered in an instant to a deity can result in an action succeeding *automatically*. However the adventurer's FATE attribute is then



temporarily lowered by 1 point. In addition, only **non-combat** actions can be rendered automatic in this way. When FATE reaches 0 the adventurer cannot make anymore further appeals.

Recovering FATE Through Sacrifice

To recover FATE points lost through appeals to the gods, a character can make a sacrifice to any god. The sacrifice must be made at a recognised temple or shrine of the god and be conducted by a priest of the cult. The cost of such a sacrifice will usually be 20 sestertii. Once completed (an hour long ritual is common) the character's FATE attribute is restored to its original level. FATE can only be restored in this way a maximum of once per day, at any shrine to any god.

Suitable sacrifices to the gods include a handful of wheat and a grain-garland, first fruits of the season, honey cakes and honeycombs, a meal, a cup of wine and pine cone (or imported) incense. British tribal warriors are fond of sacrificing the head of a warrior that they have killed in combat themselves! These bloody trophies are collected on the battlefield and make excellent dedications to the god in order to recover FATE!

Storing Sacrifices in Amulets

A faithful worshipper can purchase an amulet from a temple or priesthood that is crafted in the shape of the god's holy symbol. Any British tribesman can purchase the amulet of any British god; Roman cults only provide amulets to initiates, members of a god's religious collegium (see below). The amulet can be taken along during a normal sacrifice and the 'charge' that would normally restore the worshipper's FATE is instead stored within the amulet. This can be done a number of times until the amulet has a maximum of 6 'charges' in it.

To make use of a 'charge' the worshipper spends one round clutching the amulet and reciting a prayer to the god. Other people can use these charges if the worshipper wishes to give the amulet away, or sell it. Amulets are useful to those who travel and cannot always get to a temple. Amulets purchased from the temple typically cost 40 sestertii. If more than one amulet is owned by a worshipper, none will work.

Improvement Through Sacrifice

To improve an attribute, a character must first make a great sacrifice to his god. It is common for inhabitants of the ancient world to give thanks to the gods following a successful expedition or experience of any nature. This display of gratitude in Romanised areas usually takes the form of a stone altar dedicated to the god and both purchased at, and deposited at, one of the god's temples. Only a member of a religious collegium (see below) can dedicate an altar. The character must pay the temple 480 sestertii for this service and attend a sacrifice in which it is dedicated to the god. It costs an awful lot, but it is for permanent change. Most altars are dedicated by junior officers, centurions, tribunes or praetors.

British tribesmen do not dedicate Roman altars, but instead use votive offerings, often especially made wooden, stone or metal statues of the god or his animal form. These will hang in the sacred grove. Warriors may instead sacrifice a fine shield, sword or helmet to a god by casting into a sacred pool or river. Others may cast in some fine jewellery, perhaps a gold brooch or a torc. A minimum value of 480 sestertii or (in the tribes) 4 cows is needed, but the finer quality, the better!

<i>Attribute</i>	<i>Cost to improve 1 point</i>
HITS	1
MIGHT	current MIGHT+1
FATE	current FATE
CRAFT	current CRAFT
LEARNING	current LEARNING



The creation of the stele or the preparation of the ritual requires three days, and the a one hour ritual, led by a priest of the temple. At the conclusion of the ritual the character will gain 1 improvement point, saving it, or spending it to improve either HITS, MIGHT, FATE, CRAFT or LEARNING. It will take several dedications like this to the gods to increase FATE or MIGHT. A maximum of one dedication can be made by a character per game session/adventure.

GODS OF ROME

The gods of the Roman people accept sacrifices in every corner of the empire - even Britannia. Temples and shrines have sprung up wherever towns have developed. The Roman gods dwell in far away Olympus, while Dis Pater rules the Underworld. This is a dark place where the spirits of the dead must travel to after crossing the River Styx on a ferry. The ferryman, Charon, requires payment - lets hope your comrades placed a coin in your hand/mouth over your eyes when they buried you! In Roman Britain, a pair of hobnailed boots are often placed in graves for the long journey to the Underworld. The wicked go to pits of Tartarus, the good go to the blessed fields of Elysium. Quite quickly, the conquered Britons have taken to merging their own gods with the Roman deities. This varies from tribe to tribe; as a PC travels from town to town he will hear references to Mars Cocidius, Jupiter Taranis, Sulis Minerva and Apollo Belenus as well as others. Treat these hybrids as standard Roman gods in all respects.

Joining a Collegium

Worship of different gods is found in different walks of life. To join a cult means joining a religious collegium or brotherhood or like-minded worshippers. Player characters can join a collegia in order to 1) gain a new skill, 2) get a cult amulet and 3) form ties with others of the same collegium. Characters who like hunting, for example, can become initiates of Diana, gaining an amulet, a skill and the trust and help of other Diana cult members across Britain. To join a cult make a successful FATE roll and a donation of 50 sestertii. If failed, the character can try again in the next game. The skills associated with each collegium are listed here:

<i>God of the Collegium</i>	<i>Typical Membership</i>	<i>Skill</i>
Apollo	healers	First Aid
Bacchus	actors	Acting
Diana	hunters	Read Tracks
Juno	accountants, scribes	Evaluate
Jupiter	leaders	Organise
Mars	farmers	Healing Herbs
Mercury	merchants	Turn A Profit
Minerva	craftsmen	Mend
Neptune	horse-riders	Work Horse
Venus	lovers	Seduction
Vesta	bakers, potters	Fire Craft
Vulcan	armourers	Open Lock



Jupiter: The king of the Olympian gods. Also called Jove, Jupiter Capitolinus or Jupiter Optimus Maximus ('IOM' in inscriptions). He is a powerful god of sovereignty, mastery, government and victory in warfare. He is supreme judge and his realm is the Heaven (Earth belongs to his brother Neptune, the Underworld to his other brother Dis Pater). As a god on high he is associated with storms, rain, tempests and with thunder and lightning. He demands oaths of loyalty from its diverse subjects. All the legions and the soldiers within them hold Jupiter as their most high god.

Juno: The matronly wife of Jupiter, Juno is associated with the sky and with the moon. God of women and of childbirth and marriage, she is rarely invoked by soldiers. Her temple in the Rome houses the Imperial mint, since she is also goddess of banking. Juno punished many of Jupiter's lovers, and could be said to have also embodied jealousy. The peacock is her cult animal.

Mars: A brash god of warfare, Mars is popular with soldiers. Since the early legionaries were also farmers, he is a god of agriculture, too. Mars is invoked also for revenge. He is not a subtle god of grand strategy but an up-front believer in raw combat.

Vesta: The goddess of the home and hearth. Her temple in Rome houses a sacred flame, the hearth fire of the Empire, and is tended by twelve Vestal Virgins. The family and community are associated with her gentle cult.

Vulcan: The god of fire, smiths and craftsmen in general, Vulcan is a brawny, lame god. He is also associated with volcanoes. In myth he built many fantastic devices, some of which are reputed to be hidden about the world in labyrinths and on remote islands. His wife is the adulterous Venus. His priests are called 'flamen'. Temples to Vulcan are kept outside town walls since the god is associated with the destruction of volcanoes.

Mercury: The winged messenger of the gods, Mercury is also the god of thieves, travellers and merchants. Mercury guides the spirits of the dead to the underworld, and wayside marker stones are dedicated to him. The great cults to Mercury are run by the merchant brotherhoods to whom they owe their good fortune. Gamblers too, pray to him.

Apollo: A god of sunlight, musicians, fortune-tellers and medicine. This bold and potent god is also the protector of herdsman, but it is his association with the sun that is most strong. His deadly and unerring skill with the bow is symbolic of rays of light. But his typical symbol is the lyre. Many famous seers and soothsayers claim to have been given their powers by Apollo.

Neptune: The brother of Jupiter, Neptune is the god of the oceans and seas, as well as earthquakes and horses. A harsh and unrelenting god, Neptune shows his anger with floods, storms and earthquakes. Sailors fear him. The symbol of Neptune is the trident.

Venus: The amorous goddess of love, beauty and sex, married (in the myths) to Vulcan. She is fickle and passionate, and prone to initiating liaisons and romances. Young lovers pray to her. The Emperors of Rome all claim descent from Julius Caesar who claimed descent from Venus.

Bacchus: A god of wine, pleasure and revelry often invoked at bars, banquets and orgies. Since he is associated with wine cultivation he represents both the pleasures of wine and its darker side of mad passions and abuse. His favourite method of punishing wrong-doers is through madness. His cult throw wild orgies at which respectable women dance wildly in the countryside to the sound of raucous music.

Diana: Diana is the virgin sister of Apollo, and she is the goddess of hunting and of wildlife. As a fertility goddess she is invoked by mothers as well as more typically hunters. She has a lunar aspect and is well known as a great and deadly archer. The goddess also protects slaves, and her priests are traditionally supposed to be runaway slaves!

Minerva: Along with Juno and Jupiter, Minerva is one of the Capitoline triad, the central cults of the Imperial state. She is the goddess of wisdom and inventiveness, of women and the arts and crafts. Other professions looked to her, including doctors, teachers, actors, poets and students. Minerva is the armour-clad virgin daughter of Jupiter and burst, fully armed from his head. She is a warrior who fights for order, peace and righteous causes. After her birth she dispensed advice to her father.



Dis Pater: The grim and dark god of the Underworld who rules with his wife Persephone. He has no temples and no organised cult. Those who wish to call upon him must dig pits to throw down their sacrifices. He is a symbol of death. Also known as Pluto.

Aesculapius: The son of Apollo, god of Medicine and doctors. Aesculapius was in trouble with Dis Pater because he was preventing the new intake of the dead from arriving as they should have.

Fortuna: The goddess of fortune and good luck often called upon by gamblers in bath houses across the Empire.

Nemesis: The goddess of law and justice, Nemesis also rules over the powers of divine retribution. In some ways she is connected with destiny. The amphitheatre at Caerleon (Isca Silurium) has a shrine to Nemesis that is only accessible from the arena, no doubt used by gladiators.

The Muses: Nine daughters of Jupiter, goddesses of music, the arts, science, dance, theatre and history. The Muses are led by Apollo. Their cult centre is the Temple of Muses (Museum) at Alexandria.

Victoria: Specifically a goddess of the legions and emperors, an embodiment of victory and conquest.

Christ: Throughout the period covered by this game, the cult of Christ is frowned up (at best) or persecuted. The worshippers are opposed to sacrificing to the emperor, and this sets them up as traitors to the Roman empire. Worshippers meet at the house of their local leader (called a bishop) where they enact the last supper of their god. From 100 AD onwards only the largest towns in Britain will have a bishop. Prior to 100, worshippers will be few and far between.

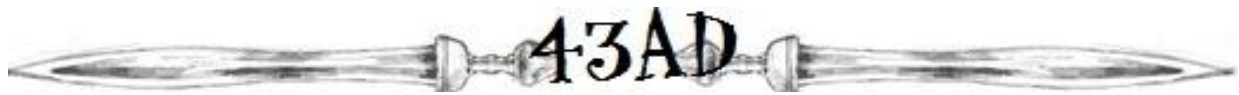
GODS OF BRITAIN

There is a recognised pantheon of gods in Britannia and the free tribes worship all of the gods described below. It is in the spirit of **43AD** that the tribes greatly fear their gods. They may fear one goddess or god above the others, the Brigantes, for example, fear Brigantia, the Iceni fear Andrasta and the Catuvellauni fear Camulos. These are the chosen gods of the kingdom, patron gods that must be placated, or bribed in order to gain boons for the tribes-people. Gods are worshipped at several holy places within the tribal territory and the mediators between their world and that of the tribes, are the druids. This section is intended to allow the GM to add in cultural details when roleplaying the tribes.

Gods of Britannia

<i>Name</i>	<i>Areas of Influence</i>
Andrasta	Revenge, Death and Winter, The Crone
Belenus	Sun, Leadership, Chariots and Horses
Brigantia	The Maiden, Spring, Fertility, War, Horses, Crafts
Camulos	War, Protection, Wild Boar
Cernnunos	Hunting, Wilderness, Animals
Govannon	Feasting, Weapons, Metalworking
Lugus	Oaths, Trade, Commerce, Laws
Nodens	Healing, The Spirit World, Water, The Ocean
Rosmerta	The Mother, the Moon, Prosperity and Fortune

During the Roman occupation, all of these gods continued to be worshipped, not just by the tribes, but also by Romans. Worship moved into the towns and into purpose built square-shaped temples. Local gods (see below) were always the exception, and Romans, Britons and travellers from elsewhere continued to worship these regional deities at their out-of-the-way shrines.



THE SKY GOD

The Sky God has a Triple Form, three aspects which have different titles, personalities and associations. The Sky God is a year god, representing the cycle of agricultural life. One aspect represents the youthful shoots, the next represents the crops bursting with life and energy, the third represents the withering of crops during the winter. Other Celtic cultures have their own names for these aspects, in **43AD** we will use the following god-forms, commonly encountered in iron-age and Roman Britain:

BELENUS – THE SHINING HERO: Belenus is the sky god in his aspect as youthful hero and virile warrior. He is the new king, he is powerful and confident, represented by dressed wooden poles and standing stones wreathed in cloak and greenery. Belenus is often represented by the Tribes as a Green Man or Leaf Hero, wreathed in vegetation. He is energetic, phallic and powerful. His accession to the kingship is marked by a great festival, Beltaine, naturally named after him. He gives the people of the Tribes new hope and confidence that the year would end with a great harvest, feasting and happiness. He is the Shining God.

Cult Centre: Belenus can be worshipped at any forest nemeton, or at any ritual pole or standing stone that has been set up on or near agricultural land.

Associations: The symbols of Belenus are the sun-wheel, swastika, and horse.

CAMULOS - THE MIDSUMMER CHAMPION: The Midsummer Champion is Camulos, the sun at its height during the summer solstice. This is a feast day dedicated to Camulos, the invincible, a powerful warrior god represented by 'midsummer giants', huge effigies woven from straw and wicker paraded through the community in excitable processions. Camulos is responsible for the protection of the tribe, with its crops and animals, but also with raiding neighbouring tribes for their wealth. Prisoners of war caught during these summer raids are sometimes sacrificed to Camulos the Midsummer Giant by being burnt alive in a giant wicker-effigy - a Wicker Man.

Cult Centre: The centre of Camulos' worship is Camulodunum, 'the Fort of Camulos' constructed at the centre of the conquered Trinovantes territory by the warrior tribe called the Catuvellauni. Camulos can receive his offerings at any sacred pool or river.

Associations: He is associated with geese, shields and swords, wild boar, ram horns, and oak leaves.

The Roman Cult: The Romans adopt Camulos as a fitting warrior god, and his name lives on in the new capital of the province of Britannia, Camulodunum – the 'Fort of Camulos'. He is equated with the Roman god of war, Mars (*Deo Marti Camulo*). Mars Camulos was worshipped in Londinium as a patron god of gladiators, perhaps because so many of his fanatical worshippers ended up enslaved and forced to fight as gladiators in the decades following the invasion. See the cult of Mars for more details.

LUGUS – THE OLD KING: Lugus is the harvest god, the deity who makes the most supreme sacrifice to provide a bountiful harvest for the tribes. This sacrifice costs him his life, however and Lugus is deposed. Some tribes claim the Old King is killed. In a way, the harvesting of the crops forms part of the rituals of the Old King, and help to kill him. The grain is slashed with sickles and then threshed on the threshing floor beneath ox hooves or the beating of threshing flails. Some tribes simulate a ritual strangling of the man who threshes the last of the corn, and then throw him in the river; others thresh the last of the corn on a man's back and chant "The Old King is being beaten to death!" Others go further, ritually murdering a human sacrifice in three different ways (strangling, throttling and then drowning in a lake or bog). Many tribes make corn figures and bury them with great ceremony, in effect the tribes are killing Lugus, the Old King - his time is up.



Cult Centre: Lugus receives his offerings at any forest nemeton, and in ritual pits dug into agricultural land.

Associations: Lugus is represented by the raven, by a three-faced head, and by a spear. His sanctuaries are sited on high places, prominent hills or heights.

The Roman Cult: The Roman's recognised the importance of Lugus, even if they hated the druids themselves. It was Rome's intention to undermine the cult at every opportunity and to eradicate its centres of worship. Mona was quickly invaded, the druids there massacred and the groves destroyed. Yet Lugus provides the tribes with their traditions and laws, and the glue needed to remain to bind the British society together. Several new towns were named after Lugus, and the Romans equated him with Mercury. Often, dedications, inscriptions and offerings made in Briton to Mercury, are actually to Lugus, the Celtic Mercury. Sometimes Mercury Lugus is depicted as a youth with winged cap, money pouch and staff wreathed with serpents, but often he is appears in the guise of a bearded old man wielding a spear and wearing a long Celtic cloak. The Romans certainly approved of the god's links with trade, and they linked his cult with the cult of his consort, Rosmerta (the Great Provider).

THE EARTH GODDESS

Like the Sky God, the Earth Goddess has a Triple Form, with three aspects that have different names and responsibilities. She is life itself and represents the endless cycle of life, from birth and youth through to motherhood and decline. These three aspects are often worshipped together by the tribes as the 'Mothers' or the 'Triple Mothers'. They also have their own individual cults, standing for separate aspects of human life. The three aspects of the Earth Mother are Brigantia (the Maiden), Rosmerta (the Mother) and Andrasta (the Crone).

BRIGANTIA - THE HIGH MAIDEN: The Maiden has many names (Brigid, Sirona, Rhiannon), but one common title amongst the tribes is Brigantia (the High Maiden). Brigantia is youth, hope, fertility, spring and healing. One of her aspects is the Flower Maiden, a spirit of spring in human form made up entirely of flowers. As Maiden, she deposes the Dark One and re-establishes the cycle of growth and life after the dormancy of winter. She is powerful and capable of fighting for the tribe. She is conqueror and defender. Brigantia is married to Belenus, the youthful sun-god. The festival of Imbolc is devoted to her.

Cult Centre: Brigantia may be worshipped at a forest nemeton, or on any high place, such as a hill or mountain.

Associations: Her symbols are birds and horses, shields and spears.

ROSMERTA - THE GREAT PROVIDER: Rosmerta is the Mother of life on earth, and she is the daughter of Don (the Great Mother). She is the fat, green productive side of the earth goddess, fertility, abundance, harvests and healthy children. She has many titles, from lady of abundance, to green goddess and lady of bread. The goddess is married to Camulos, the Midsummer Champion. She controls the cycle of the seasons and has control of the stars, heavens and moon.

Cult Centre: Rosmerta receives her offerings within the ground. Pits are dug to reach her and offerings made within them. They are then covered up. Later invocations can utilise the same ritual pits.

Associations: Her symbols are a basket of fruit, a purse, and a cornucopia (horn of plenty).

ANDRASTE - THE DARK ONE: Andraste is the earth goddess in mourning. She is winter, she is the barrenness and sterility of the cold winter months. Life is in retreat, death is on the prowl. Andraste encompasses revenge, death, battle, destiny and fate. She conjures the fears of the tribes - darkness and night, feuds, wars and disease. Andraste is both immensely feared and respected.



Cult Centre: Like Rosmerta, Andraste takes her offering underground, but she also receives sacrifices through the mirrored face of water. Any sacred river or pool can be used to worship Andraste. The Iceni tribe revere her.

Associations: Her symbols are ravens and hares

OTHER GODS

THE LOCAL GOD: Cocidius, Coventina, Don and Derventia are just four out of hundreds of local gods, lesser deities of Britain which dominate life in their local areas. Every region has a local god, perhaps residing in a spring, a pool, a river or forest. It might be the god of a mountain, a hill or a swamp. For the local clan or tribe, these gods are just as important as the more well known deities because they affect many aspects of life. Sudden illnesses, a run of bad fortune, poor crops, a fire, a missing person and so on are events linked not with chance or bad luck, but with the mood of the local god.

As with any temple, the shrine used by a clan to make offerings to a local god can be used by PCs to replenish their FATE points. All local clansmen are initiates of the god – any one of them can act as priest for the ceremony. Rarely are altars erected to these deities, more likely, offerings are cast into a river or pool or (if a forest god) broken and buried.

It is quite possible that a local god will suddenly make its displeasure known and turn a local community upside down with blight, anguish and fear. Sacrifices above and beyond the norm might be required, but even that may not be enough. The player characters might be the only ones able to restore the balance; the god might want a killer caught, an evil activity revealed, the sacrifice of a particularly unusual victim or something else entirely. As a plot element, treat the local gods as particularly powerful and unpredictable ghosts.

NODENS - GOD OF THE OTHERWORLD: Nodens is a mysterious figure, a son of Belenus and Don, who is responsible for the dead and for their journey to the Otherworld. He was once the king of the gods, but fought against the Giants and lost his hand in the battle. No king could rule if disfigured, but the divine smith Govannon, fashioned a hand of silver for him and with magic attached it to his body. This restored Nodens in body but he could not be restored to the throne. Nodens also rules the sphere of healing, and of the mysterious waters of rivers, lakes and seas. He allows spirits to pass through watery gateways into the Otherworld, and as such is the Gate-Keeper and the Keeper of the Dead.

Nodens is respected, but at times he is truly feared, for Nodens is also Lord of the Wild Hunt. He sweeps across the land of the living with his pack of hounds, collecting the souls of the dead, and taking the souls of the living, should they get in his way. Nodens is Known also as Nuada and Lludd.

Cult Centre: Nodens great centre is the River Severn, in Dobunni territory, in the west of Britain. This is Nodens's river, flowing out west into the Sunset Sea, it is famous for the Severn Bore, an awe-inspiring tidal wave that flows far upstream at certain times of the year. However, Nodens receives his sacrifices at any body of water.

Associations: His symbols are fish, as well as hand figurines and dogs.

The Roman Cult: The Roman cult of Nodens is equated with Mars. Mars Nodens has a number of rectangular shrines dedicated to him, and these are centres of healing. Nodens was also associated with Silvanus, a Roman god of hunting, this reflects Nodens role in the British pantheon as Lord of the Wild Hunt.

GOBANNOS – THE GREAT SMITH: Gobannos is another son of Don and Belenus. He is the Great Smith, that god of arcane wisdom who gave mankind the knowledge to turn rock into liquid fire and from that into beautiful bronze and iron artefacts.

The god is also revered as the provider of the feast, with the implements of feasting (cauldrons, firedogs and spits) and with the brewing of beer. He is said to have invented a brew that bestowed immortality on a warrior, keeping him free from injury, illness and death. Of course Gobannos also crafted Nodens' silver hand, and also the weapons and armour of the gods.

Cult Centre: Gobannos is worshiped at a tribe's forge. The forge must be alight and in working order! Cooking fires, pottery or tile kilns will not do!

Associations: Offerings made to Gobannos include pots decorated with the images of smithing tools, and also tablets of zinc (a white metal alloy made up from the detritus of iron smelting).

CERNUNNOS – THE HORNED ONE: This cross-legged, stag-horned deity is the keeper of his vast and foreboding forest realm. He has power over all animals and over all wild plants and trees, and can summon with his stag's bellow, a host of animals to him more numerous than all the stars in the heavens. He is Lord of the Wild Beasts, patron of the hunt and of the hunted - his totem animals were both stag and hound. Cernunnos is the king of all that sits beyond the living world of fields, round-houses and pastures.

Cult Centre: Cernunnos can be worshipped at any forest nemeton. There are other wilderness holy places, particularly hills, cliffs and mountains, that are also suitable places from which to ask a favour of Cernunnos.

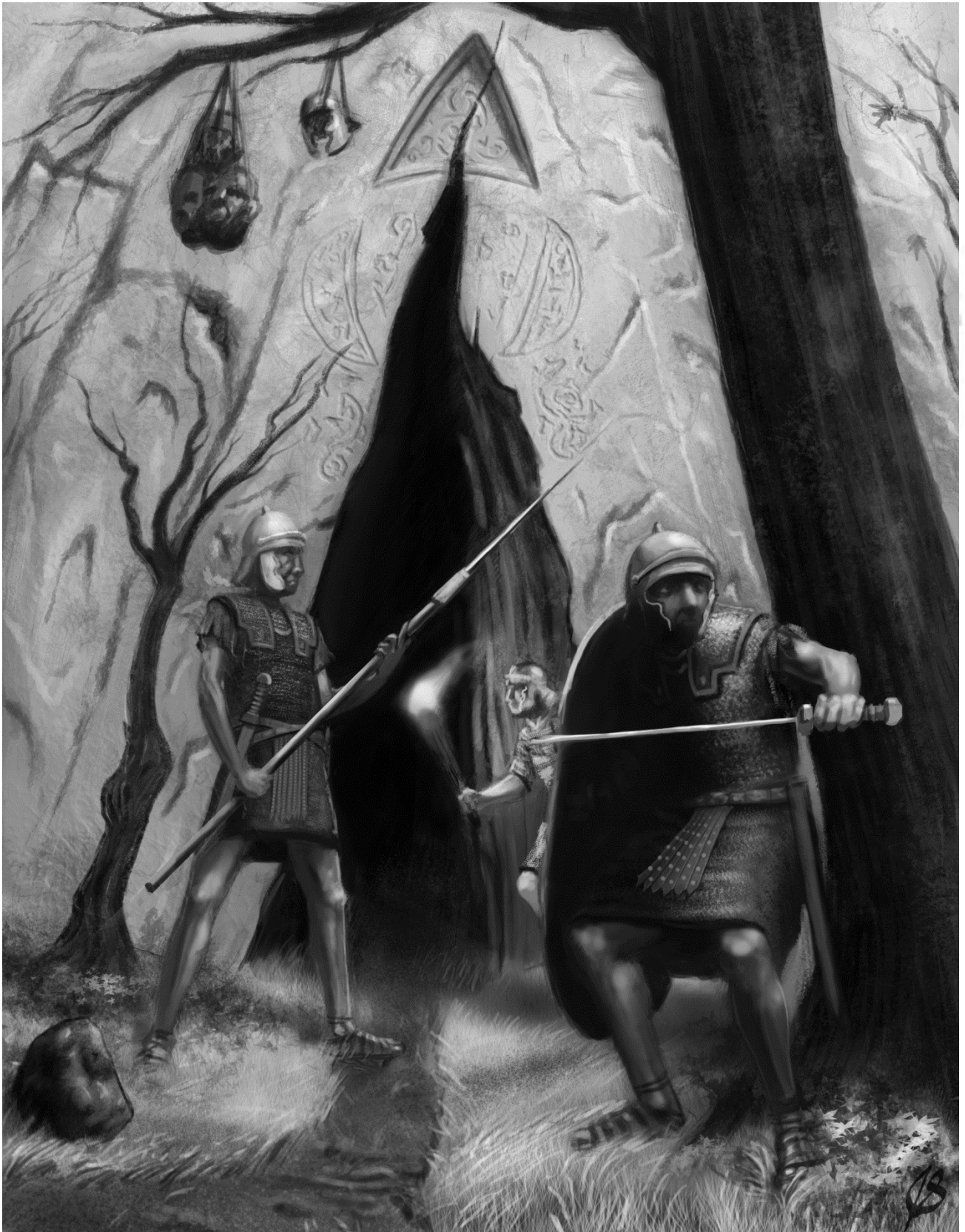
Associations: Dogs, stags.

THE CELTIC OTHERWORLD

Despite what later myth might suggest, the gods of the tribes live with the spirits of the dead in the Otherworld, far below the surface of the earth. There are ways down into this land, but they are guarded by supernatural monsters, demons that act as 'gate-keepers', preventing human-kind from going where the living should never go. The Britons sometimes refer to these guardian monsters as the Fomorions, or simply as **the Hidden**. These demons control the physical world around them, and can make life dangerous for the tribes. Most communities placate the monsters with offerings and sacrifices. More detail is provided in chapter X Adding Horror.

The dead are exposed on the edges of clan territory on wooden platforms, and after one lunar month, what is left by the crows is cremated and then buried with grave goods. The spirits of the dead go to the Otherworld through one of the watery gateways, and once there live a wonderful existence in the Land of Summer, where life is bright and full of feasting and love, happiness and cheer, where there is no death or winter, cruelty or disease.







X ADDING HORROR

'Dearest Poppaea,' said Melitta, hurrying into the atrium. 'Have you heard about Atella?' Poppaea looked up from her work inscribing the tile. 'Atella? No, do tell.'

'It's not just idle gossip, Poppaea. She's dead.' Poppaea's eyebrows rose. 'Dead? How?'

'She threw herself off the cliffs. They brought her body up this morning.' Poppaea tutted grandly. 'So sad. I feared for her, living all the way out here while her husband was fighting the Brigantes. No doubt her delicate little mind finally snapped.'

*'After that poor slave girl went mad, and Rufilla smothered her child... what next, I ask?' There were drops of fear in Melitta's eyes. 'I mean... what if it is this **place**? It is so bleak and distant. What if it is doing something to us even as we speak?'*

'Hush Melitta,' said Poppaea. 'Do not speak of such things.'

When Melitta was gone on her insignificant business, Poppaea summoned her favourite slave-girl. She handed the girl the tile she had been inscribing.

O hidden, it read, rob Melitta of her wits.

Kill her children.

Strike her barren.

Lead her husband astray.

Drive her mad.

O oppop o oppop oi moi pheu pheu

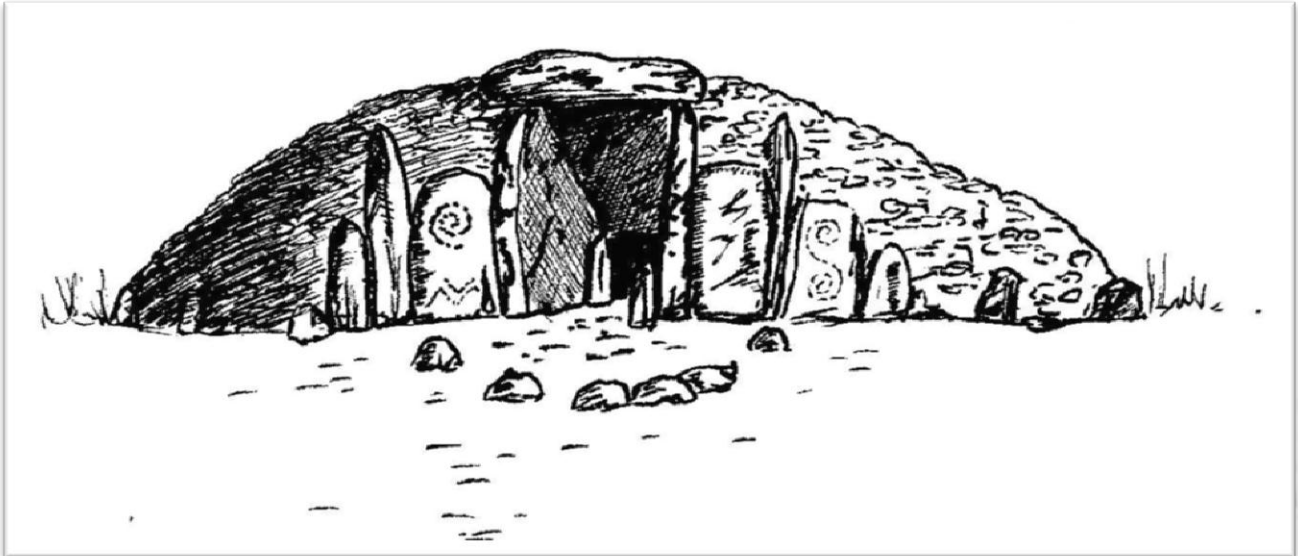
Hear this plea

'Bury this beneath Melitta's doorstep,' she told the slave-girl. 'Hurry, for she will be home soon.' Poppaea smiled as the slave-girl scurried off. Britain could be so dull. One had to make one's own entertainment.

HORROR IN THE GAME

The Game Master can play **43AD** on one of two different levels. The first level is most familiar, that of legionaries in a hostile land, battling savage tribes and experiencing tough, no nonsense military adventures. The second level adds horror. 'Out there,' horror lurks, the tribes are aware of it and it partly explains some of their bloodier rituals. Legionaries may stumble upon it from time to time in between military adventures. This level recognises that the land of Britain, the Island of the Mighty, is dark and sinister and crawling with malign entities, both spiritual and very physical. The tribes have lived alongside these monsters for generations, and have learned to pacify and contain them.

The Game Master is of course free to ignore all of these darker aspects to the world and concentrate solely on the human-orientated campaigns already detailed. But it is rather easy to combine the horror of these entities with other types of campaign. Horror ***always*** works best when it impinges on the normal, and the everyday, and when it surprises, shocks and challenges, over-turning what characters know about life in **43AD** and how the world is supposed to work.



Horror in the Tribe

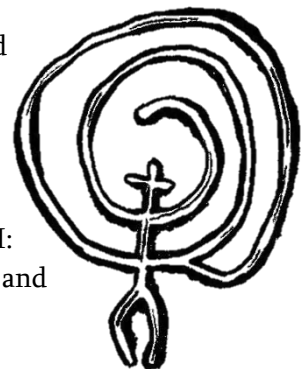
The existence of these creatures provides a rationale for the customs and behaviour of the Britons and is a fundamental part of their religion. Why do Britons cut off heads? Why do they throw human sacrifices into peat bogs after killing them in three different ways? Why do they tie victims to posts at the bottom of deep pits? What are the Britons afraid of?

Military Campaigns - With Horror

Veni, Vidi, Voratum (I came, I saw, I was devoured)

What will the Romans make of these terrors? They will do as their historical antecedents did and continue the placations and endless offerings - once units of toughened legionary veterans have gone to their deaths screaming and whimpering in a forest glade, or lost in the woods, close to their fort - the administration will actively promote the continuance of offerings. These things are wild, ancient and unstoppable. There are many horror movies that have touched upon the merging of the horror genre with that of the military, and that have isolated the protagonists and then shown them the uselessness of their feeble weaponry. Look to *The Keep*, *Aliens*, *Dog Soldiers*, *The Bunker*, and *Predator*. Legionaries, cut off from their fort at an outpost or in the wilderness, must fend for themselves when they come face to face with a monster that intends to wipe them all out.

Such monsters could wreak havoc in a Roman settlement, as any watcher of good horror movies knows. No-one believes the player-characters who suspect its presence, yet it is fixed in its purpose and will continue on its rampage. The players must discover its plan and its weakness, if it has one. There are innumerable horror movies that feature some ancient and unstoppable creature that has penetrated a small community, and some offer great ideas for the GM: *Sleepy Hollow*, *30 Days of Night*, *Ginger Snaps Back*, *The Village*, *Salem's Lot* and *The 13th Warrior*, for example.





MONSTERS

The Cave Crawlers

To take him in the dark had been their plan: to leap and grasp him with their sinewy hands ... they croaked and hissed...

The Weirdstone of Brisingamen

Beneath the ground, within rock and soil, inside mountains and hills, is a never-ending maze of tunnels. The Crawlers live within this subterranean world, a world made up of caverns, caves, tunnels, passageways and pits. The Crawlers appear as emaciated humans, short and wiry. Their skin is pale, their eyes large and they fight with claw and tooth. These creatures eat meat, coming out of their caves at night to hunt deer, hare ... or human. The crawlers are not blind, but can operate in the dark perfectly. Victims trapped in the caves with Crawlers may be able to hide from them simply by remaining motionless. They have no speech or culture of any kind, yet live in small groups, hiding from humans until these unwitting fools penetrate deep into their natural caves.

MIGHT 9 HITS 9 1 Attacks, Speed 20yds

Powers: Invisible when motionless in the dark allowing ambush, can see in the dark

Invisible Hound

This huge hellhound can be heard, perhaps baying pitifully at the Moon, or for blood, and tracks may be seen in the mud at sunrise. Its breath can be felt, by travellers out on the moors late at night, on the back of their necks, and gorse bushes might twitch and part to reveal the beast's location. But there is never a sight of it. It is invisible, and it is an awful thing to see someone flailing around on the floor, gouts of blood erupting, being dragged left and then right as an invisible beast rips and shreds. Part of an arm or a leg, or a victim's throat vanishes into the invisible maw.

MIGHT 11 HITS 18 1 Attack, Speed 30yds

Powers: Invisible (unless somehow is found to negate this power, attackers suffer a -4 penalty), always knows the location of its prey, can appear or vanish into rivers, pools, streams, wells etc.

The Thing in the Hut

There might be a round-house at the dun, with no windows ... **and no doors**. Within lives an insane prisoner, a deformed member of the clan. This 'thing' possesses unearthly strength, a total lack of compassion, and a pair of blinking eyes in the back of its head. Perhaps the clan persecuted her after the thing in the hut killed her own sister when both were toddlers. The thing wants its revenge on the clan, when circumstances permit, perhaps when the last surviving sister of the family marries a foster son staying with the clan. How do the PCs get involved in the coming blood-bath? Who lets her out ... and why?

MIGHT 13 HITS 10 1 Attack, Speed 20yds

Powers: none



Headless Killer

Carrying an unbreakable sword, the headless killer emerges from the mist to wreak his vengeance on an isolated community. He can be fought, he can be stopped - but he cannot be killed. The Headless Killer collects heads and ties them to his belt. They whisper the name of his next victim, and if several people attack the killer, the heads gibber and shriek, giving him advice and warnings. The Headless Killer will kill anyone who gets in his way and if he cannot get to a victim (he cannot cross flowing water, which might protect a victim) then he will vanish into a sudden mist.

MIGHT 12 HITS 14 4 Attacks, Speed 20yds

Powers: Vanishes for 24 hours when reduced to zero HITS, can appear close to his intended targets

Flayed Man

Once a hero was captured by his mortal enemies. They flayed him alive and sent him screaming and bleeding into the night. A generation later, a Flayed Man has come staggering out of the woods, looking for 'his skin'. Perhaps he is going to flay every living relative to those persecutors who 'killed him' all those years ago. The Flayed Man has no skin, he is pulpy mass, raw and bloody - he has no eyeballs. This fiend kills his victim, then flays them and carries the skin away to dry. He lives within a cave, where he dries his new-found skins over an ice-cold fire. He will sniff out his next victim, and carry two knives with him for the flaying. The Flayed Man wears a cloak of human faces.

MIGHT 10 HITS 16 2 Attacks, Speed 20yds

Powers: Vanishes for 24 hours when reduced to zero HITS, can appear close to his intended targets

Bavaan

The Bavaan is a vampire-like creature, a feral hag, that has its lair in remote places. Twisted and gnarled, the creature appears to an old woman with lank hair, staring eyes and twisted fangs. It has membranous wings, ragged and filthy, and it hides in daylight hours in caves and hollows. It will attack when the travellers are vulnerable, sleeping, eating or arguing. Typically it will seize a victim with lightning speed and drag it into the air to find a suitable perch where it will drain the victim's blood at 1 HIT per round. Bodies dropped to the ground are useless limp husks.

MIGHT 8 HITS 12 1 Attack, Speed 45yds (fly)

Powers: Flies silently, grab and immobilise victim on a MIGHT roll (- victim's MIGHT), can vomit blood once at an attacker to blind him for 2 rounds (roll FATE to avoid)

Fomorians

It bore some resemblance to a woman, an ill-proportioned woman, twenty feet high, and green. The long thick set trunk rested on massive legs and curving bloated thighs... It wore a single garment, a loose tunic that reached to the ground, and clung to the body in folds like wet linen.

The Weirdstone of Brisingamen

The Island of the Mighty once belonged to the race of giant-king now living only in remote wilderness areas. They are primitive, foul and utterly without law, or compassion. They move silently at night, in the twilight hours or in thick fog - if they are caught out in the direct sunlight they will be turned to stone. Fog and mist gives them the freedom to roam during the day. The Fomorians have long bodies, gangling and twisted. Their faces are deformed, their eyes staring blank (their eyesight is very poor). Some giants



are hunchbacked or lame, or have two heads that gibber madly to one another. The giants either go naked, or dress in filthy rags. They can eat anything and anyone, but are not voracious. A giant stands 30 feet high. It makes a good hunter, since it is able to sniff out humankind easily. Fomorians moan and howl to one another as a form of communication, they lost the power of speech centuries ago.

MIGHT 14 HITS 24 1 Attack, Speed 30yds

Powers: Smell humans at some distance

Hunting Crows

Half-way along the ridge the birds attacked. In a cloud they fell, clawing and pecking, and buffeting with their wings.

The Weirdstone of Brisingamen

Hunting Crows are intelligent, evil and will eat human flesh. Often they wheel over desolate moors in 'murders' looking for prey. If a victim is chosen, they mercilessly attack, coming down in a black cloud of feathers and fury.

MIGHT 8 HITS 10 6 Attacks, Speed 45yds (fly)

Powers: The flock is driven away when reduced to zero HITS

Cauldron Born

In some lonely forest a huge, decorated cauldron bubbles within a large round-house. Black Druids are able to put inside it the heads of dead heroes, and within a day they re-emerge as one of the cauldron born. These are undead, warriors, misshapen, inarticulate, unthinking - zombies. The Black Druids can create a small army of these fiends, and use them in their nefarious plans. If one of the zombies is killed, returning its head to the cauldron will result in the fiend being reborn whole, within a day! A wound or maim on the throat or head will kill one of the cauldron born instantly.

It is said by some that the cauldron born murdered their dark masters in 120 AD and rampaged over the countryside, collecting heads for the cauldron, turning an army into a vast hoard. Caledonia was overrun, Roman forces were surprised and overrun until a counter-attack led by governor Quintus Pompeius Falco was mounted. The emperor himself travelled to the province to oversee the building a vast fortification that might keep any future cauldron born at bay - Hadrian's Wall. Several raids, forays and expeditions (the last conducted in 208 by Septimus Severus, again *in person*) have been mounted by the Roman army to find this magical cauldron.

MIGHT 7 HITS 6 1 Attack, Speed 20yds (cannot run)

Powers: none, treat as a typical movie zombie, albeit moving at a faster 'shamble'

Vengeful Spirit

Although a local god provides a clan or tribe with rich crops, healthy children and good fortune, sometimes the god turns against the living. These petty gods, these nature spirits, trapped in their ancient woods or mysterious pools, can menace human-kind. There may be a reason why the god has turned against the tribe, or it may have always hunted humans in this way. Like a powerful ghost haunting a particular location, the vengeful spirit can perhaps be placated with ever more elaborate sacrifices, or the setting right of its situation. Vengeful spirits manifest in very physical ways, although the attributes



below can act as a basic guide, alter them to suit the spirit itself. Likewise the spirit's beast-form will vary tremendously, from monstrous animal (stag, eel, etc.) to animated natural feature (walking tree, face in the rock, pillar leafs or dust devil, etc.), to man-creature (vampire, beast-headed warrior, giant, long-armed goblin etc.). These monsters rarely venture far from the source of their power (a sacred tree, pool, lake, cave, peak, standing stone, etc.).

MIGHT 12 HITS 18 3 Attacks, Speed 30yds

Powers: alter local surroundings to confuse or trap opponents, will vanish when reduced to zero HITS (unkillable), manifest as a specific human (girl, maiden, hag, old man, mute green-skinned warrior)

GROUPS & CLANS

Face Feeders

There is a clan in the wilderness, on the fringe of human existence that few know of: the Face Feeders. Those who know of it believe it to be a myth. These Face Feeders are cannibals, outcasts without rules, laws, society or soul. Within their terrifying rath are cooking pots full of eyeballs, chopping boards littered with fingers and hands ... The Face Feeders attack isolated raths, and take prisoners to devour at a later time. Sometimes they will feast at the rath, or they will 'disappear' the entire population.

MIGHT 9 HITS 9 1 Attack, Speed 20yds

Skinchangers

There are ancient clans out on the fringes of the wilderness haunted by ancient curses. The Skinchangers are cursed with two forms, one beast, one human - they are were-creatures. During the day the clan members go about the business of farming and herding livestock, but at night they transform into the clan's animal form, yet it is a hulking brute of an animal - a monstrous unnatural version of that animal. Perhaps they become wolves, badgers, pole-cats, bears, rats, foxes, wild boar or wolves. They actually climb out of their human skin, leaving them hung up from the rafters of the roundhouse to return to them at dawn.

MIGHT 11 HITS 12 2 Attacks, Speed 20yds
(human) 30yds (animal)

In the wilds around the rath there may be some evidence of this curse, perhaps burrows, or bone deposits, or droppings containing human teeth and nails. It goes without saying that these Skinchangers are also cursed with a hunger for human flesh!

Black Druids - the Hooded Ones

These druids have been perverted to the cause of evil, and follow the orders of the witch Scathach. In all other respects they resemble normal druids. It is their intent that makes them formidable, using their powers for evil, bringing ruin onto communities rather than benefit, using the druid's ban to create cursed





individuals that will plague a community (perhaps the Flayed Man began his unearthly existence like this). Black Druids commonly wear the long travelling capes that hide their faces and often travel either singly or in threes. Many are skilled with the longsword and use their swordsmanship to surprise druids and slay them hand-to-hand.

Use statistics for druids; but all have MIGHT scores of 2-6 and wield longswords.

<i>Black Druid</i>				[COMBAT + 5]
MIGHT 3	CRAFT	4	SKILLS	Seek Audience, Work Horse
FATE 6	LEARNING	5	WEAPONS:	Dagger +1, Sword+2
HITS 16	ARMOUR	-	SPELLS	Beast-tongue, Magic Fire
PROTECTIVE MAGIC: 3pts			Countermagic, Disguise, Bless, Curse You	

INDIVIDUALS

Longinus - Undead Centurion

Tradition names the legionary that put Christ on the cross - Longinus. It does not say that he was actually cursed for his efforts and now walks the land as an immortal. He was killed in Germania six years later, but dug his way out of the grave and fled the legions - insane. Now he is in Britain, perhaps the sinister lieutenant of Hadrian, or Septimus Severus or a governor without scruples (do any have scruples?). He cannot be killed and is fearless in battle. Longinus may have his own motives for helping the Roman legions, he might have heard that the Holy Grail is hidden away amongst the Tribes somewhere, or the Spear of Destiny (that pierced Christ's side while he hung from the cross). Both or either might rid the undead centurion of his curse, the spear may be the only thing that can kill him (does he wish for suicide, or to destroy it?), while the Grail may restore his sanity. His enemies will certainly want to get their hands on the spear! Weapons do not like to strike Longinus, they all do 1 HIT (maximum), never severing arms or head etc. Poison, fire ... all turn away from his tainted flesh. At the most he will appear dead, but enter a coma, and then dig his way out once he awakens... very Rasputin-like ...

<i>Longinus</i>				[COMBAT + 8]
MIGHT 6	CRAFT	2	SKILLS	
FATE 6	LEARNING	3	WEAPONS:	Sword+2, Dagger+1
HITS 15	ARMOUR	3d	Helm, Breastplate (for appearances)	

The Old Crone of Abberros

She is a seer and prophetess, aged and decayed, and said by all to have lived more than ten generations and seen the gods walk. Her word is law for every tribe-member, yet the druids seem to shun her. The Crone regularly presides over ceremonial hunts for 'plotters' and 'evildoers' (anyone she considers a threat) where the accused are slain or sent as offerings to the local god. Some say she is immortal and cannot be killed, some say she is the goddess Andraste, others that she is Don. Older than the hills, she remembers when you could walk to Gaul unimpeded by wave or water, and when winter lasted all year, every year, year after year. If she is killed ... does her spirit repossess the body of a maiden within the tribe?



<i>Old Crone of Abberros</i>				[COMBAT + 2]
MIGHT 2	CRAFT	4	SKILLS	Detect Lies, Silent Move, Evaluate
FATE 5	LEARNING	6	WEAPONS:	Staff +0
HITS 14	ARMOUR	-	SPELLS	Agony, Oracle, Charm,
PROTECTIVE MAGIC: 4pts			Beast-tongue, Curse You, Magic Fire	

Scathach the Witch

Scathach is a witch from the west, Hibernia - Land of Winter. More formidable than any Druid, she has been outcast from her homeland and now seeks to dominate tribes, kingdoms ... empires. She has set herself up in a dun on one of the Caledonian islands and there trains her own Black Druids, and her own black-hearted heroes. Members of this poisonous tribe are sent out to carry out tasks for Scathach, undermining and destabilising the kingdoms. Many of the druids have come to know of her, yet cannot match her power. All they can do is attempt to hold back the Black Druids.

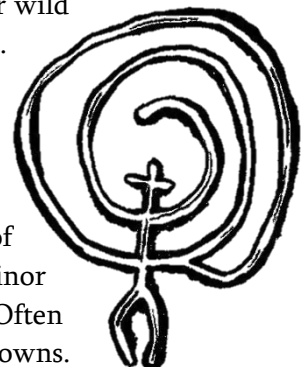
Scathach teaches her warriors personally, having the blood of Gog running through her veins. She is half-giant, 6 feet tall and strong. She cannot tolerate bright sunshine, but prefers to move about on foot, on horse-back or in chariot, at night. She can send out the Hunting Crows or her warriors to spy for her during the day.

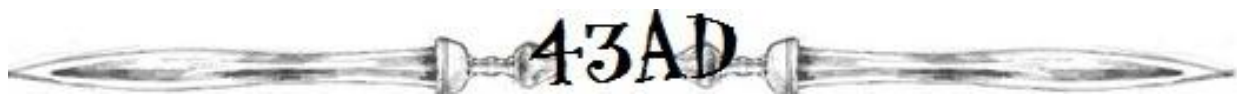
The dark god Balor, banished to Hibernia many winters ago, may supply her power or her army of warriors - he might control her or be trying to contain her. Scathach may think she acts of her own free will, when it is actually Balor 'of the Evil Eye' that is in true command, looking forward to the day when he can once again return to the Island of the Mighty.

<i>Scathach the Witch</i>				[COMBAT + 10]
MIGHT 7	CRAFT	4	SKILLS	Hard to Kill, Two Attacks, Warcry
FATE 6	LEARNING	2	WEAPONS:	Sword+2, Shield+1,
HITS 20	ARMOUR	-	Dagger+1	
PROTECTIVE MAGIC: 2pts			SPELLS Agony, Disguise, Oracle, Countermagic, Curse You	

SPELL CASTING

Magic is a reality for anyone living in Britannia, whether Roman magistrate or wild Caledonian head-hunter. They believe in it, and so rules are included for it. There are no lightning bolts and walls of fire, however, the effects are often unseen, and could be misconstrued as accident or unusual happening. Magic is the technique of controlling the universe through use of hidden or unseen powers. A druid is a wizard-priest, depending on his connection to local gods and tribal deities to work his magics. A magician calls on dark powers, spirits of the dead and demons to carry out his works, most are concerned with minor magical curses and cures that can be bought by desperate individuals. Often magicians are solitary figures, living alone in the wilderness or in villages and towns.





Spells here have no numerical value, once learned they are mastered and they do not require any written component or spellbook. The Game Master should interpret each spell not just as a single effect 'trick', but almost as a broad skill, providing a package of knowledge and experience of the occult. In addition, the spell's effects can be manipulated, perhaps by adding more HITS during the casting.

Casting Spells

When a witch or a druid wishes to cast a spell, he declares his intention to the GM and deducts 1 point temporarily from his HIT points score. A spell requires one combat round to cast, requires the caster to be unbound and ungagged and takes effect automatically. It does **not** take effect automatically when directed against a target who will be resisting the effects of a power (the target of a Sleep spell, for example). His target must make a successful FATE roll (as a resistance roll), and the spell fails if the target's roll succeeds. Most witches and druids have a magical staff which can extend the range of a power out to 100 yds.

There are two lists of spells, those open to witches and those open only to druids. No-one else may learn a spell and new spells are taught to these two types of characters either by an expert, or by dark spirit, all following significant study and sacrifice. As a final note, few of the spells are helpful and upbeat, many are dark, twisted and nasty, fitting the horrific edge of **43AD** and in keeping with the way magic was viewed in the ancient world.

Druid Spell List	Witch Spell List
Beast-tongue	Agony
Bran's Blessing	Brew Charm
Counterspell	Potion
Dancing Harp	Brew Poison
Eye of Balor	Brew Healing
Faerie Fire	Potion
Frenzy	Call the Dead
Glamour	Charm
Healing Spirit	Comprehend
Oracle	Defixion
Protective Magic	Lock
Shapeshifting	Oracle
	Sleep
	Talisman

The Druid's Spell List

Beast-tongue – This power gives the caster the ability to speak with any type of animal for 10 minutes. Most animals know very little of use, but the right creature at the right time may have much to say that is useful to the druid. A separate casting of this spell may be used to call a creature to the caster, and if the druid is in the right place (close to a den, a river bank, etc., roll 2d6 for 6 or more), it will appear within a few minutes.

Bran's Blessing – A druid can bless people, groups, raths, even tribes. The favour of the gods is bestowed upon the recipient, and something that could go wrong – goes right. Blessing one person costs 1 HIT, blessing a family costs 3 HITS, blessing a clan costs 9 HITS and blessing a tribe costs 27 HITS. Druids can team up to share the burden, and the HITS cost. Typical blessings include a good harvest, a cow or wife having an easy birth, a hunting trip, battle, looking for a lost child, etc. When cast on a PC, the recipient gains three free 'rerolls'. If rerolling 2d6, that counts as a single reroll.

Counterspell - A spell of protection against spirits, demons, ghosts and the magical powers of monsters, witches or black druids. When attacked by a spirit, magical force or spell this power gives the user (only) a +2 bonus on his FATE score (for defensive purposes only). A Counterspell power lasts for 10 minutes.



Dancing Harp – Music and song is powerful, druids learn early on how to play the harp and tell stories of legends, kings, battles and monsters. Dancing Harp is a spell of group magic, the song influencing the emotions of any or all of the listeners should the FATE roll of the most distinguished listener be unsuccessful. The druid may target a specific person or group of people, by a careful wording of his song. How does the druid want to influence his audience? His intended effect determines the cost of the spell in HITS. To be liked and trusted costs 1 HIT. To temper an emotion, turning hatred into anger, or friendship into love, costs 2 HITS. To summon an emotion out of thin air, costs 3 HITS, and to reverse a currently strong emotion (the king's champion loves the king's daughter, but now hates her!) costs 4 HITS. The emotions are not magical and do not wear off suddenly.

Eye of Balor – Druids can curse their enemies, as well as members of the tribes who have broken the laws. The druid vents his fury at the victim, closing one eye, standing on one leg and pointing with one hand, and the curse takes effect if the leader of that group fails a FATE test. It is the opposite of a blessing. A druid can curse people, groups, raths, even tribes. The disfavour of the gods is bestowed upon the recipient, and something that could go wrong – does go wrong. Cursing one person costs 1 HIT, cursing a legionary squad costs 3 HITS, cursing a century costs 9 HITS and cursing a legion costs 27 HITS. Druids can team up to share the burden, and the HITS cost. Typical curses include a bad harvest, a cow or wife having a miscarriage, a disastrous hunting trip, defeat in battle, losing one's son in the woods, etc. When cast on a PC, the Game Master decrees that any doubles rolls on a 2d6 roll (double 4, double 6 etc.) made by the player become catastrophic fumbles with terrible repercussions. The curse ends after the first fumble, unless the druid invested extra HITS in the spell, every extra HIT extends the spell to one more fumble...

Faerie Fire - The druid can use this power to create a 'magical fire', a fire that burns without fuel (on stone or sand, for example). The fire is the equivalent of a torch, and will illuminate an area 30 feet across. If cast on flammable materials, the magic fire will begin to spread just as any other fire would. Faerie Fire can also be used to extinguish a normal cooking-sized fire. Anybody on fire (or caught within a fire) will suffer 1-3 points of damage every round. If a victim's clothes are on fire (the target can make a resistance roll to prevent a druid casting Faerie Fire onto his clothes!) the victim can try to make a Might roll to put out the fire. Anyone can come to his aid and put the fire on the victim's clothes out automatically.

Frenzy – This spell can be cast on a friendly warrior, or on an enemy. If cast on a friend, the target enters a violent frenzy and his MIGHT is raised by +1 for 3 combat rounds. The spell must be cast on a warrior who has already begun to fight. To raise MIGHT by +2, the druid must spend 3 HITS, to raise MIGHT by +3 he must spend 6 HITS. Casting Frenzy on a foe causes that foe to become confused. If he fails a FATE roll he will consider his own comrades to be the enemy! Extra HITS spent to cast the spell will prolong it, at a rate of 1 HIT = 1 extra combat round.

Glamour – Using this spell the druid can alter the appearance of one person (or himself). He may take the likeness of someone he knows, or that of a 'random' person. The glamour will wear off in twelve hours unless another HIT is used to maintain the spell. Note that this is an illusion, the druid looks and sounds convincing, but his mannerisms and behaviours may give him away, depending on circumstance.



Healing Spirit – The druid calls upon a healing spirit which will, if placated with a FATE point from the injured person, restore 6 points of HITS. A patient's HITS can only be increased to a maximum of their initial value by this method, and the spirit may only visit him once per day (maximum).

Oracle - This spell requires the use of specially marked knucklebones. These are shaken like dice and cast onto the ground for a reading. They are used to decide between two or more alternatives, with the knucklebones giving the caster a 'preferred' or 'favoured' decision. The power cannot be used to resolve complex problems, only obvious choices (which path to take, which inn to stay at, which boat to hire, etc.). In this way bad choices can hopefully be eliminated.

Protective Magic – A common protective spell, used by druids and warriors. It requires war paint, or tattoos (which by their very nature are permanent, and do not need repainting each day). There are three levels of this spell, costing 1, 2 or 3 HITS respectively. Each provides a level of magical armour value, AV 1, 2 or 3, with the effect lasting for ten minutes once invoked. This is the only spell that druids teach to the warriors for their own protection. It involves painting one's body in ritual spirals and magical symbols in order to gain the effect. Armour can also be worn if possessed.

Shapeshifting – The druid can change himself into a proud and powerful wild animal, perhaps an otter, a crow, a bear or a mouse. He retains his intelligence, memory and personality, but his clothing and equipment magically vanish until the druid returns to normal. The transformation (either way) will require 10 minutes and last for up to 3 hours.. A transformed animal cannot speak human languages or use human tools.

The Witch's Spell List

Agony - This spell causes a living target within 30 feet to double up in pain for 1-3 rounds, and suffer 3-6 points of damage. The target can make a FATE roll to resist.

Brew Charm Potion -For the cost of 60 sestertii in materials the witch can create a single phial of love or charm potion. It takes 5 days to brew the potion. This potion, once drunk, brings a person under the influence of the caster. The target can make a FATE resistance roll, and if failed will loyally agree to any proposition the caster puts to him. He will not harm the caster, but equally, will not harm himself, or his loved ones. Most charmed victims will have no compunction about turning against their friends and colleagues, however. The potion might last forever, but could be negated by another witch reversing the potion with a counter potion. Note that if the caster ever turned against the victim, the effect would be broken. Charm potions can be made as love potions, binding the drinker, not to the witch, but instead to the person paying for the potion!

Brew Poison -For the cost of 10 sestertii in materials the witch can create a single phial of poison. It takes 2 days to brew the potion. It has a potency of 2d6+8.



Brew Healing Potion - For the cost of 10 sestertii in materials the witch can create a single phial of healing potion. It takes 4 days to brew the potion. This potion of healing holds enough to heal up to 18 HITS and can be drunk by as many people as need it until all 18 points are gone.

Call the Dead - This spell allows a witch to make contact with the spirit of a deceased person following an hour long ritual. The spell can only be successfully used if one of the following is present, either a) the body of the deceased, b) the location of the deceased's death, or c) a cherished belonging owned by the deceased in life. The spirit has a chance to resist the spell, and if overcome will be forced to answer up to three questions of a yes/no nature for the caster. Sometimes an evil spirit can accidentally appear (especially if the spirit successfully resisted the power) and could cause considerable problems for the caster, trying to possess him or his friends, or causing other problems.

Charm - This spell brings a target (human, monster or animal) that is within 10 feet under the influence of the caster. The caster must be able to first engage his target in conversation. The target can make a resistance roll, and if failed will loyally agree to any proposition the caster puts to him. He will not harm the caster, but equally, will not harm himself, or his loved ones. Most charmed victims will have no compunction about turning against their friends and colleagues, however. The spell could last forever, but could be negated by another witch reversing the charm spell. Note that if the caster ever turned against the victim, the spell would be broken.

Comprehend - This spell allows a witch to study any written text, maps, scrolls, carvings and parchments, and fully understand what is written there. Special signs, codes and ciphers will all be deciphered by the spell's power. It will also reveal if something touched by the caster is magical. The spell lasts for 10 minutes, and does not include the translation of *spoken* languages.

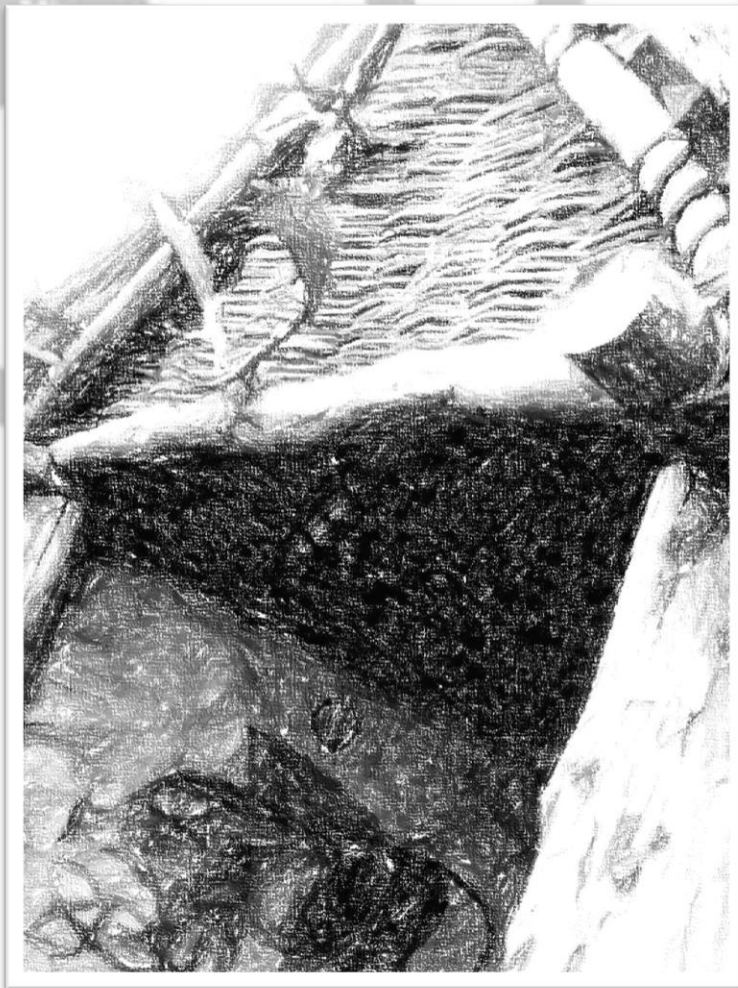
Defixion - The caster is able to harm a victim from a distance. The intended victim must have committed some grievance against the character (Dis will not punish the innocent). In the tribes the caster uses a small effigy of the person; if the victim fails a FATE roll then he suffers a nasty injury doing 2d HITS. The injury will not reduce the victim to 0 HITS, however. He will die only in the most unusual of circumstances, perhaps if his crime was very foul, but even then he gets an additional FATE roll to resist death. In the Romanised towns, witches scratch the curse and the name of the victim on a lead sheet, invoking dark gods. This is rolled up, a nail hammered through it and cast into a sacred pool (stream, river etc.). The effects are the same as above. The legal defence of a curse-writer to possible charges of wounding or possibly-even death is simple: "Dis Pater carried out the punishment, and the gods only punish the guilty". And they do - a curse written about an innocent man will not work.

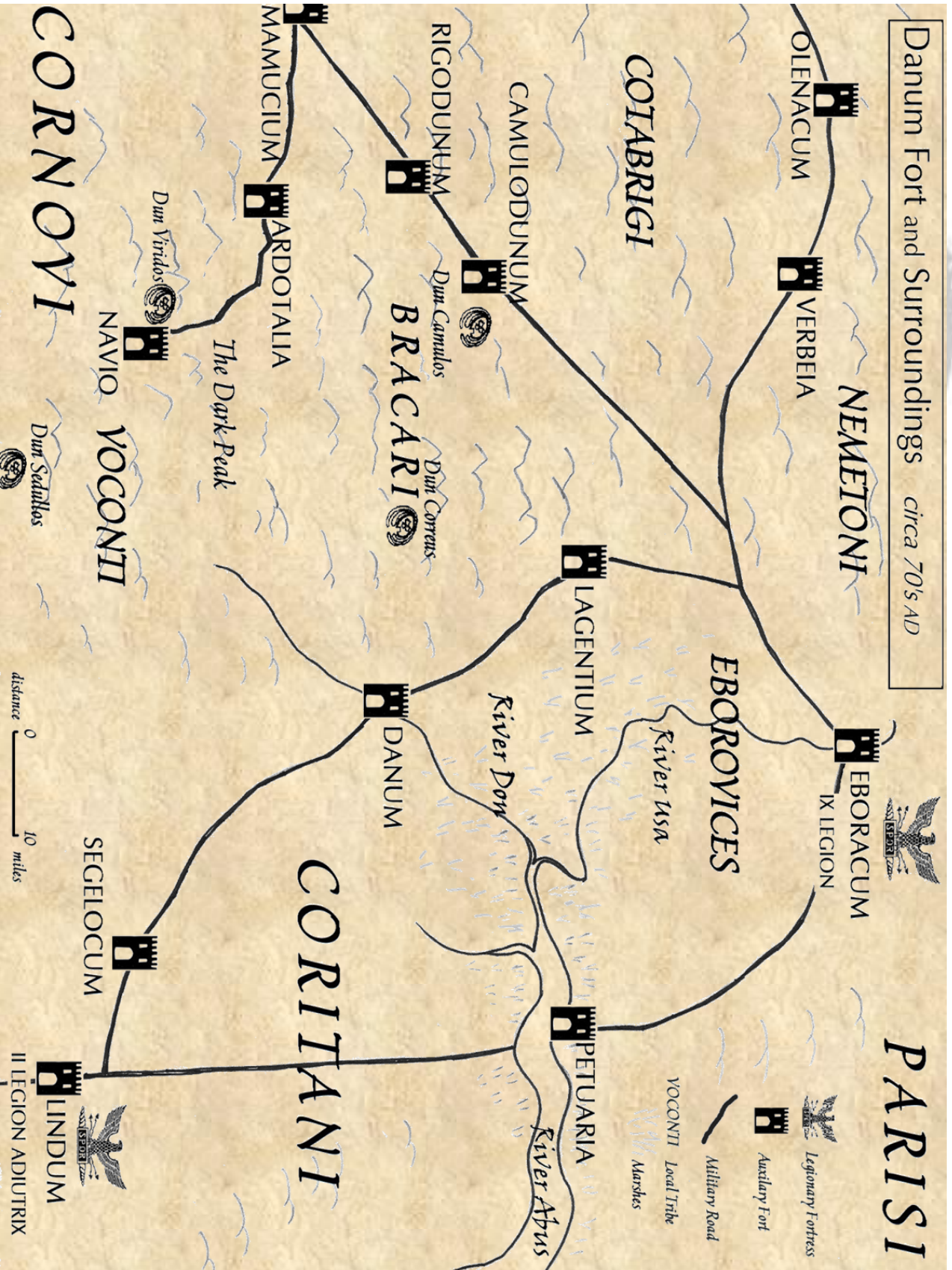
Lock - This spell magically locks (or unlocks) a door, cabinet, scroll case, chest, etc. which cannot then be opened by normal means.

Oracle - This spell requires the use of specially marked knucklebones. These are shaken like dice and cast onto the ground for a reading. They are used to decide between two or more alternatives, with the knucklebones giving the caster a 'preferred' or 'favoured' decision. The power cannot be used to resolve complex problems, only obvious choices (which path to take, which inn to stay at, which boat to hire, etc.). In this way bad choices can hopefully be eliminated.

Sleep - This spell sends a target (human or animal) that is within 30 feet to sleep. The target can make a resistance roll (animals fail automatically), and if failed will fall into a magical (very deep) sleep that lasts for 1-6 hours. Anyone under the influence of this spell can only be woken by very vigorous shaking.

Talisman - At a cost of 60 sestertii and 3 days of work, the witch can craft a magical talisman designed to protect the wearer from a specific 'something'. When attacked by the spirit, magical force or monster this talisman protects the wearer with an aura the monster finds hard to penetrate. Roll FATE, if failed, they push on to attack the character anyway (at a -2); if successful they turn away.







XI DANUM FORT

Danum is a starting location that provides the Game Master with a base location and a surrounding area within which missions can be carried out. Returning to Danum after missions, player characters will be able to interact and build up their relationships, with a number of interesting non player characters (NPCs). Danum is a Roman auxiliary fort established around 70 AD. It is part of a network of Roman forts newly established by the Roman governor, Agricola, ready for his proposed conquest of northern Britain. All of these new wooden forts house auxiliary cohorts tasked with suppressing the northern tribes whilst the Ninth Legion moves into its own new fortress at Eboracum. From there the legion will take the fight to the warlike Brigantes in the coming months and years.

Danum is a typical wooden fort built within the last couple of years ready to accommodate the First Cohort of Morini, five-hundred Roman-trained and equipped tribesmen recruited from the Morini tribe who dwell in the coastal region of Belgica province around the busy seaport of Gesoriacum (Boulogne in France). The First Cohort of Morini are tasked with local military defence and suppression of hostile native aggression. The fort sits on the southern bank of the river Don, sacred to the Celtic goddess of the same name (the goddess features prominently in later Welsh mythology and is known to the Irish as Danu), here it controls the crossing point, a stout wooden bridge built by the Ninth Legion. The map shows how the Ninth based at Lindum built a road up to the mile-wide Abus estuary where a ferry linked up with the pro-Roman Parisi tribe. When it became time for military operations to push into hostile Brigantian territory north and west of the Abus river, a quicker method of getting troops into the battle zone was required. Danum on the Don looked to be the best crossing point, between the hills of the Bracari and the trackless marshes of the east. The Ninth used the new bridge to move to Eboracum where they have just finished building a large wooden fortress. The Second Legion Adiutrix have moved into the old base at Lindum.



The river Don forms a natural frontier between the pro-Roman Coritani tribe and the warlike tribes of the Brigantian confederacy, tribes like the Cotabrigi, the Ebuovices and the Bracari. Although King Vellocatus speaks as the chieftain of the Brigantes, in reality he presides over no more than a network of allied tribes bound by treaties and dynastic marriages. While Vellocatus is firmly anti-Roman, some of the confederacies tribes may actively trade with Rome or try to play a game of neutrality. The Brigantian tribes north of the river Don are all hostile, and although none have declared war outright on Rome they present a danger to the legions and must be watched intently. Other tribes in the area can be trusted, the Parisi are pro-Roman as are the Cornovi to the south.



THE FORT

The fort sits on the south bank of the river, the military bridge crosses directly from the fort's north gate. All access across the bridge is controlled through the fort. Civilians must get the ferry boats charging one as per person for transit across the river. An annexe has been built on the west to hold pack animals and wagons that have been brought north by any military units travelling on. The cohort also has the use of a small bath-house built outside of the fort close to the river bank. The fort is new, its ramparts are of turf, topped with strong wooden palisades. Turrets and gateways are all built in timber, and the internal fort buildings are also built from wattle and daub with timber roofs.

THE VICUS

Although the fort is only a couple of years old, a small vicus (village) has already grown up around its south gate. These houses are rectangular in plan, of wattle and daub, with thatched roofs. Most are owned and inhabited by members of the Corianti tribe, providing useful services to the men of the First Cohort of Morini. Others may be owned by members of the warlike Bracari, across the river, who have come to trade and make peace with the Romans. These Bracari are not trusted, too many men (Coritani and Roman Morini alike) have had their heads hunted by Bracari warriors in the past. A little up stream is a shrine to Don, a wooden roundhouse surrounded by a sacred fence. A platform extends into the river, and it is from there that the priestess Etterna, helps locals pay respects to Don and cast in their sacrifices. The second temple within the vicus is that of Mercury Cernunnos, horned god of travellers, merchants and prosperity. He has a small wooden temple with wooden columns at the front door. Varus is the priest of Mercury Cernunnos, as well as a wool merchant. The largest building of the vicus is the mansio, or inn, a Roman post house used by messengers and officials travelling along the military road. Rooms open out onto a central courtyard. There is a common room, stables and kitchens along the downstairs range. Anyone can stay here, but prices are high.



Etterna – Priestess of Don

[COMBAT + 1]

MIGHT 1	CRAFT	3	SKILLS First Aid
FATE 4	LEARNING	2	WEAPONS: Staff +0
HITS 9	ARMOUR	-	SPELLS Agony, Defixion, Brew Poison, Call the Dead

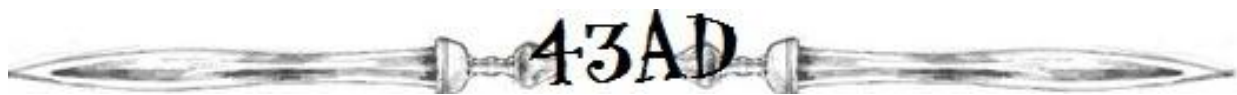
Etterna is in her mid-thirties, a read-head with thin features, and priestess of Don. She has two maidens and a blind youth in attendance. Secretly she has connections with three druids of the Bracari tribe. She gives them shelter and has contacts who can protect them whilst they are in the Danum area.

Sattius

[COMBAT + 5]

MIGHT 5	CRAFT	2	SKILLS Evaluate, Streetwise
FATE 2	LEARNING	1	WEAPONS: Stick +0
HITS 12	ARMOUR	-	

Sattius runs the bath-house near the river, and operates a gambling club, too. He is a veteran of the Ninth legion himself, now retired. His secret is dark: he once murdered his centurion during the battle against Boudicca in 60 AD. He smashed his skull in and stole his gold, and came out of the battle a hero! One druid of the Coritani knows the truth, he was at the battle... Sattius is short and fat and wears lots of finger rings. He shaves his head these days.



Sempronius

[COMBAT + 2]

MIGHT 2	CRAFT	3	SKILLS Work Horse, Seek Audience
FATE 3	LEARNING	2	WEAPONS: Knife +0
HITS 11	ARMOUR	-	

Sempronius the Italian, is a calm and orderly government official, the manager of the mansio, or post-house, in the vicus. He is well manicured and has a well-fed, contented appearance. He likes legionaries to come and drink in the courtyard of the post-house, his father was a veteran of the Ninth. He will not let any of the Morini drink here though, for fear they upset the guests sleeping in the rooms upstairs, or spook the horses in the stables. Sempronius is honest, and a good source of cheap wine and believable gossip. His father vanished on a raid against the Bracari, and rumour has it that he is now one of the 'Ghost Walkers'.

FIRST COHORT OF MORINI

You've not met a more disreputable bunch of Roman auxiliaries. The Morini are a tough Belgic tribe, and those that survived conquest were recruited as infantry into the Roman army. It is said they were cursed by their own druid as he was tortured to death, refusing to bow before the conquering legions. Now the curse haunts the Morini cohort. Others say they are just cowards, men who have fought the savage Britons, seen the horrors in the sacred groves and deep inside the painted caves, and lost their will to fight. It is likely that the player characters are part of a detachment of legionaries from the Ninth or the Second legion quartered at Danum to bolster this flagging unit of 480 men. The PCs will conduct patrols across the river into Bracari tribal lands and probably find that most of the Morini are almost useless. The river crossing is important and so the PCs and any legionaries they are garrisoned with are an important but small asset on the river Don. A poorly kept secret amongst the auxiliary cohort is that thirty men were attacked by the Bracari, the bodies of some were never found. Lately, some wild-eyed locals claim to have seen these lost soldiers as pale ghosts in the darkness close to the fort. Are they traitors, willing or unwilling? Or are they something even more shocking?

Praefect Lucius Sabinus

[COMBAT + 6]

MIGHT 4	CRAFT	1	SKILLS Double Strike, Hard to Kill
FATE 2	LEARNING	5	WEAPONS: Shortsword+2, Dagger +1, Breastplate, Helmet
HITS 15	ARMOUR	4d	

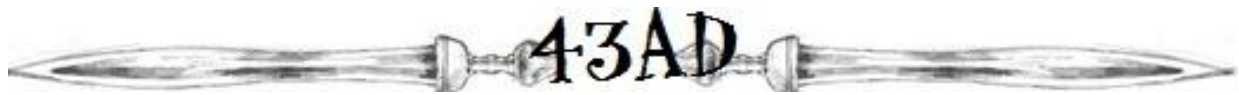
Last year twenty men were executed for cowardice by the new commander, Praefect Lucius Sabinus. He is a real martinet, a tough cookie that must first bring to heel his own troops before he can really consider taking on the savage Bracari and the treacherous Eburovices. He is aged 36, grim and fatalistic with a single streak of white in his black hair.

Centurion Gaius Cassianus

[COMBAT + 8]

MIGHT 5	CRAFT	2	SKILLS Two Attacks, Hard Kill, Shield Smash, Trap Know,
FATE 3	LEARNING	1	Streetwise
HITS 18	ARMOUR	5d	WEAPONS: Shortsword+2, Dagger+1, Chainmail & Doubling,
			Helm, Shield+1, Greaves, Vine Stick+0

Cassianus is the first centurion, and he is a good man, fighting the Morinian curse of his men! The centurion is thin, but tough as boots, a dark skinned North African who has fought in Germany and Spain. Several missing teeth, but still a wide smile when he appreciates a joke. He will like the PCs professionalism.



LOCAL TRIBES

Bracari – The land of the Bracari is one of dark valleys and thickly wooded hills, farmed by the clans. They are a warrior tribe, used to being left well-alone, and they have enjoyed setting ambushes for Roman patrols. There are many forests, gorges and valleys that provide hiding places for the warbands. Druids guide the Bracari, but the tribe is led by young and blood-thirsty King Vendubaros. The tribal capital, Dun Coreus has been abandoned for now, the warriors dispersed to their raths. Crows are the symbol of this tribe, some of the warriors wear crow feathers on helmets or paint the birds on their shields. The druids guiding this tribe wear cloaks of gloss, black crow feathers ... and are reputed to be able to steal a prisoner's soul and then send his body, like an empty husk, to do the druid's bidding... 'ghost walkers'.

Coritani – A farming people who welcomed Roman intervention so as to stop the attacks of the Iceni and the northern Brigantes tribes. The Coritani kingdom is one of flat farmland interspersed with woodland and marsh. The river Trisanton flows south through the kingdom. There are no hill forts amongst the Coritani. Their symbols are horses and suns, the warriors are chariot-crazy!

Cotabrigi – Another belligerent tribe. The Pennine mountains dominate Cotabrigi territory, wide valleys, well-farmed and often veiled by curtains of mist, are separated by rugged crag-topped hills. The Cotabrigi train their youngest daughters to fight, and these warriors are some of the fiercest the tribe can put into battle.

Eburovices – Living along the valley of the river Usa, the Eburovices have much to do with the local river trade, operating boats up and down the Usa, into the Abus estuary and the open sea. They go on well with the Parisi and the Romans ... until the Ninth legion arrived and built its fortress on the banks of the Usa. Many Eburovices live in the growing vicus outside Eboracum, by an angry minority fled into the marshes southwards where they wage a tentative guerrilla campaign against Romans. This is less of a fully-developed rebellion, and more of a Robin Hood-style 'fingers up' to Roman authority. The Romans call the gang the Red Spears and refer to them as bandits; they may have grander pretensions, but that is what they are.

Nemetoni – A tribe to the north that has made peace with the Romans much to the annoyance of others (such as the Bracari) as well as a furious King Venutius who leads the Brigantian confederacy. Rolling hills, flanked by very deep forests dominate Nemetoni lands and their greatest shrines are sacred groves within the forests.

Parisi – A wealthy agricultural tribe living north of the Abus river. The Parisi are related to a tribe by the same name in Gaul, and their links with traders and with Romans are long standing. They bury their wealthiest nobles along with their chariots, a unique practice in Britain.

Voconti – Separated from the Bracari to the north by the Dark Peak, the Voconti have bowed to the Roman invasion, though they despise doing so and will try to exploit any possible uprising. Their lands are dominated by limestone valleys, separated by uplands of sheep. These valleys are forested, and many hold small rivers or fast-flowing streams. Caves, gorges and sinkholes dot this landscape. Dun Sedullos, a mighty hill fort on the bend of a deep valley is the tribal capital, today used by the Voconti as a meeting place. The Voconti lost several battles to the Roman army, and some of their men have been enslaved to work in the lead mine underneath Shivering Mountain.

NAVIO

A remote Roman fort guarding a green valley flanked by two chains of hills to the north and south. A lead mine has just been opened up to the west of the fort by the soldiers (using slave labour of course). The mine has several times met natural caves, in fact it seems that the limestone landscape here is riddled with caves and tunnel complexes. This is the Hope Valley in modern-day Derbyshire, famous not just for lead mines but also blue john mines. Blue john is an attractive crystal, and the Romans at Navio will be



ordered to have it mined, processed and shipped out for sale. Overlooking the mine is Dun Viridos, the Shaking Mountain, now abandoned by the Voconti tribesmen who lived there.

North of the Hope Valley is the forbidding Dark Peak, a bleak and treeless plateau rising up from the valley, and dropping away to the north, east and west. Here the clouds scud close to the heather, muddy trails are obliterated by torrential rainstorms... and standing like sentinels on the rocky edge of the Dark Peak plateau are smoothly carved rock towers, oddly balanced and unnatural. These are Fomorions ... guarding the treacherous climbs up, becoming flesh in the dark or when the fog or the mist comes. The Dark Peak is death, to get lost there is to die there.

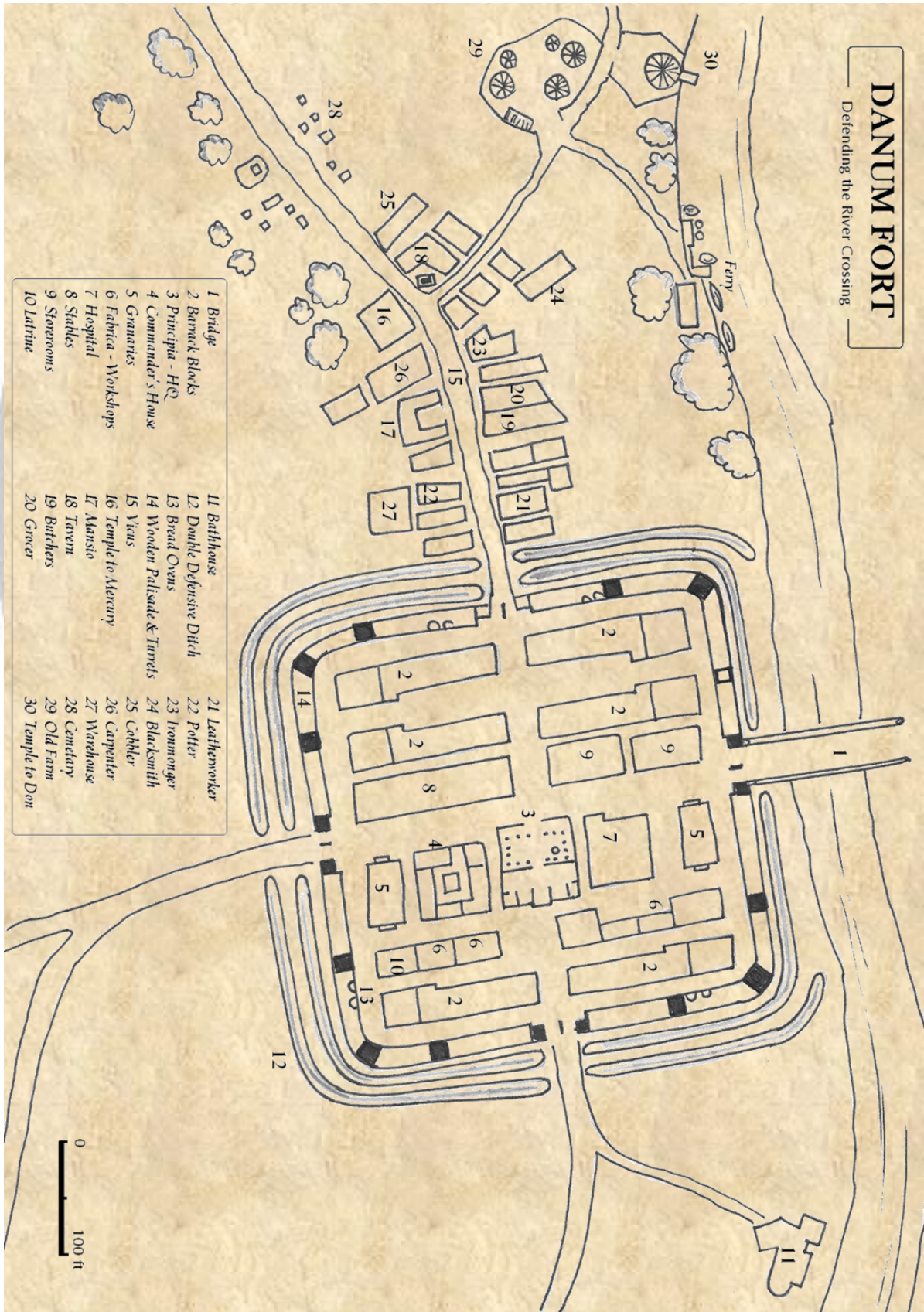
ADVENTURE IDEAS

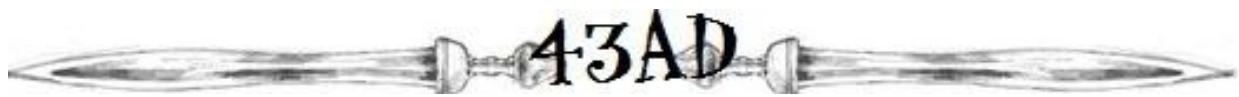
- Half of the Morini rebel and help the Brigantes cause, allowing a surprise attack by the Bracari to take place.
- A druid rebellion in the Coritani tribe forces the Second legion to send for reinforcements from the auxiliary forts like Danum. But is it a trap?
- The PCs are using Bracari guides, good men who have brought their families into the vicus and now work for the Romans. Of course they can be trusted, can't they?
- The ghost-walkers are real, and either mindless zombies or thinking heart-felt traitors (the GM decides). But what are they doing close to the fort? Are they ghosts? Can they pass through walls and see secrets?
- The Voconti have being receiving envoys from the Bracari, the northern head-hunters want the southerners back in the fight. They are prepared to take hostages to force the issue, or may offer to help free the mine slaves in return.
- A legionary pay chest has been stolen by the Red Spears and is now somewhere in the marshes, morale amongst the garrison would plummet if the news got out. Can the PCs find it quietly and quickly?
- There is something horrible and ancient in the natural caves of the Roman lead mine, a creature deadly and foul, murderous and difficult to track. Read about the monster in the short story, *The Terror of Blue John Gap*, by Sir Arthur Conan Doyle.
- The goddess Don has been stirred to hatred and several horrific events have taken place, a family were found drowned on its banks, a herd of cattle grazing in nearby fields all died and were found boneless and bloodless, a Roman officer was heard screaming in the night outside the vicus. His body was found next day in nine different places, all bloodless and boneless. Don has become a vengeful spirit: the Night Hag. There must be some way to stop her. What outraged the goddess in the first place?

The Night Hag

MIGHT 12 HITS 20 3 Attacks, Speed 30m

Powers: alter local surroundings to confuse opponents, vanishes when reduced to zero HITS (unkillable), manifests as the terrifying blind Night Hag. If she surprises an opponent (FATE roll) she is able to suck out the blood of the victims, making the river Don run red the next morning. Every successful attack in a combat round reduces MIGHT permanently by 1 point.





XII PLAY AIDS

This chapter provides the players with authentic character names, and Game Masters with suggestions for play aids and resources.

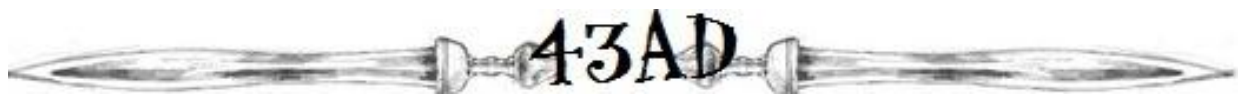
NAMES

British

Native Tribal names are of the Brythonic dialect of the Celtic language. These names continued in use with the rural population and many townsfolk who did not fully adopt Roman culture. Certainly, anyone who became a Roman citizen (or joined the army) took up a full Roman name to display their new allegiance. There are three ways to create British names. First, use the list of names provided. Second, create your own name using root words. Third, and best used 'on-the-fly' use Celtic Irish names, often easy to remember and conjuring up the period well.

List of Names: Note that many of the following names are made up separate units that can easily be swapped about to create a new name. All names in these lists are the male version. To create a female name, take one given in the list and change the ending 'os' or 'o' with 'a'; Alarcos becomes Alarca.

Adcobrovatos	Cinan	Cunovindos	Maglorios
Ambicatos	Cingetorigos	Dubricios	Maglos
Amminos	Cintugnatos	Dubnovellaunos	Melisos
Ancaratos	Cintusmos	Dumnocoveros	Morigos
Apullios	Cistumucos	Dumnovellaunos	Nectovelios
Arviragos	Cogidubnos	Enemnogenos	Rianorigos
Barito	Commios	Enestinos	Segovax
Bodiccus	Crotos	Escos	Sennianos
Brictos	Cunittos	Huctios	Senorigo
Brigomaglos	Cunoardo	Ivomagos	Tamsubugos
Broccomaglos	Cunobarros	Litugenos	Tancorigos
Cacumattos	Cunobelinos	Lugotorigos	Taximaglos
Catavignos	Cunomoros	Mandubracios	Vindex
Cavetos	Cunopectos	Maslorios	Vindomorcus



Create Your Name: Many British names were composite, made up of a root with a prefix or suffix. Some roots could be put together to create a name. Male and female had different suffixes (-os is masculine and used in the lists below; change this to an -a for feminine). Use the tables below to create your own tribal British name.

Alaunos: nourishing
Albos: white
Arganto: silver
Banno: point
Barros: top, peak
Belos: strong
Bitu: world
Bivos: alive, living
Bogio: strike
Boudi: victory
Braco: trousers
Brigos: powerful
Brocco: badger
Calgos: sword
Cambos: curve
Camulos: champion

Caros: love
Cartios: drive out
Catos: battle
Caruos: stag
Corios: troop
Cunos: hound/warrior/lord
Dagos: good
Dubnos: deep, underworld
Dunos: fort
Duros: fortified area
Eburos: yew
Epos: horse
Icos: woodpecker
Isarnos: iron
Leucos: bright
Lindos: lake
Luernos: fox
Lucos: wolf
Maglos: lord; big
Mapos: boy
Maros: great
Matu: good
Medos: judge
Moltos: praised
Namantos: enemy

Suffixes

-acos	-iskos
-alis	-issos
-anos	-osus
-gnos	-una
-inos	-tamos

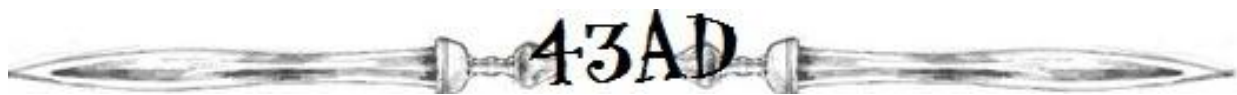
Nemetos: scared grove
Ollos: large
Pennos: head, chief
Riganti: maiden, queen
Rigos: king
Sedos: settle
Segos: force
Selgos: hunter
Senos: old
Scotos: darkness
Tagos: chief
Teutos, Tota-: tribe, people
Tigernos: lord
Tigos, Tegos: house
Trenos: strong
Truccos: unhappy
Vlat-: leader; country
Vati: prophet
Vellaunos: chief
Vendos, Vindos: white
Veni: people
Verno: alder
Vida (?): trees, wood
Vidos, Vissos (?): knowledge
Viros: truth/true (1); man (2)

Prefixes

Agr- (prefix):	slaughter
Ario- (prefix):	noble
Prastu- (prefix)	magic
Ro- (prefix):	great
So- (prefix):	good, very
Soli- (prefix):	sight
De- (prefix):	god
Ux- (prefix):	over, above
Vid- (prefix):	see
Vor-, Ver- (prefix):	over, great

Examples

Boudissos	Cunomoltus
Bariskos	Cunotamos
Bitudagos	Matugenus
Barrivendos	Senovara
Catomaglos	Totavalos



Using Irish Names: When the GM has to come up with a British name for an NPC quickly, he may find it easiest to use Irish names, these are not historical, but well known and easy to remember! The list of Irish names below does not include more modern Christian names that have been 'Celticized'.

Male Names

Aidan	Ciaran	Lorcan
Angus	Conall	Dillon
Bannon	Conlan	Donal
Bradán	Connor	Fergal
Breandan	Cormac	Fergus
Brian	Dara	Finn
Carraig	Dermot	Finbar
Cathbad	Diarmuid	Liam
		Morgan

Female Names

Aileen	Fiona
Alanna	Maeve
Branna	Meara
Brianna	Mona
Brigid	Neasa
Caitleen	Neave
Ena	Una
Ciara	Sheena
Deirdre	Sinead
Etain	Siobhan

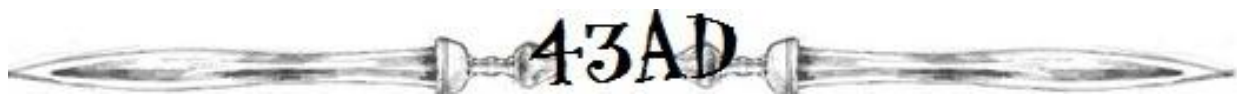
Roman

The poor and slaves use a single Latin name. Those of higher means or aspirations (this includes newly recruited auxiliary soldiers) take three names; the praenomen (forename), nomen (family name) and cognomen (personal name, or additional family identifier). There were only a few **praenomen**:

Aulus	Decimus	Numerius	Sextus
Appius	Lucius	Publius	Titus
Gaius	Marcus	Quintus	Tiberius
Gnaeus	Manius	Servius	Vibius

There were many more **nomen**:

Adaucius	Cassius	Juventius	Octavius	Sertorius
Aelius	Celerinius	Larcus	Olcinius	Simplicius
Aemilius	Censorius	Latinius	Oppius	Socellius
Albius	Claudius	Liburnius	Ostorius	Statilius
Ammonius	Clodius	Licinius	Paternius	Statorius
Antonius	Cornelius	Ligustinius	Petillius	Suetonius
Apuleius	Curtius	Livius	Petronius	Sulpicius
Arrenius	Decrius	Lousius	Plautius	Terentius
Antonius	Didius	Lucretius	Platorius	Tertinius
Artorius	Domitius	Maenius	Pompeius	Titius
Aufidius	Duccius	Manlius	Pomponius	Trebellius
Aurelius	Exomnius	Mannius	Pontius	Ulpus
Caecilius	Fabius	Marius	Postumius	Valerius
Caelius	Favonius	Menius	Quinctilius	Varius
Caesennius	Flavius	Mercatius	Roscius	Velius
Caesidius	Helvidius	Mummus	Rutilius	Vesnius
Calidius	Helvius	Mussius	Saturius	Vettius
Calpurnius	Honorius	Mustius	Sallustius	Vibius
Cammidius	Hortensius	Nemonius	Scribonius	Virius
Cammius	Hosidius	Neratius	Sempronius	Vitellius
Camurius	Julius	Nestorius	Septimius	Volusius



There were also many **cognomen**:

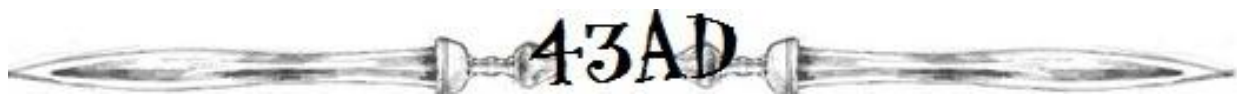
Aelianus	Donatus	Longinus	Novanus	
Agricola	Drusus	Lucullus	Paulinus	
Albanus	Facilis	Lupus	Pertinax	
Albinus	Faustus	Macer	Petra	
Aprilis	Felicissimus	Macrinus	Picens	Severus
Arcanus	Felix	Macro	Pius	Silanus
Avitus	Festus	Magnus	Probus	Silvanus
Balbus	Fidus	Mansuetus	Proclus	Solon
Bassus	Firmus	Marcellus	Pudens	Speratus
Bellicianus	Flavinus	Maritimus	Pulcher	Strabo
Betto	Fortunatus	Martialis	Quadratus	Suavis
Caelianus	Frontinus	Martius	Quietus	Super
Capito	Fronto	Masala	Romanus	Surinus
Castus	Fuscus	Masavo	Rufinus	Thurinus
Cattianus	Gaianus	Maternus	Rufus	Valens
Celer	Galba	Maurus	Rusticus	Venator
Cerialis	Gallienus	Maximus	Sabinus	Verus
Civilis	Gallus	Melito	Saenus	Victor
Clemens	Gemellus	Messalinus	Saturninus	Vindex
Coranus	Genialis	Mettellus	Savius	Virilis
Corvinus	Gracchus	Modianus	Scapula	Vitalis
Crescens	Homullus	Montanus	Scipio	Solus
Crispus	Honoratus	Nepos	Secundus	
Dida	Ingenuus	Nerva	Sejanus	
Disertus	Justus	Noricus	Senecio	

Women simply took their father's nomen (but with the ending 'a', rather than 'us'. Sisters all had the same name, although sometimes they were numbered, Prima, Secunda, Tertia ... giving Julia Prima, Julia Secunda, etc. Upon marriage they kept their name.

Slaves had one name, but if freed usually took the praenomen and nomen of their master, and added their slave name as a cognomen. Often, when a non-citizen became a citizen, he took a Roman name, the praenomen and nomen of the emperor, with the citizen's old name (often a native British name) as a cognomen. e.g. an auxiliary soldier called Tigernos of the Dobunni is given his citizenship at retirement during the reign of Publius Aelius Hadrianus; his new name is Publius Aelius Tigernus. His son will be (perhaps) Quintus Aelius Tigernus, while his three daughters will all be called Aelia. The veteran later awards his slave Charax, with freedom, and he becomes Publius Aelius Charax.

RESOURCES

There exists a large number of potential resources for a **43AD** game, mainly books, but also including some movies and TV shows. Some obvious resources are left out, since they do not say anything about Roman Britain, iron-age Britain, the legions or life for the common people. Hence, Robert Graves' *I, Claudius* is omitted.



BOOKS - FICTION

Simon Scarrow - Simon's 'Eagle' series begin with the 43 AD invasion of Britain, following the careers of two Roman legionaries, young optio Cato and experienced centurion Macro. Every GM of **43AD** must read at least one of these books, they give a definite sense of military life, the battles are visceral and immediate, the setting well realised. The series includes: *Under the Eagle*, *The Eagle's Conquest*, *When the Eagle Hunts*, *The Eagle and the Wolves*, *The Eagle's Prey* and *The Eagle's Prophecy*. Heartily recommended.

Rosemary Sutcliff - Writing in the 1950s and 60s, Rosemary's books are much more gentle stories, but nonetheless involve betrayal, war and battle. Many stories feature a young officer trying to prove himself amongst a new unit of men. Rosemary paints Britain in absolutely wonderful colours, bringing out birdcalls, the whisper of wind across moor land gorse and brings the landscape to life. She also has an empathy with the British tribes and recreates their customs and viewpoint most vividly. Her greatest work is *Eagle of the Ninth* - recommended! Other relevant works include *The Silver Branch*, *Frontier Wolf*, *Song for a Dark Queen*, *The Capricorn Bracelet* and *The Mark of the Horse Lord*.

Lindsey Davis - Famous for her long series of Falco novels, featuring a Roman investigator in the first century. Ideal for those GMs who wish to get an 'inside view' of Roman society, as well as inspiration for murders, mysteries and plots. Eighteen titles have been published, so far!

Gillian Bradshaw - This author has written many historical novels, but two in particular have relevance here: *Island of Ghosts* (the Sarmatian cavalry being redeployed to the Wall) and *Dark North* (the campaign of Septimus Severus in 208 AD).

Rosemary Rowe - More Roman mysteries, this time actually set in Roman Britain, Glenum to be precise! Almost a dozen stories, murder mysteries featuring an investigative mosaic maker...

Joy Chant - The High Celts - A fabulous book of Celtic British myths that pull in Caesar and Druids and everything else. Briton is the Island of the Mighty, and here it stands tall and magnificent! It includes short pieces of background text between the tales, and the stories are tied together as if Arthur's court are hearing them retold... fantastic.

Robert E. Howard - Howard wrote a series of stories featuring his Pictish hero Bran Mak Morn as he fought the Romans at the end of the Roman era. These stories are often a little unhistorical, but they have great drama, plenty of carnage - and horror! *Worms of the Earth* features a subterranean race of lizard-things recruited by Bran in his fight against Roman tyranny. Recommended!

BOOKS - NON FICTION

These books allow research that may expand and add depth to the background.

Roman Legionary (58BC-AD69) Ross Cowan, Osprey Books

Celtic Warrior (300BC-AD100) Stephen Allen, Osprey Books

Roman Auxiliary Forts (27BC-A378) Duncan Campbell, Osprey Books

The Roman Army from Caesar to Trajan Michael Simkins, Osprey Books

The Last Legionary, Paul Elliott (*the author of 43AD*)

Handbook to Life in Ancient Rome, Adkins & Adkins

Conquest - the Roman Invasion of Britain, John Peddie

The Roman Fort, Peter Connolly

Roman Britain, H.H. Scullard

The Complete Roman Army, Adrian Goldsworthy

Roman Britain - Historical Map, Ordnance Survey

A Guide to the Roman Remains in Britain, Roger J.A. Wilson

The Wall, Alistair Moffat



TV & FILM

Ben Hur (1959, film) is a movie of legendary proportions, and is rightly ranked as the best Roman movie ever made. Chariot racing and naval battles - amazing!

Centurion (2010, film) is a blood-soaked gore-fest of a movie, loosely based on Sutcliff's *The Eagle of the Ninth* novel, and exploring the supposed demise of the Ninth legion. Nice armour and kit in the early part of the film and the landscape and roundhouses are very evocative. The inspiration for the character types in this game. One of my favourites!

Chelmsford 123 (TV, Hat Trick Productions). From 1988, a UK comedy show that featured Badvoc (Rory McGrath) as the tribal leader of Chelmsford (Caesaromagus), getting one over the feeble Roman governor Aulus Paullus. Very funny. Large parts of the first episode were filmed in Latin, with subtitles - and those scenes were also funny!

Druids (2001, film), starring Christopher Lambert as Vercengetorix the Gallic King. **Druids** is here as a point of reference. It is one of few modern movies featuring the tribes against Rome. But it is a *bad* movie!

The Eagle (2011, film), this is the movie adaptation of *The Eagle of the Ninth*. Up until Esca and Marcus cross Hadrian's Wall it is close to the book and has some very nice scenes, the fort at the start of the movie is a gem and the Wall itself feels like a true frontier. The Seal People are depicted almost as Mohawk Indians, not the moustachioed, drunken braggarts and keepers of hospitality known from history (and the novel). The ending is strange too.... beter stick to Centurion.

The Fall of the Roman Empire (1964, film) was the inspiration for the 2000 film, Gladiator. Look to the start of this movie, the huge wooden campaign fort and the massed ranks of legionaries in the snow-clad forests of Germany. And this was before CGI, it actually looked like that on the set. Melodrama follows, but this film is one of the best.

Gladiator (2000, film), starring Russell Crowe, this is the (second) best Roman movie made to date. Plenty of inaccuracies, but that's not what the movie is about. Enjoy the battle scene in Germany and the spectacular 'Battle of Zama'.

ROAR (TV, FOX). Starring Heath Ledger, this is a great historical fantasy series from 1997 about a Celtic tribe fighting the Romans. Includes the immortal Longinus, and lots and lots of scenario ideas for a **43 AD** campaign.

Roman Mysteries (TV, BBC). A recent (and very slick and well acted) TV adaptation of Caroline Lawrence's Roman Mysteries books.

ROME (TV, HBO and BBC). A fantastic look at Roman life in the capital, with colour, brutality and a good look at the underbelly of Roman society. Sometimes ROME can be hard to watch, but is worth a viewing. Recommended.

Warrior Queen (2003, film), starring Alex Kingston, follows Queen Boudica's attempt to fight the Romans. Worth watching, but the battle sequences (with awful Roman armour and strange semaphore signalling!) will make you cringe. Round-house sequences are quite good.



RPGs

A small number of Roman-themed RPGs have been published over the years with some relevance to 43AD, any might serve as inspiration or provide additional resources for the GM.

Servants of Gaius (Bedrock Games)

GURPS Imperial Rome (Steve Jackson Games)

GURPS Celtic Myth (Steve Jackson Games)

Beyond the Wall: Pictland & the North (Chaosium)

Rome: Life and Death of the Republic (Alphetar Games)

Cthulhu Invictus (Chaosium)

FVLMINATA (Thyrsus Games)

Celts Campaign Sourcebook (TSR)

PROPS

Not every roleplaying group is comfortable with using props during a game, but those that are will find many ways to add atmosphere and immersion to their games. Others are certainly possible. The author is involved with Roman re-enactment in Britain and owns everything a Roman soldier needs to eat, sleep, pass the time of day, survive and fight ... of course some of these things cost a lot of money, and some are of doubtful value at the gaming table!

Lead curses. A piece of flat lead sheet can be inscribed with a curse in English. Use a nail or screwdriver.

Leather pouch. A much more authentic dice bag!

Wax Tablet. Buy on the internet, or make out of scrap wood and melted beeswax as the author did. Use to write in game messages! Have a lighter or candle handy to melt the tablet clear again.

Oil Lamp. Available from some museums or the internet, they burn olive oil. Keep off the table, though!

Coins. They have great value, so hand them over to the players! Use modern coins, plastic doubloons, uncleaned Roman coins (buy a job lot on eBay) or use replicas, such as those from www.westair-reproductions.com.

Wooden Bowls. Serve up food and snacks in plain wooden bowls and plates.

Food. Forget Cheetos and nachos, serve up wholemeal bread, feta cheese, figs, dates, grapes, oat biscuits, olives, wine, smoked sausage (salami etc.) and smoked cheese!

Papyrus. This can be bought by mail order (search for 'blank papyrus'), or the GM can make his own by simply staining white paper with tea or coffee and allowing to dry on a radiator. Use for hand drawn maps and letters.

Incense. Burn this (if your players don't object) to conjure up all the atmosphere and aroma of a Roman religious ritual! The author made a miniature replica altar from modelling clay, then painted it white and picked out the inscriptions in red paint.



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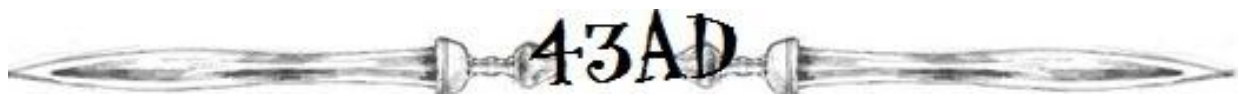
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